

*Trusting Our Future
to A.A. Principles*

**THE FIFTIETH ANNUAL MEETING
OF THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS**

*2000
Final Report*

Crowne Plaza Manhattan, New York, NY April 30–May 6, 2000

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Confidential—full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use respects our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications and with media (press, radio, TV, etc.).



50TH GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE

Trusting Our Future to A.A. Principles

"When the first General Service Conference met in April, 1951, we found that about a third of its delegates were real old-timers. The rest were active A.A.'s sober four to eight years. Best of all, the majority of them had been chosen by a two-thirds vote. . . . On their first day, the delegates inspected our Headquarters, got acquainted with the service staff, and shook hands with the Trustees. In the evening there was a briefing session under the name of 'What's on your mind?' We answered questions of every description. The delegates began to feel at home. Seeing their quick understanding and confidence, our spirits rose. We all sensed that something momentous was happening; that this was a historic moment.

"One strenuous session followed another, morning, afternoon, and evening. The delegates inspected A.A.'s finances and listened to reports from the Board of Trustees and from all of the services. There was warm but cordial debate on many questions of A.A. policy. The Trustees submitted several of their own serious problems for the opinion of the Conference. With real dispatch the delegates handled several tough puzzlers about which we at Headquarters were in doubt. Though their advice was sometimes contrary to our own views, we saw they were frequently right. They were proving as never before that A.A.'s Tradition Two was correct. Our group conscience could safely act as the sole authority and sure guide for Alcoholics Anonymous." Thus wrote co-founder Bill W. in *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, (pp. 217-18).

As the saying goes, "The more things change the more they remain the same." And when members of the 50th General Service Conference gathered at the Crowne Plaza Manhattan, April

30-May 6 — a half a century later, there were many changes but a good deal remained the same. Delegates still toured "Headquarters" (now called the General Service Office); they still "inspected A.A.'s finances and listened [endlessly] to reports." What's On Your Mind? sharing sessions still are a popular item on the busy agenda. And, yes, sessions follow each other "morning, afternoon and evening." And, for the 50th time, it was proven that "A.A.'s Tradition Two was correct."

A connecting historical thread between 1951 and 2000 was the silver-haired, soft-spoken gentleman who gave the Keynote Address. Dennis Manders, who served the Fellowship for 35 years as the "uninitiated" (or nonalcoholic) controller/business administrator has attended 50 Conferences. Since his retirement in 1985 Dennis has served as senior advisor to the trustees' Finance Committee. Dennis shared his experience and memories of the Conference, citing various events, and told the story of being hired by Bill in 1950. When Bill asked him if he drank, Dennis allowed how he enjoyed "an occasional beer or cocktail." Bill responded, "Glad to hear that Denny. We wouldn't want to hire a teetotaler who would be forever looking down his nose at us drunks."

Following Dennis's address, to a standing ovation, a large celebratory sheet cake was rolled in and it was time for that old A.A. tradition — a coffee break. Then each Conference member received a souvenir copy of the first *Conference Final Report*, in a gold binder.

This year's Conference was chaired by Gary Glynn (nonalcoholic), chairman of the board; Greg Muth, G.S.O.'s general manager; Elaine Johnson, Ph.D., Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee, and

Rick Barr, delegate chairperson (SE Ohio). Susan Ulseth, G.S.O. staff, was Conference coordinator. Reverting back to a former format, this year's Conference opened on Sunday afternoon with roll call, welcomes and the keynote address.

In his opening remarks to Conference members, board chairman Gary Glynn related, "After I was here for a year or two as a trustee, I realized the Conference was wiser than any of its individual members. Here is the one place where we absolutely have to rise above ourselves and work together for the good of all A.A. and somehow we do. Being guided by a loving God and hard work, we find an informed group conscience. . . . All of the love and acceptance that you have found at home in A.A. is here too, just waiting for you. So please feel at home, at ease, and a part of this right now."

Sunday evening the 134 Conference members (delegates from the 92 areas in the U.S. and Canada, trustees of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors and G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members) and their guests gathered for the opening dinner. An open A.A. meeting followed dinner, chaired by Mickey Hardesty (Utah). The meeting was led by Bob Peden (Northern Indiana); speakers were Brenda Sadara (S. Florida/Bahamas/V.I.), Don Miller (Colorado), Doug Richardson (G.S.O. staff), Ron Gauthier (A.A.W.S. director) and Alex Palmer (trustee-at-large/Canada).

With only two months left until A.A.'s 65th Anniversary celebration in Minneapolis, excitement ran high. Monday evening, following presentations by Valerie O'Neill, G.S.O.'s International Convention coordinator and Bonnie McConnell, Southern Minnesota delegate, the 475 Players (G.S.O. staff members) presented a continuation of the skit they did at last year's Conference.

The General Sharing Session Monday evening covered subjects that were of interest to Conference members, but which did not appear on Conference Committee agendas. Among the topics discussed were: the Big Book and copyrights, the Grapevine, La Viña, litigation, remote communities and Spanish translations.

Wednesday afternoon the Conference elected two new Class B (alcoholic) trustees. Ted Stoa of Aberdeen, South Dakota, will succeed Carl Budd as West Central regional trustee; Ric Downey, from Burnaby, British Columbia, will serve as the new Western Canada trustee following rotating Garry McAuley.

Also rotating at the end of this year's Conference was Peter Roach, Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee from Peterborough, Ontario, who has served the board well since 1994. The new Class A trustee will be Leonard M. Blumenthal, of Rolly View, Alberta, Canada. Al Perez, of Mid-Southern California, will be the delegate chairperson for the 2001 General Service Conference; Paul Jacob, South Dakota, will be the alternate chair.

Each morning at 7:30 an open A.A. meeting met and, for the first time, a meeting was available at 9:00 pm. Following the closing Brunch on Saturday six mini-buses transported delegates, family members and friends to Stepping Stones, the home of Lois and Bill W. in Bedford Hills, New York.

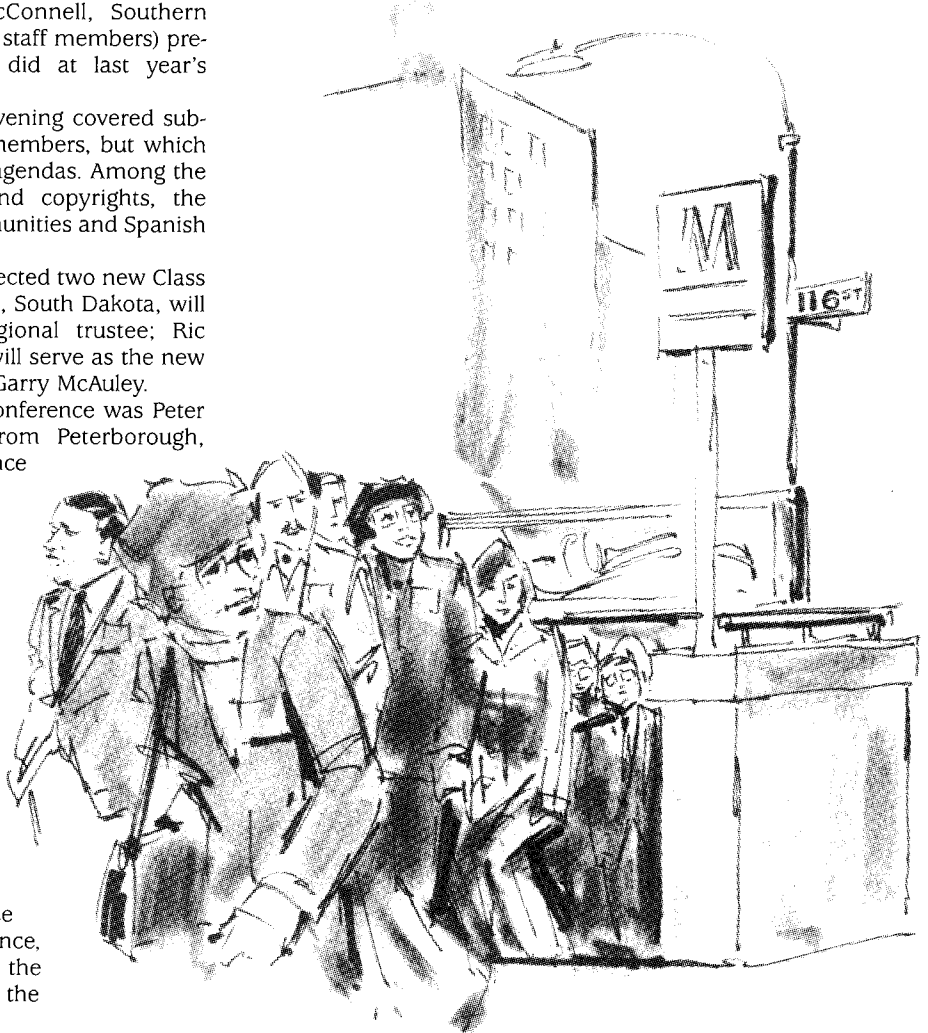
Throughout the week there were Presentations, a Workshop and Area Service Highlights. The main focus of the Conference, however, is on the deliberations of each of the 13 Conference committees, and it is during the

committee meetings that the major work of the Conference is done. After a joint meeting with corresponding trustees' committees, the Conference committees review material and recommendations, weigh and discuss various issues and come up with recommendations which may result in Conference Advisory Actions.

Just before the official closing Friday afternoon, G.S.O. staff member Lois Fisher, a veteran of 23 Conferences who will retire in the fall, shared her memories of the past and thoughts for the future. "We who serve as Conference members," Lois said, "have a vital leadership role in A.A. But should we go astray, and lose sight of the simplicity, inclusiveness, common sense and compassion that have always been present in our efforts to carry our message, we will simply not be able to 'sink the A.A. ship.' None of us is big enough to do that. The Fellowship itself will straighten us out, or simply ignore us."

Fifty years ago, Dennis Manders remembered, "that first Conference began as an 'experiment in faith and was, at the conclusion, an *experience* in faith.' If it had a theme it was 'Not to Govern. . . But to Serve'. . . . In his opening talk Bill also said 'This is your Legacy of Service, guard it carefully. We hope you will like the stewardship we have given you.' "

Thus, the 50th General Service Conference proved another "experience in faith" and trust that the future of A.A. is secure so long as the principles of our Steps, Traditions and Concepts remain steadfast.



Greetings from Delegate Chairperson

It is my privilege to welcome all of you to the 50th Annual General Service Conference. Last year at this time I was sitting out there awestruck by what I anticipated was going to happen and that I was going to be a part of it, not knowing of course, what would happen or what part I would play. Around the room were people I had read about in *Box 4-5-9* and the *Conference Final Reports*, met at Regional Forums, talked to on the phone, and knew from my region. There were all the trustees, both alcoholic and the other kind, along with the staff and others. I tried not to look too amazed, but I doubt I was very successful.

I came to understand that all of us, together, were embarking on a week-long journey of doing the business of our Fellowship. We were to work together as peers, as fellows seeking what's best for Alcoholics Anonymous. It was a week of wonder, and I felt almost every emotion I have ever known along with some new ones. By following a simple piece of wisdom that was shared with me during early group consciences — "Trust the process" — I came to understand that our principles indeed must apply to all of our affairs; that our purpose here is to preserve the Fellowship for the members yet to join.

That is why this year's theme, "Trusting Our Future to A.A. Principles," is so significant. Not only are we celebrating the 50th year of our General Service Conference, but also we celebrate 65 years of a timeless gift, our spiritual principles. We see these principles at work in the eyes of a newcomer as he or she learns that there is a solution to this fatal illness. We see them again as our home groups meet to find ways to be more attractive and better carry our message. We will see them throughout this week as we look past our own motives and perceptions to reach the accord we call "substantial unanimity."

To those who are here for the first time, welcome. This will be a week you will never forget. A week filled with elation and frustration, exhilaration and tedium. By the end of the week, at least for me, I felt a spiritual calmness, along with sheer exhaustion, and the knowledge that the principles of Alcoholics Anonymous had guided us throughout the week.

To those who are back again, welcome. I cannot express how blessed I feel to see all of you again. I am looking forward to another week of what I've come to know as the Conference experience. What a gift this is.

As we go through this week, I found that there are several tools our founders left for us. For me, they are as timeless as our program. One of those I found works very well was from Bill W. who was often quoted as saying, "The good is the enemy of the best." I watched last year, as many good things were set aside for what was best for the Fellowship. Another guiding principle was from Dr. Bob when he addressed this Conference 50 years ago and challenged us to "Keep It Simple."

I believe that it is with our principles that we have been able to steer our ship on a steady course, even through some pretty tough storms. It will be through the trust in these principles that we will stay on course now and for the years to come. "Trusting Our Future to A.A. Principles" isn't just our Conference theme, but a beacon to guide us through whatever challenge awaits us.

Enjoy and treasure this week. God Bless.

Rick Barr, Central Southeast Illinois

Keynote Address

My name is Dennis Manders and I am one of the "uninitiated" — now better known as a nonalcoholic. In 1985 I retired from the General Service Office as controller/business administrator. Here it is, 15 years later and I'm still on the running board!

The theme of this Conference is "Trusting Our Future to A.A. Principles." I would think that "trust" is the keyword in this theme — trust in God, trust in A.A. and trust in each other, basic building blocks of the A.A. program. Over the better part of the 20th century the Fellowship has grown and survived by adhering to all of the principles of A.A., and will, I am sure, continue to do so by staying on the same course. Even for this nonalcoholic the A.A. principles have been extremely important to me through all of my years of association with this wonderful movement.

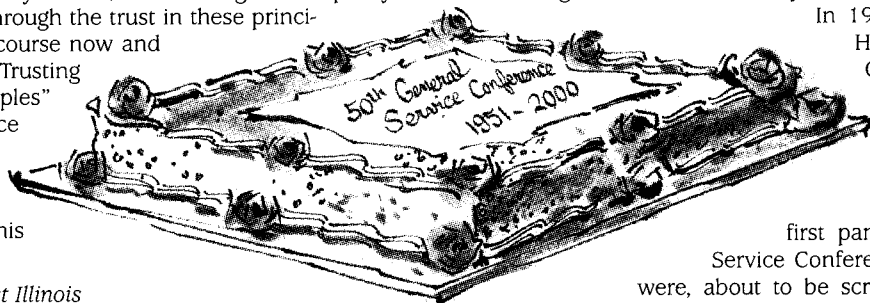
My long journey with A.A. began in early August 1950. The employment agency that sent me for a job interview never mentioned that the job was with the organization known as Alcoholics Anonymous. I had been told it was a bookkeeping position for a small publishing company. The name of that small company was Works Publishing Co., the very first company formed to handle the sales of the Big Book and the business operation of the General Service Headquarters. It was a small office on East 44th Street, with five staff members and Bill, a part-time general manager and 12 non-A.A. employees.

Hank G., then chairman of the General Service Committee, and volunteer general manager, interviewed me and told me that this was the General Service Headquarters of Alcoholics Anonymous. When he introduced me to Bill, Bill smiled, shook my hand, said "Pleased to meet you, Denny," and "Do you drink?" I thought to myself "here goes this job," but I had to be truthful. So I said "Well, yes, I do enjoy an occasional beer or a cocktail." Bill's smile got bigger and he said, "Glad to hear that Denny. We wouldn't want to hire a teetotaler who would be forever looking down his nose at us drunks!"

From that first day Bill always called me Denny. I remember that I once fielded a phone call from a really irate member. For some reason or other his package of literature had been addressed to "Charley Smith" rather than "Charles Smith." I apologized and said "well, I guess this is a rather informal Fellowship." He said "oh yeah? — what's your first name?" I said "Dennis." He then said "how would you like it if I called you Denny?" I said "just fine because that's what Bill always calls me."

As well as hiring me there was another momentous decision made in 1950. At its third quarterly meeting the Alcoholic Foundation, now known as the General Service Board of A.A., confirmed that contributions were no longer to be accepted from the "uninitiated" — now known as "non-A.A.s," and that any individual contribution from one of the "initiated" was not to exceed one-tenth of one percent of the annual budget. In 1950, based on a budget of approximately \$100,000, that amounted to \$100. By the same rule of thumb, today's maximum contribution allowed by an individual in one year would be substantially higher than that currently allowed.

In 1951 the General Service Headquarters, as the General Service Office was then known, was a rather quaint operation as compared to today's standards. We were all bracing for the first panel of the First General Service Conference to arrive. Here we were, about to be scrutinized by a bunch of



out-of-state examiners. Of course, when that first group of delegates arrived, and we all realized that the fear of the unknown had also infected Panel One, we all began to relax.

Trying to be informative, this small office had been decked out with many signs, pasted up and hanging from the ceiling. They said such things as "This is the Bookkeeping Department." And "During the past year we made X number of postings to the general books of entry." Upon reading this sign, Wilbur Smith, our then outside C.P.A., cynically said "How did you arrive at that figure, Dennis, by multiplying your age by your phone number?" To this day I still don't know how he found out.

That first Conference began as an "experiment in faith and was, at the conclusion, an experience in faith." If it had a theme it was "Not to Govern...But to Serve." The Conference was described as a "huge rotating committee." In his opening talk Bill also said "This is your legacy of service, guard it carefully, we hope you will like the stewardship we have given you."

To me, the most memorable Conference session has to be the Ninth and final session of the 1955 Conference, taking place at the Keil Auditorium in St. Louis, Missouri. This session was conducted as part of the closing session of the 20th Anniversary Convention. After Bill's proposal and much discussion, 76 delegates stood in silence for 30 seconds, to invoke the guidance of the Higher Power, before taking that crucial vote that adopted the permanent Charter of the Conference structure. It was a heart-stopping, breath-holding, emotional moment long to be remembered. Bill, exercising the principles of humility, physically stepped down from the stage to emphasize the fact that he was turning the Fellowship over to the membership. A.A. had come of age and was now standing on its own, organized around the Conference and not the co-founders.

Another Conference that sticks in my mind is the 20th, held in 1970. In 1969 Bill was beginning to slow down some because of his emphysema, brought on by too many years of too much smoking. While working on the slate roof of his studio at Stepping Stones, to repair a small leak, he slipped and fell — managing to break his fall by grabbing a small tree branch. After the fall his health seemed to deteriorate more rapidly. At the 1970 Conference he was unable to complete his opening talk, constantly losing his train of thought. All present were shocked and concerned. It was an extremely poignant moment. It was to be Bill's last Conference.

I have just picked out a few memories. The history of the Conference is so rich that it would take a historian to do a proper job.

And now, after 50 years of service, it's more than time for me to practice the principle of rotation. I cannot tell you all how grateful I am to have had the opportunity to have been a part of all this, no matter how small. I count my blessings.

Dennis Manders

Senior Advisor, Finance Committee

Workshop—

Trusting Our Future to A.A. Principles

Wednesday morning Conference members divided into groups of 12 to 14 for workshop discussions based on the Conference theme. Following are questions and a summary of responses from these discussions.

1. Twelve Steps

a) Do I sponsor newcomers? When was the last time I answered a Twelfth Step call?

Almost all participants are sponsors. Some have contact with newcomers in treatment centers, prisons, and through physician

contacts. A few participants stated that general service commitments divert them from one on one work with others. However, everyone agreed that sponsoring newcomers includes "informal" sponsorship such as acknowledging and welcoming newcomers at meetings to make them feel at home in A.A. This can be done by giving them a smile, a hug, or a pat on the shoulder, sharing our experience, strength and hope at meetings, and being available until they find a formal sponsor.

Almost all participants have made recent Twelfth Step calls and many have done so within the last year. It was emphasized that Twelfth Step calls are our most basic service and the person making the call benefits by maintaining their humility and staying out of self-pity. Those who work with alcoholics professionally also need to be "ordinary" members of A.A.

Some participants are concerned that although Twelfth Step lists in groups are long, people often have to make many calls before they reach someone, and the person calling may not get help in time. Other forms of Twelfth Step work include: helping newcomers accept responsibility at meetings, giving newcomers the telephone numbers of their sponsees, helping those who relapse make it back to A.A., taking a person who wants a drink out to eat, and helping A.A. members who travel.

b) How do I keep my spiritual awakening fresh in my mind?

Most participants keep their spiritual awakening fresh by their involvement in A.A. and sharing the joy of living a sober life with newcomers. Participants also keep their spiritual awakening fresh by going to meetings and using the Steps, especially Steps Three and Eleven. An annual inventory helps some to keep a perspective and stay honest. A.A. and Al-Anon literature also help maintain spirituality. Remaining open to the daily possibility of doing God's will for us keeps spirituality fresh. Many participants also keep their spiritual awakening fresh by working in treatment facilities, establishing substance abuse contacts, watching the indigent community come into detox, and visiting the alcoholic ward of a county hospital.

Finally, knowing the difference between what it was like when we were drinking and what it is like today, and remembering that today there is a Higher Power that we can turn to rather than the bottle, helps to keep spirituality fresh.

c) How do I use the Twelve Steps now?

Participants use the Twelve Steps in their daily lives by practicing the principles. They use the Twelve Steps at home, at work, with their friends, and in other relationships. They attend their home groups and/or Step study groups and take meetings into treatment facilities and prisons where they share the solutions found in the steps. They also learn from watching people change. The Steps are guidelines to life. Many say that the Third Step Prayer helps keep the focus and continuous Fourth and Fifth Steps are important. Steps Ten, Eleven and Twelve are the maintenance Steps. The Twelve Steps are where one learns character; the Twelve Traditions are where one learns to work with others; and the Twelve Concepts are where one attains a better understanding of life.

2. Twelve Traditions

a) Am I responsible in sharing the Traditions?

Most participants believe that they are protectors of the Traditions. Some believe that there is still little understanding of the Traditions. One group asks a past delegate to speak on Traditions once a week; other groups rotate weekly the Steps and Traditions. Some have monthly Tradition study groups. It is suggested that the Traditions be read before each meeting. In meetings we should share stories relating to the Traditions. If the

Traditions are being violated it is incumbent upon us to speak out. The home group is a training ground to experience the spiritual benefits of the Twelve Traditions. The Traditions protect us from ourselves. They are to be shared and demonstrated whenever there is an opportunity. The Twelve Traditions are at times the first attraction to newcomers. They assure them of the right to belong. Fun skits and plays are often useful and attractive to the newcomer to learn about the Traditions. Groups should also make literature on the Traditions available.

b) Does my group have an informed group conscience?

Most participants feel their home groups have an informed group conscience. However, an informed group conscience takes work. Some groups hold group conscience meetings every month to keep informed. This is a wonderful arena to exercise our spiritual conditions as A.A. members and groups. Some groups have a strict group conscience with members only voting on important issues. Others describe an informal group conscience in which members learn to listen to all in the process of discussing an issue, remembering the danger of "contempt prior to investigation." It may take more than one business meeting to acquire an informed group conscience and allow everyone to participate. It is important to share experience and responsibility rather than opinions. Help is available through G.S.O. and service literature.

c) Why is anonymity the spiritual foundation of the Twelve Traditions?

Participants believe that it is important to talk about anonymity, especially to newcomers. Anonymity includes humility, sacrifice, and equality. Anonymity protects newcomers and A.A. from its members, and it helps everyone to feel secure. Anonymity and humility go hand in hand. There are no higher ups or low-down members, just members of the Fellowship of the Spirit. Anonymity keeps all of us as equals.

Some suggest that A.A. principles will not work without anonymity. Anonymous service is important in light of working Traditions. It is not important who does A.A. work as long as the job gets done. A.A.'s future is contingent upon how well I commit myself to practicing these principles. It is suggested that past delegates help share on anonymity.

d) Discuss my role in trusting our future to A.A. principles through the Twelve Traditions.

Participants described how the principles through the Twelve Traditions have changed their lives. They are an example of "walk the talk" and they do their best to live and teach the principles. Many said they trust by keeping their sponsees involved and that it is their job to make the Twelve Traditions interesting. Trusting in a power greater than ourselves is vital.

Some suggest that it is a chance for growth when a district "strays" from the Traditions. One example given is when the Traditions are used to restrict members rather than to guide them. To protect the Fellowship and our future in A.A. all meetings should be conducted as suggested in the Twelve Traditions. The Traditions are guarantees that our Fellowship will continue undiluted. They are the glue that keeps A.A. together.

3 Twelve Concepts

a) In my home group, do I share my experiences with the Twelve Concepts and the Warranties?

The Twelve Concepts and Warranties embody the sense of trust implicit in the Unity of our Fellowship. The right of decision, participation and appeal are functioning in groups even if they do not realize it. The Concepts are to keep the structure intact for general ser-

vice work. These principles make up one-third of our heritage, so they should not be ignored.

In general, participants report that the Twelve Concepts are not often talked about in meetings. Some participants report that the Concepts are used in groups only when a specific problem arises, such as the right of a minority to be heard. It is generally agreed that everyone should relate the Concepts to members in local meetings and include where they can be found in the A.A. literature (e.g. "Twelve Concepts Illustrated"). It is important to make learning the Concepts fun. It is helpful to share personal experience with the Concepts. Some participants have their sponsees involved in the Concepts.

One new G.S.R. has started a weekly Concept Workshop. Another reported that their home group discusses a Tradition and a Concept once a month so they are completed in one year. The A.A. Service Manual is very useful in explaining the Concepts.

b) Discuss the vitality of the Twelve Concepts for World Service and how these principles insure democratic participation throughout our Conference structure.

The Twelve Concepts and Warranties contain guidance for our A.A. affairs and make it possible for every member to participate without having to be at a Conference. They help define the responsibilities and relationships with service entities and act as a basic outline to a seemingly unconventional organization.

c) What is the relationship of our Conference to General Service Conference structures in other lands?

The form of government in the United States and Canada fosters the Concepts of our service structure by ensuring democratic participation; however, this form is totally unknown in countries with different types of governments. The individual needs and requirements of A.A. in other lands determine the exact nature of their service structures. The United States and Canada cannot be an exact paradigm for reproduction in different situations.

The Concepts are active in all other countries with General Service Conferences. Although the General Service Conference, U.S. and Canada, is the senior Conference because it is responsible for the copyrights, its relationship to conferences in other lands is one of sharing experience, strength and hope. Our Conference is just one among many. The relationship and real work can be individual to individual as well as conference to conference. The relationship of our conference with the Conferences in other lands is as an equal partner as outlined in Article 2 of the Conference Charter.



Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the 2000 Conference.

FLOOR ACTIONS

It was recommended that:

- 1 The Correctional Facilities Kit and Workbook be designated as service material rather than "A.A. General Service Conference-approved Literature."
- 2 The Southern California Area 05 be granted an additional delegate area.

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

- 3 The theme for the 2001 General Service Conference be: "Love and Service."
- 4 The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2001 General Service Conference:
 - a) Sponsorship:
 - 1) The Home Group
 - 2) Sponsorship into Service
 - 3) Never Too Late to Get a Sponsor
 - b) Language of the Heart:
 - 1) Listening to the Language of the Heart
 - 2) Sharing Experience, Strength and Hope
 - 3) Passing On Our Three Legacies
 - c) The G.S.R.'s Role in A.A.:
 - 1) In the Home Group
 - 2) Link to the District, Area and G.S.O.
 - 3) Guardian of the Traditions
- 5 The following be the workshop topic for the 2001 General Service Conference:

"Love and Service"

 - a) Carrying the Message of Service

- b) Living the A.A. Principles in All Our Affairs
- c) Maintaining the Spirit of Anonymity

ARCHIVES¹

No recommendations.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

No recommendations.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

- 6 The revision of the pamphlet to replace "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" be approved.
- 7 A list of literature for young people be added to the Literature Guide section of the Correctional Facilities Workbook.

FINANCE

No recommendations.

GRAPEVINE

No recommendations.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

No recommendations.

LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

- 8 Following serious consideration of the comments and suggestions expressed at a joint meeting of the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees about the proposed new stories and the list of stories from the Third Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous* to be included in the Fourth Edition, a draft copy of the Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, or a progress report be



¹ Secondary committee.



brought to the 2001 Conference Literature Committee, keeping in mind that if a Fourth Edition Big Book is published, it will require Conference approval and the 1995 Advisory Action that: "The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, 'The Doctor's Opinion,' 'Dr. Bob's Nightmare,' and the Appendices remain as is."

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

9 The 53rd General Service Conference be held April 27 — May 3, 2003, since these dates do not conflict with any major religious holidays.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

10 Changes concerning Anonymity on the Internet be made in these Conference-approved materials: "A.A. Fact File," "A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous," "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" and "Understanding Anonymity."

11 The 2001 A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaire be approved with the deletion of Question #17 (regarding whether physical disability affects attendance or participation in A.A. meetings), since the responses to this question have been inconclusive in two previous surveys and the committee recognized that there are other more effective ways of determining how the A.A. message can be better carried to those who have these difficulties.

REPORT AND CHARTER

It was recommended that:

12 The description of the A.A. Group (Long Form Tradition Three and a section of Warranty Six, in Concept Twelve) be added in Chapter Two: "The Group and Its G.S.R." in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

13 In the section "Area Newsletters or Bulletins" in Chapter Four: "The Area Assembly and Activities," the following sentence "Many local publications quote from A.A. literature such as the Big Book, the *Twelve and Twelve*, *The A.A. Service Manual*, and Conference-approval pamphlets" be removed from *The A.A. Service Manual* and replaced with the following:

"Local A.A. publications are permitted to quote a phrase, sentence or brief paragraph excerpted from A.A. literature such as the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, *The A.A. Service Manual* and Conference-approved pamphlets without a prior, written request to do so."

14 The phrase "to use their experience, strength and hope" be inserted in the first sentence under "Sharing Sessions" in Chapter Four: "The Area Assembly and Activities" on Page S36 in *The A.A. Service Manual* to read as follows:

"In a sharing session, everyone has a chance to use their experience, strength and hope to contribute ideas and opinions about the welfare of A.A."

15 On Page S69 in the subsection titled "Financial Support" under A.A. World Services, Inc. in Chapter Ten: "The Board's Operating Corporations" the sentence "Some groups set up a regular contribution plan, using various methods" be removed from *The A.A. Service Manual* and replaced with the following two sentences from the previous edition of *The A.A. Service Manual*:

"Many groups have found it convenient to set up a *regular contribution plan* whereby they send in a predetermined percentage each month or each quarter. For part of this —or to make additions to it— they use various methods."

TREATMENT FACILITIES

No recommendations.

TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

16 The slate of trustees and officers be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in May 2000 (see page 41 for approved slate).

17 The slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. World Services Corporate Board in May 2000 (see page 41 for slate of directors approved).

18 The slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board in May 2000 (see page 41 for slate of directors approved).

Presentations and Reports

REPORT: FINANCE

Monday afternoon the Finance report was given by Art Knight, treasurer of the General Service Board and chairperson of the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee. The report was followed by questions and sharing. For more details please see the Finance section of this Report, and the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee's report.

As a friend of Alcoholics Anonymous, I'm grateful for the wonderful gift A.A. has given to my family in the restored life of a precious loved one, and for the personal gift that association with this Fellowship has given to me. As a nonalcoholic, I can truly attest to the power of this program for alcoholic and nonalcoholic alike. It has certainly changed my life in many ways, and I thank you for the opportunity to be "in service," and "of service" (I hope), to this Fellowship.

In the back of this Report is the complete report of our independent auditor, Owen J. Flanagan and Company. I want to formally acknowledge the outstanding service of Kevin Sunkel, our auditor, Don Meurer, G.S.O. controller, and Bob Slotterback, Grapevine controller. These three gentlemen, while they are all nonalcoholics, are alive with the same love of this Fellowship that you have.

In keeping with this millennium year — this turning of the new century, if you will — I thought it might be both interesting and informative if, during the course of this presentation, we occasionally referred back to that very first Conference. With thanks to Judit Santon, G.S.O. archivist, and Erin Lange, assistant archivist, I'm going to sprinkle some financial comparisons from 1950 — as reported to that first Conference in 1951 — through this report.

What a momentous event in A.A. history, that first Conference. Today we look back with respect to the foresight our co-founders had in turning over the future of this Fellowship to its members, but we forget that everything wasn't perfect. Let me share the opening paragraph from the financial report of that first Conference, entitled "Finances — Reports and Problems:—"

"Because of a substantial increase in services, coupled with a 'leveling off' of income, the three A.A. service agencies showed a net operating loss of approximately \$20,000 last year. This forced a disturbing depletion of reserve funds and poses serious problems for the future."



Compare that to this millennium year's A.A. Network News sound bite version of 1999's financial results:

1. Your Fellowship is in sound financial health and results for the year were substantially better than expected.
2. While some of the trends we have discussed over the past several years — both good and bad — continue, one significant change in trend occurred. (More on that later just to build suspense.)
3. The Reserve Fund was augmented by \$500,000 and will enable the G.S.O. to begin funding a major new project this year.
4. The outlook for the year 2000 is positive and should continue to see the Fellowship remain in good financial health.

Total revenues from all sources (the General Service Office and the Grapevine) and, separately, the La Viña project, were \$10,814,000 compared to a budget of \$10,334,000. That's \$480,000 — or 4.6% — better than expected and, generally speaking, reflects greater sales from publishing activities and higher contributions from A.A. groups as the major factors. In addition to the greater revenue, operating expenses were below projected budgets at each entity. As you see, total expenses were just slightly over ten million dollars, or just about \$229,000 less than the original budget.

The net result was a significant profit at G.S.O. of about \$866,000, offset by a loss at the Grapevine of \$22,500 and a loss from the La Viña project of \$59,000. Essentially, the positive income at G.S.O. was greater than originally expected (by slightly more than \$700,000), and the losses at the Grapevine and La Viña were slightly less than expected (by about \$7,000 and \$10,000 respectively). The net result was a profit of almost \$710,000, thus enabling the increase in the Reserve Fund of a half a million dollars.

Wow, this Fellowship has come a long way in those 50 years, but let's not forget our financial roots. In 1950, financial results "pose(s) serious problems for the future." Ten years earlier, in the 1940 financial report, the treasurer confidently noted: "Current assets include a bank balance of \$828.04, thus the present financial position is very comfortable."

I've been told (off the record, of course) that in some corners of this Fellowship my nickname is "Darth Vader." So, in keeping with that, and before we all become too euphoric about last year's results, let me again stress that the gains last year were primarily the result of stronger than anticipated sales and contributions — something we have no control over. Therefore, in my opinion, we must continue to keep a sharp and watchful eye on expenses to ensure they are always in line with revenue trends, while supporting vital Fellowship services. Hopefully, no treasurer 50 years from now will need to speak of "Finances — Reports & Problems."

Now, let's take a closer look at the G.S.O. and expand on my sound bite about the trends continuing. As you know, generally speaking, G.S.O. gets its funding to support Fellowship services from two sources: profit from literature sales and contributions. When we put numbers to that equation, we see that last year, contributions provided almost four and one quarter million dollars, and the net income from literature provided about \$2.5 million to defray the cost of services provided to the Fellowship by G.S.O. And that brings me to "good news" about one of the significant trends.

Based on the fact that contributions had appeared to stabilize at something under four million dollars during the entire period from '93 to '97, it was a significant event when contributions topped the four million mark in 1998, outstripping the previous year by 5% and essentially matching the level of contributions last reached in 1992. Very significantly, the positive trend continued in 1999 with contributions reaching \$4,242,000, a gain of

almost 4.0% over budget and more than 5.0% over 1998. That's great news!

But, again, let's reach back to 1950 for a moment. There was some good news scattered in that bleak treasurer's report. According to the report, there were approximately 100,000 members of the Fellowship in 1950, and contributions from groups that year amounted to \$76,400, an increase of \$18,700 from the prior year, or 32 percent. So 50 years ago, a positive trend of increasing contributions also was emerging. In my opinion, this Fellowship takes its Seventh Tradition responsibilities very seriously. And, believe me, if we were ever to see 32% increases in contributions in the future, full self-support of services — without reliance on book profits — would clearly be the case.

Next, let's look at both the number of groups contributing and the percent that those groups represent of total registered groups. There are approximately 56,300 groups registered with G.S.O., of which 43.2% contributed last year. We all know the importance of supporting your service entities, be they the local, district, area, central office/intergroup or G.S.O. As those responsible for disbursing the funds rotate frequently, it is important that groups know the current address to send the funds. This is especially true in today's fast paced world of the Internet, online groups, etc. There is one very encouraging note. Contributions last year averaged about \$76 per group, representing an increase of about \$4.00 over 1998.

Now, let's return to the other part of the income equation: literature sales. Literature revenue dollars, at just under nine million, were over budget by about five percent. Most importantly, that positive result was because unit sales were actually up. Here — I'm hoping — is the start of a new and favorable trend. After reporting on the decline in unit sales for the past ten years, last year unit sales stabilized and actually increased by a modest one percent. That's good news. I personally believe that part of that increase is due to a heightened awareness within the Fellowship that every dollar that's diverted to non-Conference-approved literature actually weakens the Fellowship's financial position and ability to support services.

Interestingly, this isn't a new problem. Let me share with you what the treasurer said in 1951: "Income from the sale of the Big Book and from the sale of pamphlets has declined over the past three years. It was suggested that this may be due in part to increased circulation of books and pamphlets from sources other than the Foundation." So, let's all pray that the slight increase in unit sales we saw in 1999 is the start of a very favorable trend.

When we deduct the cost associated with running the publishing operation, there is \$2,508,000 left to help defray the cost of services provided to the Fellowship by G.S.O. Said another way, contributions from groups, that's the \$4,242,000, covers about 72% of our Service Expense of \$5,878,000. The profit from literature sales—that's the \$2,598,000—provides about 28 percent. So, last year, G.S.O. essentially covered service costs and had, as we saw earlier, approximately \$700,000 left over.

Interestingly, back in 1950, total office expenses were about \$98,000 and contributions were \$76,400. So, back then, contributions covered about 78% of expenses compared to our 72% today. A couple of personal observations about these numbers: In Warranty Two of the Twelfth Concept, Bill W. wrote: "In about half of the last twenty years, A.A. group contributions have failed to meet our world needs. But the Reserve Fund, constantly renewed by book sales, has been able to meet these deficits — and save money besides. What this has meant in the lives of uncounted alcoholics who might never have reached us had our services been weak or nonexistent, no one can guess. Financial prudence has paid off in lives saved." (Twelve Concepts for World Service, p.66)

We could update the date, and say the same thing today. Income from literature continues to help A.A. meet the needs Bill so eloquently defined.

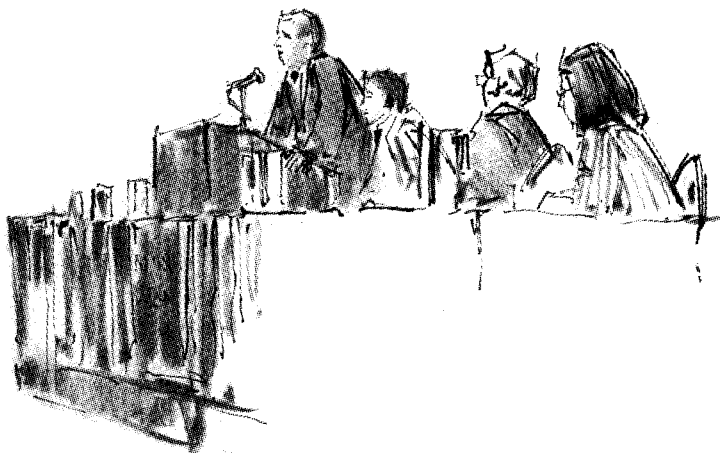
For this year, based on last year's experience, the G.S.O. budget reflects prudent optimism. The budget anticipates a modest 2% increase in contributions and a conservative 2% decrease in literature unit sales, with no anticipated change in pricing. These assumptions result in projected income for this year of \$9,327,000, essentially the same as last year.

Now that we know where the money came from, let's take a look at where it went last year. Again, a detailed breakdown is in the audited statements, but I like to look at our expenses "by type" and "by service." Not surprisingly, as a service organization to the Fellowship, the bulk of all G.S.O. spending (about \$5.9 million in 1999) is on services to the Fellowship. You can see, also, that spending at G.S.O. has actually come down a bit and is remarkably stable over the past handful of years. As I learn more about G.S.O., I am continually impressed by the enormous range of services that dedicated staff and employees provide in a quiet and efficient way. Again I think of Bill's words from that Second Warranty: "What this has meant in the lives of uncounted alcoholics who might never have reached us had our services been weak or nonexistent." (*ibid.*, p.66)

Viewing how the money gets spent by service, we can see that a big chunk goes to what I would characterize as "getting together to share." That ranges from this Conference to Regional Forums to traveling to assemblies at all levels of the Fellowship. Finally, publishing all the shared experience through the many newsletters and communications that flow from G.S.O. and the support services required to operate the office form the balance of expenses.

If we look at our expenses a different way, by type of expense, we can see that "people costs" — salaries and benefits — for the G.S.O. employees that perform all those services, is, not surprisingly, our largest expense. Next comes direct service costs, such as communications pieces, free literature, and the associated expenses of writing, mailing, etc., as well as the "getting together costs" I referred to before. Running the office — paying for everything from rent to paper clips — is our third largest category, while all other expenses (including things like the cost to pay for our audited financial report) are last.

In total, G.S.O.'s expenses last year were slightly over \$8,500,000. On a group basis, spending to support services to groups averaged \$104, exactly the same as the prior year. While the volume of communications and correspondence increases at the General Service Office, spending remains essentially flat. In



my opinion, this reflects both some of the benefits of employing new technology and the "financial prudence" of the entire staff at G.S.O. There's no question in my mind that the Fellowship gets very cost-effective service from this dedicated group of people.

For this year, expenses are projected to increase 7.7%, and reflect a modest increase in salaries and other people-related costs, as well as the start of a significant project related to preservation of our historical roots. \$100,000 has been allocated in this year's budget (with similar amounts anticipated each year for the next three to four years) for archival preservation. You'll hear more about this exciting project in the course of our Conference reports. Additionally, we anticipate another \$100,000 of expenses due to the World Service Meeting, a bi-annual event which we will host this year here in New York. Therefore, with revenues expected to be about flat at \$9,327,000 and expenses up by 7.7% to \$9,178,000, we hope to see a slight excess of income over expense for the year, projected at just \$148,500. In my book, I call that a tight break-even budget.

Turning to the Grapevine, we can view its financial health in a similar way. Like G.S.O., it receives its income from sales of its principal publication, the Grapevine, as well as sales of other special items, like *The Language of the Heart*, other specialty literature, tapes and calendars. However, by its very charter, the Grapevine receives no contributions, and therefore, if it cannot break even, it must look to the Reserve Fund to make up any deficit. If we put numbers to the question, "Where Does the Money Come From?" we see that the Grapevine operated last year on income of about \$1.4 million. That's after all the costs to produce the magazine and related items. Interestingly, since the editorial costs of producing the magazine are "fixed" — or the same, regardless of whether one or a million copies are sold, the impact of any change in circulation is dramatic and can mean the difference between being self-supporting or having to tap into the Reserve Fund.

Last year all costs for editorial, circulation and administrative expenses were about \$1,449,000, so the Grapevine needed help from the Reserve Fund to cover its loss of \$22,000. However, last year, average circulation was just about 116,000, a decline from the prior year of about 1,000 subscriptions. Here's one of those trends again: the Grapevine (our principal publication to carry the message of recovery in print on a timely basis) has now experienced four consecutive years of average circulation decline. Had the average circulation been at budget level — just 3,000 more subscriptions — the Grapevine would have been self-supporting. I guess the moral of that story is that the Fellowship's response to the Grapevine not only determines the financial health of the publication, but affects the general health of the Fellowship's Prudent Reserve as well. Like the Big Book, the Grapevine is a powerful Twelfth Step tool; hopefully, as a result of this Conference, your Twelfth Step work will include the Grapevine.

For 2000, the Grapevine is projecting a loss of approximately \$67,000, based on a decline in average circulation to 115,000 subscriptions. That's about \$45,000 greater than the loss experienced this past year. If the budget turns into reality, it will represent the seventh consecutive year of operating losses for the Grapevine. While both management and the Grapevine Board have worked diligently to get the Grapevine back to a self-supporting position, every internal projection shows a continuation of this loss trend. Therefore, with approval of the General Service Board, the trustees' Finance Committee has encouraged the Grapevine Board to seek outside consulting assistance to explore every avenue of business process improvement. A consulting firm has recently been retained, and hopefully, will bring fresh approaches and new technologies to the

Grapevine's business practices that will help enhance financial performance.

As we all know, La Viña is the Spanish-language magazine project approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. Since then, the magazine has grown from an idea to a full-fledged publication with a 1998 average circulation of just 8,000, approximately 500 copies greater than budgeted. Circulation continues to hover in the 7,500 to 8,500 range, and given the costs of production and editorial, circulation and administrative expenses, La Viña continues to lose money. This past year, because of the slight increase in circulation and the reduction in editorial expenses, the loss was \$59,000, about \$10,000 less than anticipated. This year, the project is budgeted to lose \$66,000, which would bring our cumulative investment in the project to \$461,000, all of which has been funded from the Reserve Fund. The General Service Board has extended its review and discussion of La Viña for another year, while we search for a way to bring La Viña to self-support. Personally speaking, the Grapevine board and management have worked hard to put out a quality publication that is responsive to the needs of the Spanish-speaking members of the Fellowship on a cost-effective basis. Like the Grapevine itself, the editorial and preparation costs are the same whether one or a million copies are produced, so circulation growth is critical to the magazine's success. I believe it's time for the entire Fellowship to get behind this project and show what a concerted effort to make our Spanish-speaking members aware of La Viña might do to circulation.

And that brings me to the final CNN sound bite of my opening comments: The outlook for 2000 is positive and should see continued financial health for the Fellowship. Revenues are essentially flat to last year, increasing less than one percent, while operating expenses increase 6.5%, due primarily to the people costs and major project costs mentioned earlier. The projected net profit at G.S.O. is just \$148,000, but in my opinion it is very tight. Should book unit sales decline further, or contributions reverse the current favorable trend, a small profit could quickly turn into a loss. The losses at both the Grapevine and La Viña increase. Both budgets, in my opinion, are optimistic and require full Fellowship support for attainment. In total, the combined results are projected to be significantly lower than last year, and, while in the black, essentially are at a break-even level.

All this brings me to my final point (thank goodness, he's almost done)—that's the health of the Reserve Fund. Since I've already invoked the Second Warranty, let me quote its opening sentence, which is drawn from the Traditions: "Sufficient operating funds, plus an ample Reserve, should be its prudent financial principle." (*ibid.*, p. 64)

Following three years of planned operating losses to bring the Reserve Fund back to a "prudent" (under 10 month) state, we are clearly there. Last year, the fund was stable at just about nine months as losses at the Grapevine and La Viña were offset by the significant profit at G.S.O., allowing a temporary increase in the Reserve which will be used to fund this year's major projects as required. The fund now stands at just nine and four-tenths months reserves, and, given the expectations for 2000, should remain at about that level. Therefore, I can report to you today that your Fellowship is financially healthy. Let me reiterate Bill's admonition from that Second Warranty: "Financial prudence has paid off in lives saved." (*ibid.*, p. 66)

Arthur L. Knight, Jr.

Class A trustee & treasurer, G.S.B.

2000 INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION

Monday evening's presentation session, on A.A.'s upcoming 65th Birthday celebration, was chaired by Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee Peter Roach. The presentations were followed by a skit featuring the 475 Players (G.S.O. staff), of "questions" received at the International Convention desk.

In 1991, when our delegate, Dennis B., and Maureen O. from the Conventions and Visitors Bureau made the presentation for the 2000 International Convention, it seemed so far in the future — and now here we are in the year 2000. In their presentation they showed a slide of Dr. Bob fishing in Minnesota with the statement that even Dr. Bob vacationed in Minnesota.

From June 29 to July 2, 2000 — just a couple of months away — we will meet in celebration of A.A.'s 65th Birthday at our International Convention. Minneapolis is proud to be the Host City for the Convention, and we hope to see all of you there.

This very special event will be packed full with meetings, meetings, meetings, workshops, panels, marathons, mini-marathons, and, of course, the Big Meetings and other events at the Hubert H. Humphrey Metrodome. Thursday evening starts off with a Block Party outside the Convention Center and all along Nicollet Mall. There will be dances at the Hilton and the Hyatt on Thursday night, and you may dance Friday and Saturday night at the Metrodome after the Big Meetings. The Big Meetings will be translated simultaneously into Spanish, French, German, Japanese and American Sign Language. All day Friday and Saturday, there will be A.A. meetings, in various languages, going on at the Convention Center as well as the Hilton, Hyatt and Regal hotels.

Friday night at the Metrodome will mark the Opening Ceremonies, with a Parade of Flags of those countries in attendance at the Convention — probably about 80 — followed by the Big A.A. Meeting. Saturday night there is an Oldtimers Stadium Meeting, and Sunday morning the Closing Meeting at the Metrodome. Complimentary shuttle buses will be available to and from the Metrodome events, the Convention Center and any other Convention sites.

Preparing for such an event is a lot of work. The trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums, Valerie O'Neill, the Convention coordinator, as well as Chuck Rice, Karin Nord, and Gail Sharpe, the A.A. Host Committee chairs, and their subcommittees have all worked hard to help make the many visitors to Minneapolis feel welcome and comfortable. The Host Committee is now well on its way to being 3,000 members strong! We are grateful for their service. Preregistration closes on May 15, 2000. So if you have not yet registered, do it right away (there are still some forms available in the back of the room). Of course, anyone can register on-site, but long lines will be expected, and it will be \$10 more to register on-site to cover turnaround-processing costs.

For the family members and friends that belong to Al-Anon or Alateen and will be going to Minneapolis, there are a variety of daytime activities, including meetings and workshops at the Radisson, Marriott and Marquette hotels. In addition to the English program, there will be meetings in Spanish and French and other languages reflecting the theme of Al-Anon "Hope @Al-Anon, Alateen, Everywhere."

Minneapolis is a beautiful and welcoming city, with its combination of lakes, fishing, historic sites, shopping, sports, parks and cultural activities. We have great restaurants, coffee bars and ice cream parlors.

We from Minneapolis look forward to welcoming you to this International Celebration of A.A.'s 65th Birthday, where every-

one will, we know, be speaking the language of the heart!

Bonnie McConnell, Southern Minnesota

"Pass It On — Into the 21st Century"

The story goes that the first two A.A. members went to visit the third A.A. member in the hospital. At the end of the visit, the two A.A. members asked the third if they could return the next day and the man on the bed replied, "Yes." Later that evening his wife asked him why he wanted to speak with these two men when for years people have been trying to help him and he was not receptive. He replied that he was allowing these two men to see him again because they needed his help. The International Convention cannot take place without the help of many A.A. members: those who speak, those who distribute information, those who serve as the host committee and, finally, those who attend.

The host city and non-A.A. members also experience the impact of an International Convention. I observed the president of the Minneapolis Convention Bureau explaining to a downtown businessman that no one firm would be given the coffee concession for our Thursday night block party — "that's not the A.A. way. Every restaurant has the right to sell coffee during this event!"

Service work is at the heart of the Twelve Steps and where better to offer service than to thousands of A.A. members coming together to celebrate A.A.'s 65th Anniversary? "For many of us, the spiritual joy we feel by helping is in some ways what it's all about," explains Dian J., a member of the Convention's host transportation subcommittee. "Volunteering my time lets me give back, pass it on and meet more people in the recovery community."

"My reason for volunteering is the word 'we,'" says Janet K. of St. Paul. "It goes right to the First Step. We can't do this on our own." Pete G., a St. Paul volunteer who does service year-round adds: "I enjoy things more when I'm part of them — it's more fun to be involved in making something happen rather than just being a 'taker.'" It's also a chance to be part of history. "This might be one of the biggest events I ever attend in my lifetime," observes Janet K. "Could Bill W. have imagined that in the year 2000 so many drunks would be staying sober together, one day at a time?"

On page 117 of *The Language of the Heart*, Bill tells another story, exactly 50 years before this International Convention: "On A.A.'s 15th Anniversary everybody knew that we had grown up. There couldn't be any doubt about it. Members, families, and friends — seven thousand of them — spent three inspiring, almost awesome days with our good hosts at Cleveland."

"The theme song of our Conference was gratitude; its keynote was the sure realization that we are now welded as one, the world over. As never before, we dedicated ourselves to the single purpose of carrying good news of A.A. to those millions who still don't know. And, as we affirmed the Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous, we asked that we might remain in perfect unity under the grace of God for so long as he may need us."

The International Convention, like all A.A. get-togethers, requires much behind-the-scene planning and cooperation. Following is a list of some of the things which must be done by June 28, 2000: Invite 600 speakers to share their experience, strength and hope with us; help arrange a welcome for 100 Polish A.A.s; don't forget clowns for Thursday night Block Party; make sure 10,000 seats are set up on floor of stadium for Friday night meeting; order flags for Friday night Flag Ceremony; find giant fishing hat to hold names of A.A. members with over 40 years sobriety for Saturday night at Stadium.

And remind Minneapolis Convention Bureau to arrange for Blue Line to be painted on street from Convention Center to stadium — so we won't get lost; find parking area for 400 shuttle

buses to carry us from hotels to Convention Center; order helium balloons for Minneapolis host volunteers at airport; get truck to deliver 50,000 programs to Convention Center; make sure the Convention Center orders 15,000 pounds of coffee and 100,000 packets of sugar. Keep It Simple!

The objectives of the 2000 International Convention are to provide opportunities for rededication of attendees to the primary purpose of A.A., to enable attendees to witness the success and growth of the A.A. program around the world, to let the world know that A.A. is alive, flourishing and available as a community resource, locally and internationally. It has been a long time since the first two A.A. members visited the man on the bed, but the spirit and miracle of Alcoholics Anonymous remains the same. In Minneapolis we will have another opportunity to "Pass It On — Into the 21st Century."

Valerie O'Neill

2000 International Convention coordinator

REPORT: SUBCOMMITTEE OF THE TRUSTEES' LITERATURE COMMITTEE'S PROGRESS REPORT ON PROPOSED FOURTH EDITION OF THE BIG BOOK

Before the lunch break on Wednesday, Conference members listened with great interest to 4th Edition progress report, given by the subcommittee chairman.

I have been privileged to serve as the chair of the subcommittee on the Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, which was formed in May 1997 as a result of an Advisory Action of the 47th General Service Conference. That action recommended that a draft Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, be developed and a progress report be brought to the 1998 Conference Literature Committee, keeping in mind the 1995 Advisory Action that: "The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, 'The Doctor's Opinion,' 'Dr. Bob's Nightmare,' and the Appendices remain as is."

In 1998, the Conference recommended that a draft Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, continue to be developed and a progress report brought to the 1999 Conference Literature Committee, keeping in mind that, if a Fourth Edition Big Book is published, it will require Conference approval and the 1995 Advisory Action that: "The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, 'The Doctor's Opinion,' 'Dr. Bob's Nightmare' and the Appendices remain as is."

Last year, the 1999 General Service Conference recommended that a progress report and/or draft of the Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, be brought to the 2000 Conference Literature Committee, keeping in mind, that if a Fourth Edition Big Book is published, it will require Conference approval and the 1995 Advisory Action that: "The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, 'The Doctor's Opinion,' 'Dr. Bob's Nightmare,' and the Appendices remain as is."

The 1999 Conference also recommended that the Publications Department of the General Service Office maintain the following specific editorial responsibilities regarding the Fourth Edition Big Book Project:

Times Change

During the discussion about mechanics of the Conference shortly after the opening, several delegates noted that smoking or not smoking during the Conference is no longer an issue. In the year 2000, the debate was over whether delegates could use laptop computers during the sessions.

Editorial "fine tuning" such as footnotes, punctuation, capitalization, spelling, updating, jacket materials, page numbers, etc. Thus, page numbers are likely to change for content after page 164.

Coordinating the flow of work between the book designer, typesetters, proofreaders and the production people, who order the paper and schedule the printing with the book manufacturer.

In the case of the proposed Fourth Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the G.S.O. editors would prepare or coordinate new material and changes such as: New Material — Cover and jacket design; jacket copy; preface; foreword to the Fourth Edition. Changes — Title page; contents page; factual material that appears in footnotes; introduction to personal stories.

The 1999 General Service Conference also recommended that, based on precedent in regard to previous editions of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the A.A. history book, and *Daily Reflections*, any draft copy of the Fourth Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous* be considered a work in progress, and as such, is confidential; the operating principle being that any story material brought forward to the Conference Literature Committee will be done on a "for-their-eyes-only" basis, adhering to the principle of the "right of decision," and not brought forward for any other general distribution until publication.

This presentation is the third progress report to the Conference on the proposed Fourth Edition. Members currently serving on the subcommittee are: Jim Clough, Pacific regional trustee; David Every, Grapevine director; Marne Hill, Eastern Canada regional trustee; John Koster, A.A.W.S. director; Beth Rabren, Southwest regional trustee; Vinnie McCarthy, Publications director; Lois Fisher, G.S.O. staff, Literature coordinator.

At its inception, the subcommittee determined that its process would be a sharing model rather than a formal committee structure. At every step of our work, we go around the table and each member of the subcommittee shares his or her view on the topic at hand. Each of the 20 meetings we have held to date has begun with a sense of the group on how we are experiencing our process and progress with our assignment. Every step taken is by unanimous group conscience. We do not take "yea" or "nay" votes. If there is a sense that we are not together, our process stops, we explore our different views and concerns, and only when unanimity as an entire group is achieved do we move forward.

The initial work of the subcommittee was to review 1222 stories in several stages which we called "rounds." Each story was first read separately by each member of the subcommittee, then by members working in pairs, and finally by the full subcommittee, so that every story was thoroughly reviewed. As stories were reviewed, we determined which of them we believed were possibilities for inclusion in a Fourth Edition. The subcommittee was grateful to find that the stories submitted were wonderful and the challenge was to set aside stories.

The original subcommittee also considered the stories in the Third Edition and remembered Bill's words regarding what constitutes a good A.A. narrative: "The main purpose of the revision is to bring the story section up to date, to portray more adequately a cross section of those who have found help — the audience for the book is people who are coming to *Alcoholics Anonymous* now. Those who are here have already heard our stories. Since the audience for the book is likely to be newcomers, anything from the point of view of content or style that might offend or alienate those who are not familiar with the program should be eliminated." With those words in mind, the subcommittee selected 17 stories from the Third Edition to recommend for inclusion in the Fourth Edition.

Throughout its work, the subcommittee looked for the best possible A.A. stories representing the current membership, always remembering what Bill W. stated: "We are looking for straight personal narratives which describe the drinking history, how the newcomer arrived in Alcoholics Anonymous, how A.A. affected him, and what A.A. has since accomplished for him."

In addition, the subcommittee discussed what each member considered the basic elements that make a good Big Book narra-

tative. Following is a compilation of their thoughts: Describe what happened from the mental compulsion to the physical craving; describe the progress of the disease including the denial, the alibis, and self-delusion. Describe the self-imposed crisis that made the author look at his or her drinking. Describe one's introduction to A.A., sponsorship, spiritual development and how the author works the program, offering a solution to the newcomer. Describe participation in A.A. service.

After thoroughly reviewing 1222 stories by late spring of 1999, the original subcommittee had reduced the stories to 95. Those who had submitted stories that would not be included in the Fourth Edition were notified and their stories were returned.

Last May, several members rotated off the subcommittee and others joined the group. The number serving on the subcommittee increased by two when rotation took place. Four regional trustees were asked to serve on the subcommittee with the idea that regional trustees have more opportunities to interact with members of the Fellowship from many different areas, thus increasing opportunities to share information about the progress of the Fourth Edition Big Book.

The current subcommittee has chosen to follow the same sharing model. Their task was to review the 95 stories selected by the first subcommittee and ultimately to select the best of the best. In the course of our deliberations, using the same criteria, the 95 stories became a short list of 38. Aware that we may have ten to fifteen too many stories, the subcommittee then recommended that this year's Conference Literature Committee be sent the 38 stories selected by the subcommittee as well as a list of stories in the Third Edition that are suggested for inclusion in the proposed Fourth Edition. The members of the Conference Literature Committee were asked to adhere to the confidentiality policy of the subcommittee. That same information was also sent to the members of the trustees' Literature Committee not currently serving on the Big Book Subcommittee. A joint meeting of the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees was scheduled for Saturday, April 29, 2000 prior to the opening of the General Service Conference for the purpose of obtaining input about the selected stories.

Following this Conference, the subcommittee will give serious consideration to all input received from the Conference Literature Committee prior to recommending to the trustees' Literature Committee which stories should be forwarded to Publications for editing. After the stories are edited, a draft of the Fourth Edition Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, will be forwarded to the General Service Conference, through the Conference Literature Committee, for approval. The earliest this could happen would be the 2001 Conference.

Garry McAuley
Western Canada regional trustee



TRUSTING OUR FUTURE TO A.A. PRINCIPLES

Wednesday afternoon's presentation/discussion session was chaired by Dick Martin, Southern Illinois.

Recovery: Trust the God of Your Understanding

I came to Alcoholics Anonymous without a

belief in God. It was not that I did not believe in God, but rather that the question of His existence and belief in His power had not ever been decided in my mind. As a child and early teen I had been exposed to church, but did not see that it had any relevance in my life and when I was able to I quit attending.

That is not to say that I didn't ask God for help, because I did. When I was having a particularly hard time due to my drinking I would invoke the "drunkard's prayer," making bargains with God, promising that if I would only be allowed to get out of this one I would never drink again. Of course when the heat was off I would begin to rationalize that what I really meant was that I just wasn't going to drink so much that bad things would happen. Soon I would be off and running, putting any thought of God on the shelf to be dusted off again when things once again got bad enough. These requests of God were not due to a conscious belief in the existence of or power of Him, but rather they were due to desperation.

When, through the grace of God, I was guided to A.A. I was told that your simple Twelve Step program could be summarized as — trust God, clean house, and help others. As the fog cleared and I was able to examine the Steps for myself and listened to you at meetings, I slowly began to accept that these principles you were giving me offered hope that my life could change. However, I wouldn't accept that any belief or trust in God was necessary for this to work.

In a book written for the 25th Anniversary of A.A. called *A.A. Today*, Bill wrote detailing Ebby's visit to him on that fateful November day in 1934. Bill recounts that, "Ebby told me his story, carefully describing his drinking...establishing his identification with me." Ebby's message included "...that vital attitude of dependence on God, or a higher power." (*The Language of the Heart*, p. 245) Bill says that Ebby sold him at once on his message, but not on a dependence on God.

In speaking of his difficulty with accepting a belief in God, Bill goes on to say that "Mine was exactly the kind of deep-seated block we so often see today in new people who say they are atheistic or agnostic. Their will to disbelieve is so powerful that apparently they prefer a date with the undertaker to an open-minded and experimental quest for God. Happily for me, and for most of my kind who have since come along in A.A., the constructive forces brought to bear in our Fellowship have nearly always overcome this colossal obstinacy. Beaten into complete defeat by alcohol, confronted by the living proof of release, and surrounded by those who speak to us from the heart, we have finally surrendered." (*ibid.*, pp. 245-46)

This too is what happened in my life. When faced with the hopelessness and helplessness in my life, I had to become willing to be willing to believe in a power greater than myself. The door to believing in a Higher Power began the day an oldtimer, tired of hearing me question the existence of or need for God, asked me how long I had been sober. I proudly told him that I had been

sober for just over three months. He then asked me how long I had ever been able to stay sober on my own. I sheepishly said that it had been years since I had been sober more than a few days in a row. He went on to say that I might want to consider that God was doing for me what I could not do myself. This was the beginning that allowed me to begin to see all that God was doing for me, even before I got sober, forming the foundation for a trust in the loving care of the Higher Power that I was given by the program of Alcoholics Anonymous.

With trust in this Higher Power that I call God, the decision in the Third Step to turn my will and my life over to Him has not been difficult. I feel as if I have been gently placed in God's loving hands, and I no longer have to live in fear.

As the Big Book says, "For we are now on a different basis; the basis of trusting and relying upon God. We trust infinite God rather than our finite selves. We are in the world to play the role He assigns. Just to the extent that we do as we think He would have us, and humbly rely on Him, does He enable us to match calamity with serenity." (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 68)

Today, when events in my life are not occurring the way I would like, I have the trust in God to believe that it is happening just the way it is supposed to, and in the end it will be all right. This is what others in A.A. have shared happened in their lives and what, from my own experience, has happened in mine. What more proof could I ask?

Joe Deneault, West Virginia

Recovery: Clean House

What a privilege to be here representing Nevada (Area 42) and, as each of us knows, the Fellowship as a whole. My topic, Recovery: Clean House, is one of the core principles, so dear to us as recovering alcoholics. My own experience with this principle was one of avoidance and dread in the beginning. With the strong and patient lead of good sponsorship and lots of meetings, I was able to begin to make progress in the ongoing task of cleaning house.

Cleaning house is embodied in Steps Four and Five of our Twelve Steps of recovery. Our Big Book puts the strongest warning possible concerning this phase of our development in recovery. Let me share that familiar passage on Step Four from Chapter Five, page 66 of our Big Book. "It is plain that a life which includes deep resentment leads only to futility and unhappiness. To the precise extent that we permit these, do we squander the hours that might have been worth while. But with the alcoholic, whose hope is the maintenance and growth of a spiritual experience, this business of resentment is infinitely grave. We found that it is fatal. For when harboring such feelings we shut ourselves off from the sunlight of the Spirit. The insanity of alcohol returns and we drink again. And with us, to drink is to die."

Further counsel is given in the portion on Step Five, Chapter 6, page 72: "If we skip this vital step, we may not overcome drinking. Time after time newcomers have tried to keep to themselves certain facts about their lives. Trying to avoid this humbling experience, they have turned to easier methods. Almost invariably they got drunk." In simple, uncomplicated language, our recovery is threatened if we choose to bypass or minimize these all-important "house cleaning" Steps. Without a searching and fearless moral inventory personal recovery is sure to escape us.

The 2001 chair of the Conference Committee on Trustees came out of the hat. Mike Barnes (Western New York) will be the chair and Linda Counts (NW Texas) the alternate. When it came time to vote for next year's chair of the Serenity A.A. Group it went to the hat—and, you guessed it, Linda is chair and Mike co-chair.

And this great principle of unsparing self-survey also serves us well throughout our sober lives.

We learned with time that this principle, so vital to our personal recovery, must have a larger application if Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole is to remain healthy. Turning the focus of surveying and inventory to the local home group, central office, district, area assembly and even the Conference is a most important tool if these entities are to remain spiritually healthy.

Remaining spiritually fit insures that our main purpose, that of carrying the message of recovery to the still-suffering alcoholic, does not become diluted in any way. None of these entities are exempt from the problems that beset us as individuals in recovery. Self-seeking that can blindly lead us as individuals can also take the effectiveness out of our collective efforts to carry the message at all these levels of service.

Let me focus for a few moments on our efforts here at this Conference. Incorporated in this year's theme, "Trusting Our Future to A.A. Principles," is one of the key elements, that of "Recovery: Clean House." This reminds all of us to be especially cautious in our deliberations.

Spirituality is letting self-interests go and searching for God's will in all matters. Searching out and sacrificing our own personal agenda will always be the starting point for us as we strive to determine the conscience of the Fellowship. The participants of past Conferences have taken the time to do the house cleaning necessary to keep this year's Conference on track and healthy. Our job is to avoid discussion and argument that goes beyond healthy debate to the extent that it becomes unproductive and divisive.

Cleaning house, with a time-out and an examination of our direction, can bring us back to a renewed purpose. The time we may take to review our purpose and direction allows us to renew our effort to seek a mutual understanding.

Doing the work in committee, coming together here for further deliberation and then voting on each agenda item can only be of maximum effectiveness if we individually have sought to set aside self. Seeking only that which is best for the Fellowship as a whole is our goal. If we are to be successful in our deliberations at this Conference we will have to follow, both personally and collectively, that "course of vigorous action" spoken of in the Big Book (p. 63). If we keep our house clean wherever we serve, the message will be there for the still-suffering alcoholic. "The answer will come, if your own house is in order."

My prayer for us here is that we continually "See to it that our relationship with Him is right, and great events will come to pass for you and countless others." (*ibid.*, p. 164)

Thank you for this opportunity to serve. May God's will for our Fellowship be found here this week.

Dick Hill, Nevada

Recovery: Work With Others

When I received the loving invitation to give a presentation during the 50th General Service Conference, my first thought was "I am chairing the morning meeting, isn't that enough, Lord?" My second thought was, "I must be sicker than most, so I need all the service I can get." My third thought was to call my sponsor and get her insights on this topic, "Recovery: Work with Others." I never think of saying "no"; I am always grateful to be asked to do anything in A.A. (I wasn't asked to do much before I got here!) And I have found that working with others teaches me how to love.

The Foreword to the Third Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous* (p. xxii) states, "Each day, somewhere in the world, recovery begins when one alcoholic talks with another alcoholic, sharing experi-

ence, strength, and hope." This is how we share our message. This is how I remember my recovery and its start:

The world is dark — suddenly you see a pinpoint of light — somewhere inside, you dare to hope. You move toward the light. It flickers, but burns steadily and you see others who are also moving toward the light. You stumble, tell yourself it will fade soon, but feel compelled to keep moving forward. Someone says "Hello, you are in the right place; you don't have to drink today." You hear the words "We" and "Welcome." "What should I do?" you ask, and at that moment, recovery begins.

These people who seem like strangers, and certainly are not to be trusted, start to make you feel that perhaps they understand. They tell you they will love you until you can love yourself. They tell you to keep coming. They seem to know you even though you are still "terminally unique." This becomes my A.A. group, my people, my kind. I belong to them. Every prejudice, every barrier, dissolves because I can hear that they feel like me, think like me, and most importantly, (I know) they *drank* like me. They encourage me to participate, to become a part of. They gave me keys to the church, a coffeepot to fill, a Big Book and a seat.

Recovery and working with others are interdependent, each sustains the other. Each breathes the breath of life into the other, into the life of the program of Twelve Steps. Working with others keeps us ever mindful that we are not running the show. Working with others means that we must call upon our Higher Power to help us help others, because we know we cannot do it alone. We cannot get another person sober, happy and involved, by ourselves. We need the help of a Higher Power. We need a sponsor; we need the Twelve Steps of recovery, the Unity of the Traditions, and the growth that service provides.

Walk out of this hotel, look in a doorway, see a drunk lying there — foul-smelling and useless — and ask yourself (in your clean suit with your clear eyes), how did I get here from there? The answer for us all, I believe, is Alcoholics Anonymous.

"Don't Drink!"

"Go to meetings and help another alcoholic."

"You can't keep it unless you give it away."

"Get a sponsor, a home group, do service." What does it all mean? For most of us, it means the opportunity to recover.

We can work in prisons, hospitals, nursing homes. We answer telephones at our local intergroup or central office. We can work at conventions, with young people, old people, people with special needs (i.e., the deaf, blind, home bound, Sober-over-60, developmentally disabled). We can work with alcoholics of different cultures, with different values, in different languages, but at the core of it all is the disease of alcoholism, the desire not to drink, our Third Tradition. Nothing has been found to benefit us more spiritually or emotionally than working with another alcoholic.

When I was newly sober, I often asked, "Why did I get sober? So and so is more deserving, more valuable, more important." I have come to believe that I was given sobriety so that I could pass it on. Since our sobriety is based on a "daily reprieve based on our spiritual condition" in any given 24-hour period, we must work with others to learn to love. We must love each other or perish.

As Dr. Bob wrote: "And one more thing: None of us would be here today if somebody hadn't taken time to explain things to us, to give us a little pat on the back, to take us to a meeting or two, to do numerous little kind and thoughtful acts in our behalf. So let us never get such a degree of smug complacency that we're not willing to extend or attempt to extend, to our less fortunate brothers that help which has been so beneficial to us." (*Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers*, p. 338)

Let us all keep the torch of sobriety burning through our love for each other as we trudge the road of happy destiny together.

Cookie Schamroth, Southeast New York

A.A. AROUND THE WORLD

The following presentations, on Wednesday evening, were given by the chairman of the trustees' International committee and the staff member on the International desk.

Co-founder Bill Wilson was truly a visionary when he proposed a World Service Meeting in 1967. It was inconceivable at that time that A.A. would have presence in 150 countries by the year 2000. The growth of A.A. around the world should be attributed to the efforts of various managers and staff at the General Service Office who provided literature, shared experiences by letter and personal appearances. The membership of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, in its supervisory capacity, continues to be made up by the General Service Conference electing new trustees committed to carrying the message of recovery through the General Service Board's two service corporations — A.A. World Services, Inc. and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. These two service corporations provided the organizational format to assist alcoholics worldwide. The growth of A.A. around the world would not have occurred if our membership had not consistently maintained our A.A. principles, found in our Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions, Twelve Concepts for World Service and the Six Warranties.

Consistent maintenance of our anonymity and singleness of purpose has sent a clear message to people that A.A. is no different in the United States/Canada Conference than it is in South Africa, Mexico, Poland, New Zealand or any other country that is following our A.A. principles. The shared experience of one alcoholic finding sobriety and a new way of life through A.A. — three Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service — has given A.A. the opportunity to expand in all parts of the world.

As your trustee at-Large/U.S., and World Service delegate, I have had the privilege of attending the World Service Meeting in Auckland, New Zealand, in October 1998; the Meeting of the Americas, Zonal Meeting held in Guadalajara, Mexico, in October 1997; San Salvador in October 1999; and the 7th National Mexican National Convention in Matzalan, Mexico, in November 1999.

From these experiences I know the work of the staff of the General Service Office and the General Service Board of A.A. has a commitment to assist other countries with their literature, and provide shared experience by mail and direct personal participation with many A.A. structures throughout the world. Through our current Conference Charter we have provided licensing agreement for one A.A. service structure per country to publish A.A. copyrighted books and literature. The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous holds the copyrighted literature in trust for A.A. worldwide.

The future growth of A.A. around the world will depend on how well we carry the message of recovery from alcoholism through our shared experience and our literature. The letters "S.S." in A.A. stand for Service equals Sacrifice. The service of one alcoholic sponsoring another alcoholic is carried out at a larger scale worldwide, with one country sponsoring another country.

Country-to-country sponsorship has allowed A.A. to flourish and grow from one country to another, particularly where the language was not a barrier and the countries could exchange literature. A.A. members have visited and participated with other countries by assisting in workshops, helping set up service structures, and exchanging shared experiences. Our A.A. friends in Mexico are heavily engaged in this activity on a country-to-country sponsorship with Cuba, the results of which are outstanding and hold a great promise for future growth and development of A.A. in Cuba.

The proposed agenda for the forthcoming 16th World Service Meeting, to be held October 2000 in New York, has workshop

topics which are an example of what we do to assist each other in our worldwide Fellowship. Topics will include 1) Resolving Difficulties in the Development of Service Structures; 2) Is A.A. Still Attractive? and 3) Communication Between Countries.

The theme for the 16th World Service Meeting will be "A.A.—Our Future is Our Responsibility" and approximately 40 delegates from around the world will have an opportunity to discuss how their countries are fulfilling the responsibilities of carrying the message into the new millennium and the challenges we are facing in fulfilling our primary purpose.

Some of the same topics we discussed in our General Service Conference will be discussed and shared at the 16th World Service Meeting. They include: 1) The Flow of Information within A.A., i.e. Handling Anonymity; 2) Making Service More Attractive Through Improving Communication; 3) How Can We Better Carry the Message to Other Countries?; 4) Changeless Message in a Changing World; and 5) United For Those Yet to Come.

Regardless of our country of origin, race, ethnic background or religion the common denominator for all alcoholics is alcoholism. Our recovery from alcoholism is our single and primary purpose. We have no other. A.A. will continue to grow around the world and our future will be secure so long as we base our operations and future growth upon A.A. principles. There is only one language in A.A., and that is the language of the heart.

Dean Rinehart, trustee-at-large/U.S.

Do you ever wonder just how far the A.A. message has traveled?

Several weeks ago a small tattered envelope containing a handwritten note in Cyrillic landed on my desk — a simple, yet profound message of gratitude to A.A.: "Thank you from my whole heart for the blue book about Alcoholics Anonymous you sent and for paying attention to me living in the small township of Amazar near the Baikal Lake, concerned about an alcohol problem."

Some of you may be asking "Just where is Amazar?" And my response would simply be "Not very close." That postmarked envelope from south central Russia — east of the Borshchovochnyy Mountains and close to Mongolia, but nearer to the China border — took over three months to get to my desk at G.S.O. in New York. Leave it to your imagination to trace the route which that small tattered envelope may have taken to get here or how long the Big Book we sent took to reach the newcomer in Amazar. You need not wonder, anymore, just how far and wide our message of hope continues to travel around the world and under many various conditions.

Today there are 46 International General Service Offices. Some offices are fairly large and staffed by a dozen or more employees, others are small one-person offices. Whether large or small, we all have one common mission — to help carry the message of hope and recovery to the alcoholic who still suffers. When an inquiry comes in from overseas where there is an existing G.S.O. or central office, we always try and refer to the appropriate service center. As we are getting ready to light our 65th A.A. Anniversary candle, let us not assume that our work is done. We are still continuing to reach parts of the world where the A.A. candle has just been lit, and there are places, near and far, where the drunk is still stumbling in the dark searching for a way out.

Looking back over a decade or more, we have seen Eastern Europe open up to the Fellowship. We have also heard the magical and moving accounts told by staff or read the stories in *Box 4-5-9* or our meeting in print, the A.A. Grapevine, of how the A.A. message was carried to Cameroon, China, Czech Republic, Poland, Russia and Slovakia. We have also seen the phenomena

of rapid growth in Poland, where in October, at the Tenth European Service Meeting held in Germany, it was reported that there are well over 1,500 groups in Poland and they are growing in "leaps and bounds." Last year Poland celebrated its 25th A.A. Anniversary, Iceland celebrated its 45th and the Ukraine held its 10th-year celebration. In May Belarus will be celebrating its 10th.

As exciting as these past decades have been in Eastern Europe, future expansion seems to be in the emerging countries of Asia and Africa. In China, Mongolia and Korea A.A. groups do exist, yet there is no general service structure at this time. Last fall we heard of a group springing up in Cape Verde, off the west coast of Africa. The formation of this group was the result of the tireless Twelfth Step efforts of an American working overseas. We might look at this A.A. member as a "one-man international C.P.C. committee," as he spreads the A.A. message wherever he goes.

Early this year we were contacted by a member who had recently traveled to his native country of Togo with A.A. literature. Later, he called to share with us his excitement — 30 alcoholics met together for their first A.A. meeting in Togo and fell in love with the Steps. And more recently, we received a letter from a health organization in the Democratic Republic of the Congo asking for information about Alcoholics Anonymous. Within a few days we sent a letter explaining A.A. along with literature and contact information. But none of this would be possible if it weren't for groups participating in service and their generous contributions.

It was at last year's Conference that some of you heard the mountain-top account of how A.A. started in Cameroon through dedicated members in France sharing with an alcoholic (former inmate) working in a prison in Cameroon. Seizing the opportunity while traveling in South Africa and Europe this past year, the staff member on the International desk at the time shared with board members of Great Britain and South Africa a mutual interest in helping to further carry the A.A. message throughout Africa. As a result, this past February, Greg Muth and I boarded a plane to Johannesburg, South Africa. We met with board members of Great Britain and South Africa to discuss the possibility of setting up a zonal service meeting for the sub-Saharan countries of Africa. While still in the initial stages, there is a mysterious occurrence spreading throughout the 14 countries as pockets of enthusiasm and interest have surfaced and perked an interest in the Twelfth Step opportunities which lay ahead for our friends in Africa. With growth, the Fellowship of Africa will face many challenges. First, there is only one General Service Office in Africa and it is located in South Africa. There are over 54 countries throughout Africa and languages range from three in smaller countries to over 400, including dialects. Arabic, English, French, German, Portuguese or a combination of these may or may not be a secondary or third language. There also remains the fact that there is an indelibly high illiteracy rate. This means there will be a need for something more than our A.A. literature to aid in carrying the message of hope and recovery. In God's hands anything is possible, and our hope is that each day, somewhere in the world, through whatever obstacles or barriers, the hand of A.A. will be there. Country sponsorship, I believe, will be of vital importance to the Fellowship in Africa.

In January, Cuba celebrated its 7th A.A. Anniversary, and I journeyed to Cuba to join in the celebration. One of the challenges of carrying the message on the island is the sparsity of A.A. literature. It is not unusual for several members to share books. We have seen this in many countries where economics plays a key factor. In spite of this, I was astounded and awestruck by the basic, simple, profound message of recovery and hope shared by many on the island — A.A. at its finest, one alcoholic

sharing with another by that all familiar language of the heart. Their newly formed General Service Office in Havana reported over 98 groups and an estimated membership of over 1,000 in Cuba. Since 1995, Mexico has been sponsoring Cuba and last year Cuba held its first General Service Conference. All 26 areas were represented by trusted servants. Because of the generous contributions of A.A. groups in the U.S. and Canada, we recently were able to augment the A.A. literature provided by the Board of Central Mexicana for the Fellowship in Cuba.

On the A.A. landscape of service worldwide, country sponsorship is one of the most instrumental and inspiring A.A. experiences we have seen in recent years. We have learned that Mexico is now actively sponsoring Belize and is helping them move toward setting a service center to provide services. At the Tenth European Service Meeting we learned that Spain's sponsorship was instrumental in helping Portugal to establish their first General Service Conference. Just as in the beginning, when our co-founders Bill and Dr. Bob met for the first time — one alcoholic sharing with another — and just as one sponsor passes along experience, strength and hope to another alcoholic, our A.A. experience reveals that when one country shares their experience, strength and hope with another country, it makes for greater unity, recovery and service, which grows far beyond all boundaries.

Over 30 years ago, plans were well underway for the First World Service Meeting. Bill W. stated that the objectives of this historic meeting would be to consider future development of world services; to strengthen general service work existing abroad; to increase the number of service centers; to provide for them an orderly plan of evolution; and to assist in strengthening their self-support. The First World Service Meeting was held in New York City, October 9-11, 1969 at the Roosevelt Hotel; the theme was "Our Common Welfare." Twenty-seven country delegates participated.

In October of this year, we will be welcoming over 39 delegates representing over 27 countries to New York for the 16th World Service Meeting. They will travel from as far as Australia, Belgium, Brazil, Colombia, Great Britain, Finland, Guatemala, Germany, Iceland, Ireland, Italy, Japan, Mexico, Netherlands, New Zealand, Norway, Poland, South Africa, Spain, Sweden and Switzerland and beyond. It will be another magical opportunity for delegates from around the world to join and share A.A. experience with each other so that ultimately the alcoholic stumbling in the dark finds a way out — whoever she or he is, near or far, in whatever language she or he speaks. The theme will be "A.A. — Our Future is Our Responsibility."

I would like to share a letter which our co-founder Bill W. wrote in October 1969 to the delegates of the First World Service Meeting:

Dear Delegates:

We of the General Services extend to you our warmest greetings. We share with you our hope that this first meeting of its kind will later be seen a turning point in A.A.'s world affairs, perhaps a truly historic event.

We shall try to get a clearer insight into the question of A.A.'s leadership for the future — how it might be more effectively developed than at present. Country by country we shall try to estimate the general service needs of today and tomorrow.

In short, we shall try to see more clearly what A.A.'s world responsibilities really are and how these can be better met — now and in the future. We wish to inaugurate an orderly and ever more effective evolution — not a damaging revolution.

To me these questions will always be crucial to the survival and

the unity of our world society. Every new generation of A.A.'s will have to face them. Nothing can be taken for granted. Constant vigilance, keen foresight, immense dedication, plus an abiding faith — these will be the requirements if we are to fulfill A.A.'s destiny.

On matters of this import, I speak with great feeling, since more than one-half of my A.A. life has been invested in the construction of A.A., its principles and its world services.

Certainly I am not the last word on A.A. I'm only one of the first ones. The future now belongs to you and to all those still to come. I am certain that you will merit God's grace.

*Ever devotedly,
Bill*

Eva Sanchez, G.S.O. staff

TRUSTING OUR FUTURE TO A.A. PRINCIPLES

Ray Stiver, Grapevine director, moderated the Thursday afternoon presentation/discussion session.

Unity: Our Common Welfare

"The unity of Alcoholics Anonymous is the most cherished quality our Society has. Our lives, the lives of all to come, depend squarely upon it. We stay whole, or A.A. dies. Without unity, the heart of A.A. would cease to beat; our world arteries would no longer carry the life-giving grace of God; His gift to us would be spent aimlessly. Back again in their caves, alcoholics would reproach us and say, 'What a great thing A.A. might have been!'" (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 129) Thus Bill Wilson opens his essays on our Twelve Traditions.

Notice that I did not say this was just the opening to Tradition One. For indeed, this first and foremost Tradition of unity permeates all of our other guiding principles: Why are A.A. leaders trusted servants? Why do our groups have only one requirement for membership, and why are they autonomous except in matters that effect A.A. as a whole? Unity. Why do we have but one primary purpose and no affiliations? Why are we fully self-supporting, and forever nonprofessional? Unity. Why do we have no opinion on outside issues? Why is our program based on attraction? And, why is anonymity the spiritual foundation of all our Traditions, ever reminding us to place principles before personalities? Yes, Unity.

Of course, this unity extends into our Concepts for World Service as well: "The final responsibility and the ultimate authority for A.A. world services should always reside in the collective conscience of our whole Fellowship." (*Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. 6) This Conference is that actual voice. Each level of service is endowed with traditional Rights of Decision, Participation and Appeal. Our Charter relies upon the force of tradition and the power of the A.A. purse for its final effectiveness.

And listen to the bell of unity as it rings throughout our General Warranties: "...in all its proceedings, the General Service Conference shall observe the spirit of the A.A. Tradition, taking great care that the Conference never becomes the seat of perilous wealth and power; that [no] Conference member shall ever be placed in a position of unqualified authority over any others; that all important decisions be reached by discussion, vote, and whenever possible, by substantial unanimity; that, though the Conference may act for the service of Alcoholics Anonymous, it shall never perform any acts of government; and that, like the Society of Alcoholics Anonymous which we serve, the Conference itself will always remain democratic in thought and action." (*ibid.*, p. 62)

Yes, unity is our common welfare; our most cherished quality; the saving grace that keeps our Fellowship whole. But does

this mean that we need all be the same; that we must always conform; that we can accept no diversity? Our literature is filled with compelling evidence to the contrary. In *A.A. Comes of Age*, Bill weaves for us the tale of our early years, how bickering over our differences nearly tore us apart. He records for us the long list of membership requirements sent in by early A.A. groups to our fledgling General Service Office. Indeed, we know that our Traditions are not a list of our accomplishments, but an inventory of our early mistakes, mistakes corrected by unity. But unity came with a price tag; a price tag named sacrifice.

Bill writes: "The group, in turn, found that it had to give up many of its own rights for the protection and welfare of each member, and for A.A. as a whole. These sacrifices had to be made or A.A. could not continue to exist. Out of these experiences and realizations, the Twelve Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous began to take shape and substance. Gradually we saw that the unity, the effectiveness, and even the survival of A.A. always would depend upon our continued willingness to give up our personal ambitions and desires for the common safety and welfare." (*A.A. Comes of Age*, p. 287) How many of us would still be alive if not for the sacrifice of our forefathers as they strove for our common welfare? I fear that most of us would be dead.

Those of you, whom I have had the privilege of serving with at the 49th General Service Conference, know firsthand how readily this body makes sacrifices to preserve our Legacy of Unity. From recommendations pertaining to support for our board's policy on discounts and subsidies, to the confidentiality of new stories in the Fourth Edition Big Book; from an updated "Time to Start Living" for our seniors, to a new pamphlet for African/American alcoholics. Each of these recommendations was discussed at great length, and each became Advisory Actions with votes of overwhelming unanimity. This body went into overtime dealing with floor actions on topics such as whether to include a diversity statement on vacancy letters for our most trusted servants. The votes of these floor actions were likewise, virtually unanimous. Then we voted to close the Conference even later, so we could still have our final sharing session. Unity.

But, like everything in our Fellowship, we claim progress rather than perfection. I was chilled to learn of a delegate chastised by his area last year, for acknowledging what was best for A.A. as a whole. I was likewise distressed to be surveyed about our Fellowship's continued need for literature deemed to be "special interest." Our tradition of unity has taught us time and again, whenever a need is demonstrated on behalf of any of our members, that need is in the acute interest of our society as a whole. I have every faith that we will continue making these crucial sacrifices whenever the need arises.

In 1955, after its five-year trial, this Conference was confirmed to be our Fellowship's permanent service structure. Yet even as Bill W. turned over the reins, he cautioned us to remember where we had come from. "We have had great problems, but they have always been resolved. Never has a grave issue cut across and scarred the face of this far-flung Fellowship. But, again, this is no earned virtue of ours. Too many of us in our drinking days have suffered the terrible penalties of proud and angry pursuits to forget them now. These very pains have been the beginning of whatever wisdom we have since incorporated in A.A.'s Twelve Traditions. Hence, I feel confident that these forces of destruction will never rule among us. We are prepared to pay the price of peace. We will make every personal sacrifice necessary to insure the unity of Alcoholics Anonymous." (*ibid.*, p. 234) That was 45 years ago and, my friends, what an incredible gift it is to be sober, alive, and here with all of you today.

Together this year, we celebrate the 65th anniversary of our beloved Fellowship, and its Legacy of Recovery. We commemo-

rate our 50th General Service Conference, and its now long Legacy of Service. And indeed, we are here today, Trusting our Future to A.A. Principles, still willing to pay the price of peace, as we carry together, our Legacy of Unity into this new millennium.

Jamie Rude, Connecticut

Unity: The Informed Group Conscience and Substantial Unanimity

I have a friend who says that A.A.'s Twelve Traditions are more important to a newcomer than A.A.'s Twelve Steps. She says, "What is the first thing a newcomer wants to know? Even before his first meeting? What does it cost to be a member and who can belong." She may have a point. The A.A. Traditions of "no dues or fees" and "anyone who wants to stay sober can belong" are usually the first principles of our Fellowship the newcomer learns. As the newcomer becomes less new, other A.A. principles are learned, such as honesty, sharing and self-support, which are embodied in A.A.'s Steps and Traditions.

Just as the newcomer grows to understand A.A. principles and, through applying those principles in his or her life, to rely on them, A.A. as a Fellowship has similarly grown. Anyone reading *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* can see that the Steps and Traditions are rooted in experience, not theory. They are a product of testing, failure and success. As a Fellowship, we have discovered what works and what doesn't. From this process, we have distilled principles to be used in solving whatever problems arise within the Fellowship. Among these principles, embodied in our Traditions and Concepts, are the principles of the informed group conscience and substantial unanimity which, as a Fellowship, A.A. trusts.

Future experience will challenge us in applying A.A.'s Traditions. In the interconnected world of the Internet, where will local autonomy end and begin? Does the concept of an A.A. group embrace a chat room? Can one have a sponsor one has never met? Where does the personal anonymity of our founders intersect with their place as historical figures? How does A.A. maintain the purity of its message when every person with a computer can print his version of a Big Book? A.A. struggles with these questions daily. All force new interpretations of A.A.'s Steps and Traditions.

In solving these and other problems yet unforeseen, A.A. is blessed. Unlike other organizations, contained within A.A.'s principles is, in addition to a set of spiritual concepts, a problem solving process. Concept XII guarantees all issues will be fully discussed and decisions will be reached with substantial unanimity. We have a Right of Appeal so the views of the minority are fully heard. Our Right of Participation insures participation in solving a problem by those persons most affected. We seek "democracy in thought and action." As ultimate authorities, A.A. has the "collective conscience of our whole Fellowship" and "a loving God as he may express Himself in our group conscience." This process of discussion, unanimity, participation, minority protection and divine guidance is as good a mechanism for problem-solving as could ever be devised. It provides a procedure which will resolve whatever challenges the future brings. Without preserving and enhancing this process, no individual problem will be successfully solved.

Having engaged in the process, what should A.A. members expect as a solution to their future problems? To most of these types of problems, there is no clear cut right or wrong answer. Last year the Conference P.I. Committee of which I was a member was assigned the task of deciding whether to recommend the public release of A.A.'s video of Bill W. telling his story. The A.A. principles of personal anonymity and cooperation with our



friends seemed to collide. My committee was closely divided about the merits of the decision to be made, ultimately voting not to release the video. However, everyone on the committee agreed that the decision was so significant in its application of A.A. principles that no single committee should resolve it. For the sake of unity within the Conference, the committee unanimously decided that the decision be brought before the whole Conference where, after much discussion, it was also decided not to release the video. After this process of thorough discussion, exchange of information, and respect for the minority view, a feeling of unity was achieved.

If the process is followed, unity is maintained. The solution A.A. chooses to any individual problem may in the future prove to have been either wise or foolish. However, if the A.A. decision-making process is followed — where the group is informed, all views are aired, democratic procedures are used and minority rights are respected, the outcome will be unity.

The future will require A.A. to apply its principles in new ways to issues yet un contemplated. However, so long as A.A. applies those procedures of problem-solving which it has been given in its Traditions and Concepts, its future is secure. If A.A. trusts its future to these principles, it will have a future.

Clayton Vandivort, Eastern Missouri

Unity: Practicing Genuine Humility Through Anonymity

My presentation topic, "Practicing Genuine Humility through Anonymity" is, in my opinion, the perfect definition of what Alcoholics Anonymous represents.

As an active alcoholic for 23 years I had a close relationship with humiliation and I consistently practiced genuine humiliation in every aspect of my life. I was not capable of accepting any responsibility in the disaster that had become my life. When I first came into Alcoholics Anonymous I was excessively judgmental and critical. I put all of you to the "Grace test." Some of you passed and some of you did not. My goal was to prove that you possessed "absolutely nothing" I wanted. I would become extremely agitated when you would tell me how good your life had become and that you owed it all to A.A. Some of you spoke

volumes without opening your mouths. These particular members were irresistible to me and, try as I might, I could not stop wanting what they appeared to have. As I watched and listened, it became apparent that they were completely at peace with themselves, with others and — it seemed — the whole world. I later learned that this weird state was called "serenity" and was a product of genuine humility. They had simply ceased to have conflict with any person, place or thing. They no longer played the big shot braggart and no longer craved to be the center of attention, and that was a completely alien concept to me. I, on the other hand, trapped by my ego, could only measure my worth by the yardstick of "better than" or "not good enough." If I did not let you know how truly gifted I was then I would just disappear, "the hole in the donut syndrome." Truly serene people transcend those petty attachments and are able to become conduits through which the Higher Power can be expressed.

Tradition Eleven tells us that anonymity "is more than a denial of self-seeking. This Tradition is a constant and practical reminder that personal ambition has no place in A.A. In it, each member becomes an active guardian of our Fellowship." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 183) Then in Tradition Twelve we read, "These experiences taught us that anonymity is real humility at work. It is an all-pervading spiritual quality which today keynotes A.A. life everywhere. Moved by the spirit of anonymity, we try to give up our natural desires for personal distinction as A.A. members both among fellow alcoholics and before the general public. As we lay aside these very human aspirations, we believe that each of us takes part in the weaving of a protective mantle which covers our whole Society and under which we may grow and work in unity. We are sure that humility, expressed by anonymity, is the greatest safeguard that Alcoholics Anonymous can ever have." (*ibid.*, p. 187)

Since "Anonymous" represents one-half of our name it only seems natural that anonymity itself becomes the vehicle for each and every member to practice genuine humility. "Humility" is an elusive quality and is the exact opposite of "arrogance." I have been told that if I have to point out to you how humble I am then I probably do not possess humility. Humility cannot be possessed; it is a gift bestowed on me by my Higher Power and is only present in my life to the degree that I am able to maintain my spiritual condition by asking for guidance and then listening

for the answer. Humility then also becomes a by-product of prayer and meditation. Humility cannot tolerate arrogance in any form — the two are just not compatible.

During the process of writing this presentation, I was constantly reminded in all my research and reading that the program of Alcoholics Anonymous is simple, but definitely not easy. That ego-reduction is paramount. I cannot base my recovery on old behaviors and belief systems. That humility is the goal and anonymity is the vehicle. These qualities are constant factors embodied within every principle of Alcoholics Anonymous. Genuine humility is an attractive, nourishing quality, and our Fellowship thrives on its divine influence. It is only present when we can align our will with our Higher Power's will for us. We demonstrate humility when we are willing to sacrifice our human tendency to be right and accept the authority that is recognized in A.A., that of "a loving God as He may express Himself through our group conscience." (*ibid.*, p. 132) When we willingly suspend disbelief and distrust of the process, then we become neutral and open to new information and change. Neutrality is the space where the seeds of our future are planted and nurtured. It is the space where we become teachable and resistance to change melts away. We are able to recognize that our decisions are more likely to be correct when many voices are heard, rather than one, and that great wisdom springs from the collective experience of our past. A.A. is an organic society that is always in the process of change. When we tend it and nourish it, it produces fruit year after year, but neglect can cause it to wither and die. Our Fellowship is growing up and maturing spiritually. I witness this everywhere I go, by the caliber of members who are serving our Fellowship. Our challenge is to continually create an atmosphere where spiritual growth can flourish. What I understand and believe to be true today is that the principles of Alcoholics Anonymous can be interpreted to support any and all points of view, but when we allow ourselves to be led by our Higher Power the right interpretation and solution will present itself. It is my belief that the God of our understanding will continually disclose exactly the right solutions for each challenge we encounter if we continue to "Trust Our Future to A.A. Principles." I am in the infancy stage of my own spiritual development and am reminded that "you" are my teachers and "I" am forever your student.

Grace Edwards, British Columbia/Yukon

TRUSTING OUR FUTURE TO A.A. PRINCIPLES

The Thursday evening presentation/discussion session was chaired by Carl Budd, West Central regional trustee.

Service: I Am Responsible...

When I came through the doors of Alcoholics Anonymous I had just turned 20 years old and already knew all that I needed to know about the "pitiful and incomprehensible demoralization" of alcoholism. My entire life was in shambles and I was almost completely without hope. I was at the place where many of us get to — I was more afraid to live than I was to die. The only good thing about that day is that A.A. was there.

You were there to teach me about the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions. You were there to give me direction and hope, just as you have done for countless alcoholics before and after me. And because of the incredible gifts you have given me, my life today is far beyond my fondest dreams.

Like most of us in A.A., I started in service by making coffee and cleaning ashtrays. I was taught to do those things because my sponsor and my home group saw it as their responsibility to

teach me correct principles from the beginning. I am here today because I scrubbed a floor 18 years ago.

My sponsor and my home group stressed service. They stressed gratitude in action. They taught me that to be of service I had to have something to give. And that once I had something to give, I had to give it.

So my first responsibility in A.A. was to learn about the Twelve Steps and the Twelve Traditions and to make them manifest in my life. I had to work each Step and let each Step work in me. I had to learn to live each Tradition and strive for its fulfillment in me and my home group. In the Twelve and Twelve, Step Twelve begins, "The joy of living is the theme of A.A.'s Twelfth Step, and action is its key word." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 106)

The remainder of my responsibility is action. Indeed, in A.A.'s Legacy of Service, Bill W. wrote, "Our Twelfth Step — carrying the message — is the basic service that the A.A. Fellowship gives; this is our principal aim and the main reason for our existence. Therefore, A.A. is more than a set of principles; it is a society of alcoholics in action. We must carry the message, else we ourselves can wither and those who haven't been given the truth may die." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. S1)

I am disappointed when people say that they don't have time when they are asked to make a Twelfth Step call. I am saddened when a G.S.R. says that district meetings are just politics and they don't want to go. I am frightened when someone tells me that they have done enough and that someone else should do it. Can you imagine what would have happened if Bill W. would have said that after his first meeting with Dr. Bob?

Many of us like to sit around and discuss the way things used to be. We ask why and when did they change? Who is responsible? Someone will usually blame treatment centers. Someone else may say that "high bottom drunks" are to blame. Still another may claim that it's computers or the age of technology.

There may be a grain of truth in some of that. But I say that "I am responsible." In giving us the Conference Plan, our co-founders gave us the greatest bequest of all. They bequeathed to us a tradition of love and service. They bequeathed to us a legacy of selfless devotion. They bequeathed to us the responsibility for our future. So the responsibility is ours — yours and mine.

It is my responsibility to say "yes" when asked. It is my responsibility to teach other members about the Twelve Steps, the Twelve Traditions, and the Twelve Concepts. It is my responsibility to help others learn about our Three Legacies. It is my responsibility to help others succeed in their service commitments.

If I have learned anything during my time in this great Fellowship, I have learned two things. I have learned that, as a sober member of Alcoholics Anonymous, I am a servant and a teacher. In the Third Step Prayer, I asked God to "Relieve me of the bondage of self, that I may better do Thy will." (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 63) This is service. This is my responsibility to my own development, to you, and to Him. And it is these principles that are my responsibility to pass on to other members, newcomers or oldtimers. Tradition One teaches that "Each member of Alcoholics Anonymous is but a small part of a great whole. A.A. must continue to live or most of us will surely die. Hence our common welfare comes first. But individual welfare follows close afterward." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* — Long Form, p. 189)

This is the great dichotomy of Alcoholics Anonymous — that to serve you, I save me. That to abandon myself to these simple principles, I may have another day. No longer is my life the shambles that it was when I first met you. No longer am I afraid to live. No longer am I nothing but a two-bit, drunken, punk kid. And if I have nothing else, I have hope. Each day of my life today is better than the one before. What an enormous blessing you have been in my life. You have been a blessing for me and for my fam-

ily and loved ones. You have been a blessing for my employer and my community. And because you are such a blessing to me, and because my gratitude for you is immense, I have no choice but to seek to serve you in any way I can. Each day I rededicate myself to the principles of Alcoholics Anonymous. To the Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service. For this I am responsible.

Ken Gusner, Southern Wisconsin

Service: Our Primary Purpose

When I received the invitation from Susan to share on this subject, I felt very important; then my brain began to shrink and I went blank completely. I did not know what to write. I asked my sponsor, and he suggested writing my experience, strength and hope, and using some parts of the literature.

When I sobered up in 1982 our group had service positions within the group, but not a G.S.R.; plus, I was not interested in any service position. I read the Steps and looked at the Traditions — nothing happened.

When I was sober (dry) for about two years I began to feel miserable, fearful, guilty. I was on a dry bender. Other members in my group suggested that if I worked the Steps I would feel better. A few days after that I asked my sponsor to show me how to do the Steps — especially Step Four. When I finished the Fourth Step (my inventory) I called my sponsor and told him I was ready to do Step Five. When we finished he sent me home to do Steps Six and Seven. I felt something happened that day. To me, the room was clear and I felt clean; that day I became a true member of Alcoholics Anonymous. I started making my amends. Something happened to my group. They elected me G.S.R. and it was the beginning of my group and me getting involved in our service structure.

It took me a long time, at least a year and a half, to learn the Traditions, and another three years to learn about the Concepts for World Service. I served as G.S.R. for three years, alternate D.C.M. for two years, D.C.M. for two years. Then I served two years each as Northeast Texas Treatment Facility chair, area treasurer, alternate delegate, and am currently delegate for the Northeast Texas Area.

I also learned that all these principles that we have in place — the Steps, the Traditions and the Concepts — were here before I sobered up, and it is my responsibility, as well as the responsibility of every A.A. member, to keep them the way they are. Anything we do in service, from the group all the way up to the Conference, as well as at the General Service Office, concerns our Fifth Tradition: Our primary purpose is to carry its message to the alcoholic who still suffers.

Today I can say to you that service is part of my life and it is my responsibility to pass it on to others. Today I know what principles are, and I try to put these principles before personalities at all times.

My personal ambitions, my selfishness and self-centeredness do not belong in Alcoholics Anonymous. I hope that throughout this Conference we keep in mind what is best for *all* A.A.s. I want A.A. to stay as it is — for my children, your children, and anybody who wants this program. This we owe to A.A.'s future; To place our common welfare first; To keep our fellowship united. For on A.A. unity depends our lives, and the lives of those to come.

Luis Pineda, Northeast Texas

Service: The Spirit of Rotation

I was briefly honored, briefly terrified, as I read and reread the invitation to make a presentation on the Spirit of Rotation at the

50th General Service Conference. I had nothing to say. The news of the day is one of my compulsions. I've been pondering the daily discourse that certain inherent genetic weaknesses might be identified and eliminated; that quite possibly diseases such as alcoholism could be eliminated. I lay awake weighing whether increased tolerance would be a desirable trait. That old elusive notion of "a cure" looms once again around the corner, threatening to render the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous a quaint leftover of the twentieth century.

We are told that death itself might become elective not so long from now. Yet, here we are today, considering Service: The Spirit of Rotation, when the very need for such a Fellowship in the future is questionable, if we buy the hype. In the sixties, I was a peace-marching flower child, so I have had some experience with ludicrous movements. A group of formerly cutting-edge alcoholics, now sober, collected in New York City, excited over spiritual matters, working together, even arguing over the best ways to be selflessly helpful, seems equally ludicrous in May 2000. Those of us gathered here today, however, profess to live in a different realm. We are not subject to waiting for miracles that may or may not materialize. Our miracle lies in the reality of here and now, in the actions of our group conscience, where we do together what we cannot do for ourselves. Our theme at this 50th General Service Conference, "Trusting Our Future to A.A. Principles," gets its life-force from the boundless supply of fertile earth we are rooted in, guaranteed to us by the principle of rotation, the tilling of the soil, which keeps us fresh and vigorous.

The days of the 49th General Service Conference seem like only yesterday; the Panel 48 delegates surrounded the new delegates, intent that we heard and saw everything, inside and outside the Conference room. They seemed to savor and wanted to share every second, sight and sound, and yet they were uniformly happy to be going home, to have their legacy come to an end. I could not understand this disparity and frankly didn't buy it. I had expected to see the 48s distance themselves from us, having been at "the mountain-top" longer; I heard several announce intentions of becoming a trustee, and anticipated more campaigning than I could find. I was not the only cynic present. We found each other watching everyone; it was a relief to find others showing the strain of that characteristic intensity based in fear. Our greatest discovery was that, in spite of our obvious differences in sobriety, experience and background, our thoughts and perceptions were nearly identical. We relaxed, and became friends. In *A.A. Comes of Age*, Bill describes the first Conference: "On their first day, the delegates inspected our Headquarters, got acquainted with the service staff, and shook hands with the Trustees. In the evening there was a briefing session under the name, 'What's on your mind?'"... Seeing their quick understanding and confidence, our spirits rose. We all sensed that something momentous was happening; that this was a historic moment." (*A.A. Comes of Age*, pp. 217-218) So it seems, that our experience was not unique. Last year we came with the same apprehension that filled alcoholics at the first Conference, and we left knowing we had witnessed a historic moment. This year that same apprehension has already been replaced with the sense that something momentous is happening.

I was born on a farm, and love to grow roses as much as I love to smell them. Serenity is always found in the dirt of my garden, and the tougher the clay, the more pleasure I take from the effort. As a delegate, I had to work to find time for such serenity this past year. The smiling faces of the G.S.O. staff were often with me there, and I often marveled at their continued graciousness, having come to appreciate the amount of dedication and effort they bring to their work. I read the correspondence as rotation took place in the fall, wondered how they could maintain that joyful

spirit and efficiency in the middle of transition. I thought back to some of my own transitions in service, and remembered the magic that happens when we agree to make a change in this Fellowship. The two-year transition has been the most questioned aspect of my involvement in service by family and friends. The world outside would find our rotations disruptive and impractical, but we have learned that freedom from ourselves is based in making new beginnings. I know today that the genuine happiness in the voices of our staff members on the phone and in their correspondence comes from living in the midst of many new beginnings.

In the Conference Charter, it states "In all its proceedings, the General Service Conference shall observe the spirit of A.A. Tradition....that none of the Conference members shall ever be placed in a position of unqualified authority over any of the others...and that, like the Society of Alcoholics Anonymous which it serves, the Conference itself will always remain democratic in thought and action." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, pp. s87-s88)

As accounted in *A.A. Comes of Age* (p. 230), the 5th Conference in St. Louis approved this resolution, authorizing the Conference to act for the Fellowship. Bill's words as they completed the action included his comparison to a parental relationship. "... 'Here is our experience together in this family. This is your inheritance. This is for you to multiply or squander. Take it. Go out and meet life. We'll stand by. We'll help when the going is tough. But now you are on your own. We can no longer decide for you, act for you, protect you. We can only love you with all our hearts. The rest is up to God and yourself.' When parents fail to do this, the seeds of misery are almost inevitably sown."

Remember these words as you leave this Conference, Panel 50. That this Conference or another in the future might make a mistake will not effect the future of Alcoholics Anonymous. That we resist change, that we attempt to hang on to positions, that we unduly exert our influence on those newly elected, sows the seeds of misery and threatens our very lives. Bill ended with an expression of gratitude to God "who...has allowed us to construct this wonderful edifice of the Spirit in which we are now dwelling. And now eager hearts and hands have lifted the spire of our cathedral into its place. That spire bears the name of Service. May it ever point straight upward toward God." (*ibid.*, p. 234) Our future is likely because we continue to agree that the spire bears the name of Service and not the names of past delegates, trustees, and staff.

The future of Alcoholics Anonymous in this millennium begins with the rotation of Panel 49. The names of some trustees will change, the staff will rotate in 2001; the single constant remaining will be the structure that lives in the spirit between us in this room today. We have all watched the miracle of a suffering alcoholic come to happy sobriety repeatedly, and have been strengthened every time the effort was made to help another. It is doubtful that genetic manipulation can touch what occurs in Alcoholics Anonymous. We are about to seed a new crop in great soil, and are entrusting the results to our God. It is exciting to be here, equally exciting to go home, report and serve. Recently, I remarked to a friend that I couldn't wait for this year to end so I could be in A.A., too. As usual, it seems another alcoholic said it first, said it better. Bill remarked that Sunday afternoon in 1955: "Back in 1948, we were thinking of this. Dr. Bob and I once wrote a joint piece in the Grapevine asking, 'why can't we join A.A., too?' Well, this is the day when we do join A.A." (*ibid.*, p. 230) Panel 49 delegates will soon resume their old seats in A.A. meetings, trusting your direction because we know how you are directed. A.A. remains secure with you. May your service be blessed.

Laura Hummel, Southeast Michigan

FAREWELL TALK

Longtime G.S.O. staff member Lois Fisher, who will retire in the Fall, shared some thoughts Friday afternoon, prior to the closing of the Conference.

This is my twenty-third and final General Service Conference and I am honored by the invitation to share some thoughts with you as the 50th Conference comes to a close. I find it reassuring that the theme is "Trusting Our Future to A.A. Principles" — especially appropriate since this year marks the 50th anniversary of the adoption of our Twelve Traditions.

Although my sobriety date is October 18, 1972, I joined A.A. in San Francisco in December 1970. Bill Wilson died the following month on January 24th, and I can recall the profound sadness in meetings when his death was announced. As a self-centered newcomer at the time, his death did not have much effect on me personally. However, I am grateful that when I came to G.S.O. seven years later, Bob Hitchins, the general manager, and several members of the staff had worked with Bill. Dennis Manders, whom you met earlier this week, and Nell Wing, Bill's long time secretary and our first archivist, were still there. Dr. Jack Norris was chairman of the General Service Board and Milton Maxwell, Michael Alexander, Jim Estelle and other giants in our Fellowship's history were serving as trustees. Today I cherish that link to the past.

Fast tracking to the present, I've given this talk many times in the wee small hours of the morning. In those early hours, I found myself thinking about our Fellowship in the years to come and cannot resist this opportunity to share some of my own thoughts and concerns regarding A.A.'s future.

I remember asking Bob Hitchins, the general manager when I joined the staff in 1977, his thoughts about what might lie ahead for our Fellowship. He expressed concern about rigidity. In his farewell talk to the 1986 Conference, past general manager Bob Pearson described growing rigidity — the increasing demand for absolute answers to nit-picking questions — as the greatest danger facing A.A. Certainly we cling to our principles as encapsulated in our Twelve Traditions, Concepts and Warranties. But I question whether we aren't practicing a misguided sense of self-righteousness when we deny writers and historians pictures of our co-founders, although we sell books that contain pictures of them and distribute a 1979 Conference-approved video produced specifically for television and the general public which contains pictures of the co-founders. I wonder if we are driving alcoholics away from our life-saving Fellowship as we make an issue about how a newcomer identifies himself at a meeting or whether a member of a group should celebrate an anniversary of sobriety because he or she is on antidepressant medication. One might wonder how Bill would react to the increasing demand on G.S.O. to "enforce" our Traditions. Those who knew him say that Bill was open, tolerant and permissive and that one of his favorite sayings was, "Every group has a right to be wrong." He had absolute faith that faults in A.A. were self-correcting.

The proposed Fourth Edition Big Book also comes to mind as I think of our Fellowship's future. In my years at G.S.O., we have received countless letters and calls from both women and men expressing concern about the sexist language in the Big Book. Those who knew him say that Bill was inclusive and had no intention of offending women or anyone else; the book was published in 1939 and the language reflects that time. Because of Bill's very important role in our history, as well as for sentimental reasons, the Fellowship understandably is quite reluctant to change a word of his writing. Nevertheless, I find myself hoping that the

Foreword to the Fourth Edition might include an explanation of this — not as an apology for Bill's words, for none is needed — but simply to convey the reasons we have for not changing the original text. This might make the text more engaging to people coming to the Fellowship today who find themselves alienated by the chapter "To Wives," the constant use of the masculine pronoun and statements such as, "We are like men who have lost their legs...."

Then there is our literature for so-called "special" populations. Since I was attracted to three "special interest" pieces of literature as a newcomer, I readily admit a bias in that direction. At age 33 I thought I might be too young to be an alcoholic so I read "Young People and A.A." and my third night in the Fellowship attended the San Francisco Young People's Group. I also read "A.A. for the Woman" and "Letter to a Woman Alcoholic" with great interest. I am sure that I would have joined A.A. without these pamphlets, but they addressed concerns I had as a young woman and made me feel both welcome and included. Some members believe that meetings and literature for specific populations are divisive and affect A.A. unity. I see them as effective ways of carrying the A.A. message and evidence of the diverse and inclusive membership within our Fellowship.

So much for my concerns. Sharing them now is part of my "letting go" process. I know that through a loving and well-informed group conscience, our Fellowship will find its way in resolving these and other important issues.

Today my faith in our program and our Fellowship is stronger than ever. Twenty years ago, then retired general manager Bob Hitchins spoke at our Friday morning A.A. meeting for his 40th A.A. anniversary. (Bob sobered up in 1940, and was manager at the time of Bill's death and for six years thereafter.)

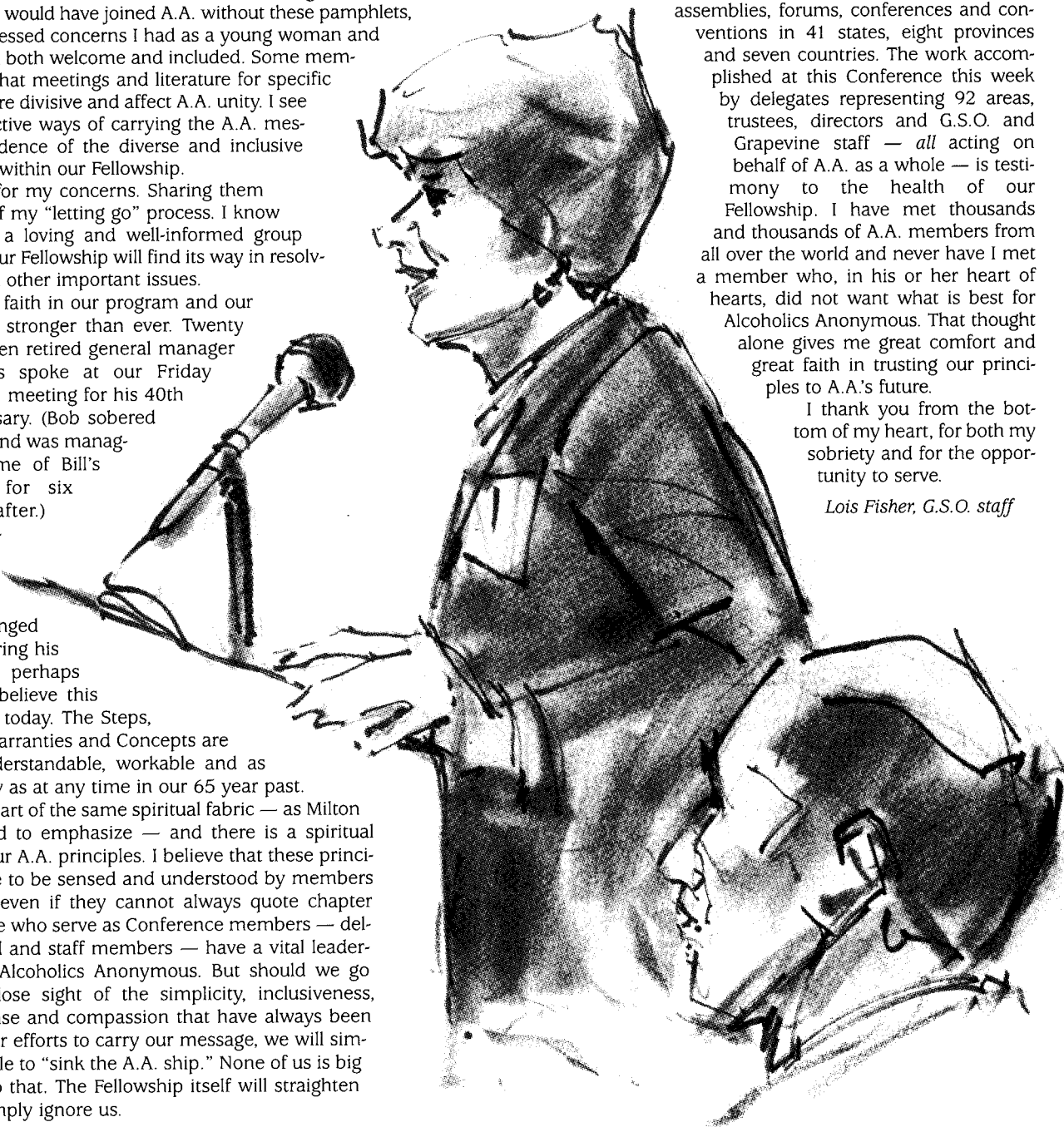
On that occasion he said that he felt that A.A. had changed very little during his 40 years — perhaps not at all. I believe this remains true today. The Steps, Traditions, Warranties and Concepts are as valid, understandable, workable and as needed today as at any time in our 65 year past. They are all part of the same spiritual fabric — as Milton Maxwell used to emphasize — and there is a spiritual unity in all our A.A. principles. I believe that these principles continue to be sensed and understood by members and groups, even if they cannot always quote chapter and verse. We who serve as Conference members — delegates, board and staff members — have a vital leadership role in Alcoholics Anonymous. But should we go astray, and lose sight of the simplicity, inclusiveness, common sense and compassion that have always been present in our efforts to carry our message, we will simply not be able to "sink the A.A. ship." None of us is big enough to do that. The Fellowship itself will straighten us out, or simply ignore us.

My 23 years at G.S.O. have been a wonderful trip and I am grateful beyond words. I literally claim friends in every state and province in North America, as well as many countries. On a very personal note, I want to express my love and gratitude for my friends and colleagues at G.S.O. From my first contact with staff member Cora Louise Belford (now retired in Mississippi) who, as staff coordinator, trained me and served as my mentor, to our "new guy," Rick Walker from Minneapolis, working with the wonderful G.S.O. staff members has been a unique privilege that I will cherish the rest of my life. And I've also loved working with our dedicated non-A.A. employees — a great group who take pride in serving Alcoholics Anonymous.

Since 1977, I have been privileged to serve with over 1000 delegates, almost 150 trustees and about 40 non-trustee directors. I have attended meetings, assemblies, forums, conferences and conventions in 41 states, eight provinces and seven countries. The work accomplished at this Conference this week by delegates representing 92 areas, trustees, directors and G.S.O. and Grapevine staff — *all* acting on behalf of A.A. as a whole — is testimony to the health of our Fellowship. I have met thousands and thousands of A.A. members from all over the world and never have I met a member who, in his or her heart of hearts, did not want what is best for Alcoholics Anonymous. That thought alone gives me great comfort and great faith in trusting our principles to A.A.'s future.

I thank you from the bottom of my heart, for both my sobriety and for the opportunity to serve.

Lois Fisher, G.S.O. staff



Reports from the General Service Board, Trustees' Committees and G.S.O.

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Trustees' report: The year 2000 is an important one for our board because we are celebrating three events: this 50th General Service Conference, our International Convention in Minneapolis in June, and the 16th World Service Meeting in New York, in October. While the business of this Conference is much like those of the past, it is worth noting that we have been hearing the actual voice and the effective conscience for our whole Society for half a century. Our International Convention will allow us to celebrate and show our gratitude for sixty-five years of the existence on earth of the A.A. message. At the World Service Meeting, delegates from around the world will once again share their experience, strength, and hope in carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics everywhere.

Wednesday morning, on behalf of the trustees' Literature Committee, Garry McAuley will report on progress of the proposed Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*. A subcommittee of the trustees' Literature Committee continues to work on this project, initiated by the 47th General Service Conference, always keeping in mind the Conference Advisory Action that "The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, 'The Doctor's Opinion,' 'Dr. Bob's Nightmare,' and the Appendices remain as is." The trustees' and Conference Literature Committees have established close communication so members of the Conference Committee are informed about this important project. I want to thank the past and current members who have served on the Fourth Edition Subcommittee for what has proven to be very hard work. Current subcommittee members are Garry McAuley, Jim Clough, Marne Hill, Beth Rabren, David Every, John Koster, Lois Fisher and Vinnie McCarthy.

Wednesday evening, we will hear a presentation on "A.A. Around the World" explaining some of the marvelous Twelfth Step work abroad. The World Service Meeting takes place every other year. In the years when there is no World Service Meeting, many countries join in zonal meetings. Since the last Conference, our trustees and staff participated in two zonal meetings: the Tenth European Service Meeting, and the Eleventh Meeting of the Americas (REDELA). We also expect to be represented at the Fourth Asia-Oceania Service Meeting in South Korea next spring.

In addition to participating in World Service Meetings and zonal meetings, we find other ways to share our service experience with other countries and, equally important, we ask them to share their experience with us. Two months ago, Greg Muth and Eva Sanchez traveled to Johannesburg, South Africa, where they met with representatives from the boards of Great Britain and South Africa to look for ways that we can cooperate to carry the A.A. message into other countries in the vast African continent. We continue to share with the G.S.O. in Paris about helping A.A. in French-speaking Africa. Millions of alcoholics in Africa have never had an opportunity to hear about A.A. They do not even know that there is a way to stop drinking. We hope that the time is near when we will

see A.A. take hold and grow in Africa, as it did in Eastern Europe over the last fifteen years.

Trustees and staff responded to requests from A.A. in other countries that led to visits to Cuba, El Salvador, Guatemala, Honduras, Peru, the Dominican Republic, Mexico, Finland, Germany, Hungary, Poland, and Russia. Each trip report conveyed the deep gratitude that we experience when the A.A. message reaches a newcomer in another corner of the world.

In addition to personal visits and correspondence, one of the primary ways the A.A. message is carried beyond our borders is through translations of A.A. Conference-approved literature, most often the Big Book. Last year, G.S.O. continued to translate A.A. literature into other languages and help other countries print these books. For example, we published *Alcoholics Anonymous* and in Croatian and Greek, the latter with the help of the G.S.O. in Great Britain; plus the Twelve and Twelve in both Greek and Czech, and *Living Sober* in Romanian.

We are currently working on translations of *Alcoholics Anonymous* in Romanian and the Twelve and Twelve in Slovenian. We covered the printing costs for *Alcoholics Anonymous* and the Twelve and Twelve in Benisaya, a language spoken by 16 million people in the Philippines. We also are working with the G.S.O. in India to translate A.A. literature into Punjabi and other languages. The Punjabi book will have readers besides those in India; there happens to be a large community of Punjabi speakers in Western Canada. The Big Book has now been translated into 40 languages. It is fundamentally important for alcoholics to read the Big Book in words that come as close in spirit as possible to the original 1939 English version, whatever language it is translated into. For that reason, and to support unity and help provide the funds G.S.O. needs to serve A.A. groups, A.A.W.S. has continued Bill W's practice of registering copyrights on A.A. literature and asking alcoholics in every country to unify around one G.S.O.

In 1997 the trustees of the General Service Board voted unanimously to endorse the resolution of the A.A.W.S. Board to preserve and protect the copyrights held in trust for all of A.A. around the world, including taking legal action, if necessary. As I reported to you last year, legal action in fact became necessary to protect our copyrights from a persistent infringer in Germany. Recently the German courts ruled that A.A.W.S.'s copyrights were valid and that they had been infringed.

Given the nature of legal proceedings, I hesitate to guess at a date when this matter will be entirely behind us.

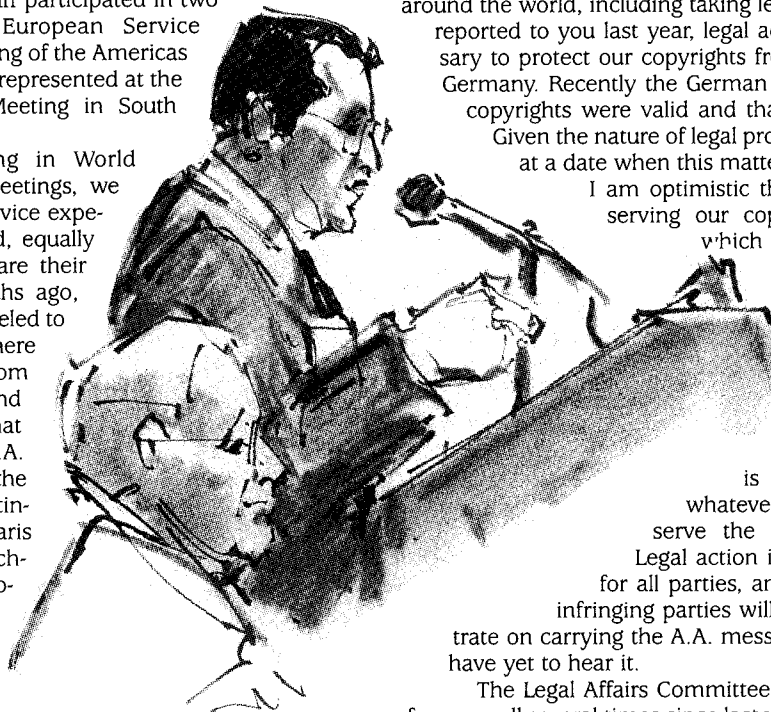
I am optimistic that we will succeed in preserving our copyrights on the Big Book, which are valid outside of the United States, as well as our copyrights on the rest of our literature, which are valid everywhere.

A.A.W.S., with the support of the General Service Board,

is firm in its resolve to take whatever action is necessary to preserve the integrity of our literature.

Legal action is distasteful and distracting for all parties, and I hope and pray that the infringing parties will stop so we can all concentrate on carrying the A.A. message to those alcoholics who have yet to hear it.

The Legal Affairs Committee met in person and by conference call several times since last year's Conference. This committee has oversight of A.A.W.S.'s legal actions to protect copy-



rights and also reviews other legal matters affecting G.S.O. I thank the committee for taking on this additional responsibility. The members are Linda Chezern, Dean Rinehart, and Richard Roughton. The committee meets with our general manager, Greg Muth, our general counsel and past board chairman, Michael Alexander, the chairman of A.A.W.S., Jack Ostrem, and me. We often seek experience from Vinnie McCarthy, who is a consultant to the committee. Dean and Michael are lawyers, and Linda is a judge, and we are able to use their expertise to help evaluate the advice of outside counsel.

With the growth of the Internet, we have occasionally found that A.A. copyrighted literature was being posted on some web sites without permission. I'm happy to report that most of those domain and web site owners have responded positively to our requests by removing A.A. Conference-approved literature posted to their sites.

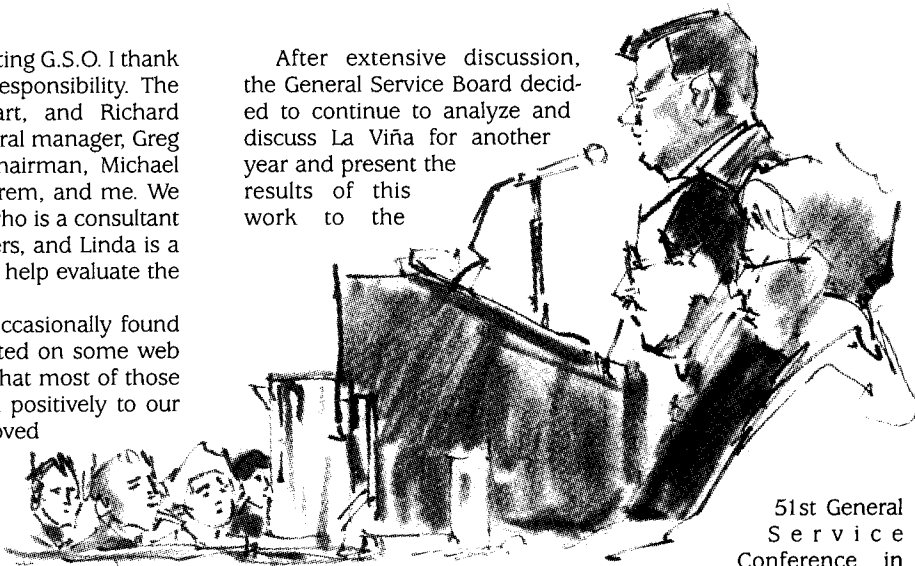
Recently we have received complaints from long-standing A.A. intergroups who have found themselves displaced from telephone directory listings by an organization that tries to get people seeking Twelfth Step calls to go into treatment. After we told this organization of the potential these actions had to confuse individuals seeking Alcoholics Anonymous, they agreed to discontinue using the A.A. name in their phone directory listings.

In November, we welcomed a new addition to the G.S.O. staff, Rick Walker. Rick came to us from the Intergroup Association of Minneapolis and Suburban Area, where he served as office manager. He is currently serving on the Treatment Facilities and Loners desk. Rick joined us following the retirement of Richard Bush, who served us well for eleven years. Richard completed his tour of duty at G.S.O. on the International assignment, where he served as our emissary to other countries. He leaves us with a well-used passport and friends around the world.

A number of Spanish-speaking A.A. groups in the U.S. have expressed some dissatisfaction with our current Spanish translation of the Big Book and other literature. Interested delegates, trustees, and staff met before last year's Conference and will do so again this year. We have received sharing on this topic by phone, letters, and at Regional Forums. We are working with Spanish-speaking districts and groups to get a better understanding of the many questions that arise in addressing their dissatisfaction. The very good news about these questions is that Spanish-speaking A.A.s are now in a position to communicate easily with G.S.O. Past trustees, staff, and delegates dreamed of the day when Spanish-speaking A.A.s would be full participants in General Service. That day has arrived.

The General Service Board looked hard at La Viña last year. La Viña was approved in concept by the 1995 General Service Conference, subject to approval of a business plan by the trustees' Finance Committee. That Conference approved the use of the General Service Board's Reserve Fund to finance La Viña for up to five years. The first issue was published in 1996. The original business plan proved to be too optimistic, and La Viña continues to lose money despite considerable work by the Grapevine's management and board to control costs and increase circulation. As you heard at the Conference last year, La Viña has been well received and has proved to be especially helpful in corrections work. At the General Service Board's executive session in January, our treasurer, Art Knight, showed the board several alternative ten-year projections of combined G.S.O. and Grapevine income and losses, illustrating the extent to which La Viña losses might affect our overall finances. The Grapevine board provided us with projections showing losses of around \$70,000 per year for the foreseeable future.

After extensive discussion, the General Service Board decided to continue to analyze and discuss La Viña for another year and present the results of this work to the



51st General Service Conference in 2001, which would

be five years after the first issue was published. The sense of the board is that, while we cannot speak for next year's board, we would favor continuing La Viña because of its role in carrying the message to Spanish-speaking alcoholics and its effect on A.A. unity. We welcome the views of the Conference as we go about this work.

The Grapevine's circulation has continued to decline, which has resulted in losses for the past six years. The Grapevine's management and board are looking at ways of reducing the cost of carrying out the business functions of the Grapevine. We hope the finances of the Grapevine can be improved by changing its business operations while keeping both editorial and product quality at their customary high levels of excellence.

G.S.O. finances continue to be excellent. Last year's income of \$907,600 was inflated by a number of nonrecurring items and should not be considered a starting point for projecting future results. Nonetheless, we find ourselves able to finance important archives and computer network projects without hurting the Reserve Fund. Our principle of corporate poverty tells us we should spend money only when it is essential to carrying out our work, and both the archives and network projects fall into that category. Our task in archives is to rescue a large number of precious audio tapes of our pioneers before they are lost forever to decay. The new computer network will replace an obsolete system that is making it difficult for us to communicate with each other and with the Fellowship we serve. I urge you to read more about these two projects in the A.A.W.S. corporate report, and those of the trustees' Archives and the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committees.

Gary Glynn, chairman

ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.

Directors' report: Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.) is a New York not-for-profit corporation. The trustees of the General Service Board are the members of A.A.W.S. and elect the A.A.W.S. directors, who are responsible for oversight of the General Service Office (G.S.O.), which provides group services, including printing and distribution of Conference-approved and service literature. The A.A.W.S. Board met seven times since the last Conference to receive G.S.O. management and staff reports, review group services activity and progress on implementation of Conference and board recommendations, review financial reports, price new or revised publications, review pub-

lishing operations and matters of G.S.O. administration, consider requests from A.A. members and non-A.A.s for permission to reprint A.A.-copyrighted literature, and to address other matters as they arose.

There are nine A.A.W.S. directors. Currently, four are trustees, including two general service trustees and two regional trustees, three nontrustee directors; the G.S.O. general manager and the staff coordinator also serve as directors. Also attending board meetings, but not voting, are the services director, G.S.O. staff members, the controller, publications director, information services manager, human resources director, archivist, board secretary, and a Grapevine staff member. The board welcomed guests, trustees, appointed members of trustees' committees, delegates and other A.A. members to its meetings during the year.

The committees of the A.A.W.S. Board are: Services, which considers the needs of all service assignments; Publishing, which reviews reprints, foreign literature and publications matters; Finance, which oversees salary and budget, audit review, and retirement; and Nominating. Long-range planning is done within each committee and by the board as a whole.

Since the last Conference, A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. staff participated in the following Regional and Special Forums: Northeast Regional Forum, Altoona, Pennsylvania, June 11-13; West Central Regional Forum, Sheridan, Wyoming, September 10-12; East Central Regional Forum, Ann Arbor, Michigan, September 24-26; Southwest Regional Forum, Lubbock, Texas, December 3-5; and Western Canada Regional Forum, Richmond, BC, Canada, February 18-20. A Special Forum was held in San Juan, Puerto Rico, August 21-22; and another Special Forum was held October 9 on the Navajo Reservation in Window Rock, Arizona. Four areas—Arizona, Colorado, New Mexico and Utah—helped organize the Window Rock Special Forum.

New Groups — During 1999, 1,965 new groups were registered with G.S.O., compared to 2,184 in 1998. A subcommittee of the board is working on ways to improve communications with groups regarding the registration process.

Year 2000 (Y2K) Project — Due to the work of Information Services manager Lillianna Murphy and her staff, the office computer systems were totally Y2K-compliant well before year-end 1999. G.S.O.'s Information Technology crew worked on December 31, and again, on January 2, to ensure that all systems were operational before the office reopened for business on January 3, 2000.

G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site — The board endorsed a plan to broaden the information on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site. Additional literature will be posted to provide material in addition to Public Information data. In 1999, the office experienced a marked increase in visits to its Web site, totaling approximately 730,000 for the year, compared to 400,000 visits in 1998. The 1999 figures reflected an average of 2,000 "hits" per day.

List of Newsletters — A letter was sent to delegates and intergroup/central office managers in the U.S./Canada about our "List of Newsletters in the Fellowship" service piece. This communication—in English, French and Spanish—generated good response and helped us to expand the list and update our information about area, district and intergroup/central office newsletters.

Intergroup Seminar — The 14th Annual Intergroup/Central Office/A.A.W.S. Seminar was held in Bradenton, Florida, October 14-17, with representatives from more than 100 offices attending.

Visitors to G.S.O. — G.S.O. welcomed 1,097 visitors during 1999. We enjoyed visits with trusted servants from service structures in other countries: Jacinto Roque Diaz, trustee, Board of the Dominican Republic, July 30 meeting; Peter Balo, general manager, Hungarian Central Service Office, Budapest, October 28

meeting; Alfredo Hernandez, Class B (alcoholic) trustee, General Service Board of Colombia, October 28 meeting.

Tenth European Service Meeting — Eva Sanchez attended the Tenth European Service Meeting in Frankfurt, Germany, October 22-24. Twenty countries were represented at the meeting. Eva also visited the Munich G.S.O. and met with two members of the General Service Board, October 25-26.

International — At the invitation of the Hungarian Central Service Office, Greg Muth attended Hungary's Fifth Annual National Meeting, July 3-4, as well as a meeting with board members and staff. Greg's travels during June 27-July 6 also included a stop-over at the German General Service Office in Munich. Greg visited the General Service Board in Helsinki, Finland, August 10-11. He also met with Finnish members who had separated from the A.A. structure. Greg continued on to Moscow, Russia, August 12-16, where he met with the Russian General Service Board and participated in the Twelfth Anniversary celebration of the Moscow Beginners Group. Richard Bush was present for the 25th Anniversary of A.A. in Poland, in Poznan, August 20-22. Approximately 2,000 A.A. members from a dozen countries were present.

Greg and Eva traveled to Johannesburg, South Africa, February 8-14, to meet with members of the board of South Africa and representatives of the General Service Board of Great Britain for discussions on ways to carry our message to countries in the sub-Saharan region of that vast continent, and to work toward a future "zonal" meeting in Africa.

Eva Sanchez and Danny Mooney traveled to El Salvador, where trustees Alex Palmer and Dean Rinehart served as delegates to the XI Meeting of the Americas (REDELA) in San Salvador, October 8-12. Eva also visited the G.S.O. in Guatemala City, October 14.

During November 3-8, Greg Muth, Dean Rinehart and Danny Mooney attended the VII Mexico Convention in Mazatlan, and also visited the G.S.O. in Mexico City. Eva Sanchez traveled to Cuba, January 21-23, for the Seventh Anniversary of A.A. in Cuba. She gave two presentations and also sat in on a meeting of Cuba's General Service Board and visited the G.S.O. in Havana.

Sixteenth World Service Meeting — Preparations continue for the Sixteenth World Service Meeting, to be held in New York, October 22-26, 2000. Adrienne Brown, Doug Richardson and Susan Ulseth will serve as secretaries for the World Service Meeting committees.

2000 International Convention — The board received regular updates on preparations for the 2000 International Convention, to be held in Minneapolis, Minnesota, June 29-July 2, 2000. The board approved a request that several A.A. Conference-approved books be available for sale at the International Convention, including English, French and Spanish-language versions of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, *A.A. Comes of Age*, and *As Bill Sees It*. The recommendation was forwarded to the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums.

Financial Results for 1999 — Gross sales of \$9,419,300, were approximately \$424,200 (4.7%) greater than budgeted, and \$212,300 (2.3%) greater than in 1998 (which did not include SMAA). Contributions of \$4,242,000 were \$142,000 (3.5%) greater than budgeted and \$203,000 (5%) greater than in 1998; total expenses of \$8,517,000 were approximately \$163,500 under budget; and net income for 1999 was \$866,300, \$689,700 over budget.

2000 Budget — Through its Finance Committee, the board prepared, reviewed and recommended G.S.O.'s 2000 budget to the trustees' Finance Committee. The budget projects

\$9,236,500 in sales, \$4,991,500 in gross profit, \$4,332,000 in contributions, and \$9,327,000 in total revenue. Total expenses are projected at \$9,178,000 with a \$148,500 net profit budgeted for the year 2000. The board approved the transfer of \$500,000 to the General Service Board's Reserve Fund.

Special contributions received in 1999 were allocated by area, a practice we will continue in the future. The review of self-support continued and G.S.O. has begun utilizing better formatting and color in the printing of the Quarterly Contributions Letters to groups.

Publishing — Since the 1999 Conference, we reviewed cover designs for new hard-cover book jacket and soft-cover book designs, which are scheduled to be phased in between March 2000 and March 2001. A list of introduction dates was sent to all delegates and literature purchasers. The revised Treatment Facilities Kit/Workbook were produced and priced according to our policy, i.e., committee kits/workbooks are priced to cover the cost of contents. The following translations were completed and priced according to our policy, i.e., English equivalent: Czech *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, Greek *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, and Ukrainian "This Is A.A." The board authorized \$25,000 to cover the cost of translating the Big Book into Mongolian. The board approved the \$6,000 cost of printing five pamphlets in Ukrainian: "This Is A.A.," "Is A.A. for You?," "Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?," "Young People and A.A." and "Do You Think You're Different?" All Spanish-language workbooks/kits are being revised. The Spanish translation of *Living Sober* is also being revised and should be available by year-end 2000. During 1999, the board granted permission/did not object to 169 requests to reprint from A.A. literature, and 14 requests were denied.

New Warehousing/Distribution Center — After more than a year of research, G.S.O. has moved its main U.S. warehousing/distribution operations from Kansas City to a firm called Quebecor in Church Hill, Tennessee. The transition period has worked out well, and it is expected that this change will result in savings of approximately \$80,000 per year.

Literature Orders — In 1999, G.S.O. processed 27,866 paid literature orders; 6,318 or 23% were credit card orders; telephone orders totaled 8,897, half of these paid by credit card.

Copyright Infringement — In March, the Court in Frankfurt, Germany, ruled in our favor in the suit brought against an individual who had been producing and distributing A.A.W.S. copyrighted literature. The Court ruling affirms that our copyrights on the Big Book in English (First, Second and Third Editions) are valid outside the United States. New material added to the Third Edition remains copyrighted in the U.S. In fact, all translations of the Big Book—and all of our other literature—are protected from misuse by valid copyright. G.S.O. has requested and received positive responses from several Web sites and domain owners to remove copyrighted, A.A. Conference-approved literature posted on their Web sites.

The board welcomed new regional trustee director Jim Clough, who replaced rotating regional trustee director Garry McAuley in May 1999. In addition, the board elected a slate of officers to serve through Conference 2000. The board requested that the trustees' Nominating Committee approve Beth Rabren to replace Jack L. Ostrem as a regional trustee director on the A.A.W.S. Board following the 2000 Conference.

G.S.O./Staff Operations — New staff member Rick Walker began work at G.S.O. on November 29, replacing Richard Bush who retired on November 30 after 11 years of devoted service. Erin Lange was hired in January 2000 as assistant archivist at G.S.O. Erin brings G.S.O. significant professional knowledge in the archives field and a strong background in electronic document

management. The additional support will allow the audio preservation project to move forward, starting with the recordings of the St. Louis Convention. At year-end 1999, G.S.O. had 83 full-time positions, compared to 82 employees in 1998.

Three all-employee meetings were held since the 1999 Conference to introduce new employees and to respond to "ask-it-basket" questions. At the most recent all-employee meeting in March, each employee received a copy of the Severance Plan. In addition, interdepartmental orientations were held to exchange information and explore ways of increasing communication and utilizing shared resources and experience. A proposal to increase and expand our office efficiency by installing a P.C.-based networking system has been approved. G.S.O. finalized negotiations with its health care provider for the 1999-2000 plan year and realized an overall 4.2% reduction in annual plan costs.

Services Mondiaux des Alcooliques Anonymes (S.M.A.A.) Inc. — The directors of S.M.A.A., an affiliate corporation of A.A.W.S., Inc., have held meetings on a quarterly basis since the last Conference. At the January 27, 2000 meeting, the directors received reports on the operations and finances of the corporation during 1999. For the 11-month period (S.M.A.A. was acquired on February 1, 1999), S.M.A.A. realized a loss of approximately CAN \$34,500 from operations. After interest earned on the S.M.A.A. Reserve Fund and currency translations, a loss of U.S.\$11,400 was recorded. The directors reviewed and accepted the S.M.A.A. budget for 2000, which was forwarded to the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee.

Jack Ostrem, chairperson

ARCHIVES

Trustees' committee: The committee discussed the comments and recommendations received to improve the Archives Handbook. It was agreed that the Archives Kit format would allow more frequent updates, as we learn about new preservation and retrieval procedures.

We also reviewed the current archives policy on the co-founders anonymity. Although, the co-founders' anonymity was broken on a number of occasions in the past, the committee agreed that anonymity is the primary spiritual foundation of our Fellowship and reaffirmed the G.S.O. Archives Policy that we maintain the anonymity of all members, living or dead, including the co-founders, at the level of public media.

The audio preservation specialist conducted the on-site evaluation of G.S.O.'s audio collection. His report, with the detailed financial estimates of the project, was reviewed by the committee and forwarded to the General Service Board. It was felt that the financial concerns should not limit our efforts to proceed full speed with the preservation works.

We started planning for the 2000 International Convention. The G.S.O. Archives will have its own booth, located in close proximity to the general registration area and we expect many of the Convention visitors to stop by.

Linda Chezem, chairperson

Archivist's report: The reconstruction has been completed in the Archives. A new window was installed between our work area and the research room. While maintaining a quiet area for research, the window also allows us to better monitor this area.

The G.S.O. Archives welcomed representatives of the Danish General Service Office Archives who researched early Danish A.A. history here. They expressed how invaluable our resources were to compile Denmark's A.A. history.

A number of areas expressed concerns over the difficulties in establishing ownership of their collections. The separation of the area's and the archivist's personal collection is sometimes unclear. Area collections are strongly encouraged to prepare a detailed inventory of their holdings, and that inventory should be regularly reviewed and updated by the Area's Archives Committee.

Early 1999, we received the tragic news about Frank Mauser, former G.S.O. archivist. Frank took over the position in 1983 from Nell Wing, and served until the end of 1998. Memorial services were done both in Vero Beach, Florida, where Frank retired, and in New York.

Judit Santon, archivist

CONFERENCE

Trustees' committee: The committee met three times since the 1999 General Service Conference. During that period we reviewed 1999 Advisory Actions pertaining to the Conference, including the theme chosen for the 50th General Service Conference, "Trusting our Future to A.A. Principles."

We also reviewed the summary of Evaluation Questionnaires submitted by Conference members, and from that shared experience several suggestions for improving the flow of the Conference were made. They included concerns that there was insufficient time for the Joint (dinner) Meetings of the trustees' and Conference Committees on International Conventions/Regional Forums and Archives; that the stacking of Conference Committee meetings (Monday afternoon and Tuesday morning) allowed little leeway for a committee that needed additional time to consider agenda topics, as well as leaving less time for preparation of preliminary committee reports; and, that fewer breaks may contribute to increased stress for some members. We decided to start the Conference on Sunday for these reasons.

We also reviewed topics submitted for Conference consideration and forwarded subjects to the appropriate trustees or Conference committee and reviewed and accepted the committee's 2000 budget and sent it to the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee.

In January, the committee approved the updated main Conference Agenda, including presentation topics and workshop questions. We considered over 26 Conference agenda topics submitted since the last meeting, and discussed ten subjects in great detail. We welcomed the delegate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee to the January 29th meeting and felt ready to join with all Conference members in a special celebration of A.A.'s 50th General Service Conference April 30, 2000.

Jim Clough, chairperson



Staff report: The Conference coordinator is the G.S.O. contact for General Service Conference members. The Conference process continues throughout the year and the coordinator corresponds regularly with delegates and alternate delegates, who cooperate to make the annual Conference responsive to the needs of the Fellowship. The coordinator of the Conference is also the contact for area and district committee members, as well as past delegates, in the 92 areas throughout the United States and Canada.

A.A. members are encouraged to submit topics through their area committees for consideration by the Conference. Suggested topics may be forwarded to a trustees' committee for consideration and, where appropriate, referral to a Conference committee. The Conference coordinator is responsible for:

- Serving as secretary to the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Assembling suggestions for the Conference theme, presentation/discussion and workshop topics that are reviewed by the Conference Agenda Committee, which makes selections that are recommended to the Conference for approval.
- Working with the G.S.O. staff and general manager on planning and coordinating each phase of the Conference.
- Scheduling and assembling reports and other information for the Conference Manual; and, with the guidance of the Publications Department, the Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9* and the Conference Final Report.

Susan Ulseth

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY/TREATMENT FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: The trustees' Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community and Treatment Facilities have been meeting jointly since August, 1998 as a result of an action taken by the General Service Board in April, 1998. Since the 1999 General Service Conference, the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committee has met three times.

Cooperation With the Professional Community — The focus of the trustees' C.P.C. Committee is to assist local C.P.C. committees in providing A.A. information to professionals who may come into contact with the still-suffering alcoholic through their work. Following is a description of the committee's work over the past year:

We recommended the production and instillation of the new panel for the C.P.C. exhibit proceed, using a revised new panel. We reviewed and accepted the 1999 exhibit lists and evaluation reports and encouraged the C.P.C. staff member to continue seeking exhibit opportunities at national professional meetings of social workers and members of the clergy. Thirty exhibits were coordinated for 1999. In addition, we reviewed and accepted an updated 2000 exhibit list and made suggestions regarding future events to be added to the list.

The committee reviewed and discussed a suggested change to the pamphlet "Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?" It was a strong sense of the meeting that there is no need for any change to the pamphlet. The committee requested that the General Service Office explore the viability of broadening the distribution of the Membership Survey to the professional community. We suggested that the Special Needs materials be given a more elevated profile in our communication with professionals, and also suggested that copies of at least two issues of *About A.A.* be included as part of the literature package to be sent whenever exhibiting at national events. We also suggested that, if feasible, G.S.R. Kits include at least two issues of *About A.A.* and literature on sponsoring physicians and helping them identify A.A.s in their practice

who could meet with selected patients.

The committee discussed developing guidelines to help A.A. members inform their doctors and other professionals about A.A. for possible inclusion in the C.P.C. Workbook. After sharing a wide variety of successful experiences of collaborating with professionals, especially their own physicians, there was considerable consensus that one-on-one sharing was more successful than literature in helping physicians feel competent in working with those afflicted with alcoholism and guiding their patients towards A.A. Subsequently,

- A subcommittee was appointed to discuss ways to inform physicians regarding the benefits of using A.A. members as resources when attempting to help the still-suffering alcoholic.
- We requested that the staff member gather "Sponsoring Your Doctor" sharing from area and local committees for review at the July 2000 meeting. Prior to the meeting, the gathered experience would be converted to a draft for possible inclusion in the C.P.C. Workbook. Finally, the committee requested background information on "C.P.C. and Remote Communities" and that the topic be placed on the agenda for the July 2000 meeting.

Information for professionals on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site was accessed over 43,000 times and C.P.C. committees acted as local resources for many of the more than 1,400 professionals who, via the e-mail response form, requested additional information and an A.A. contact.

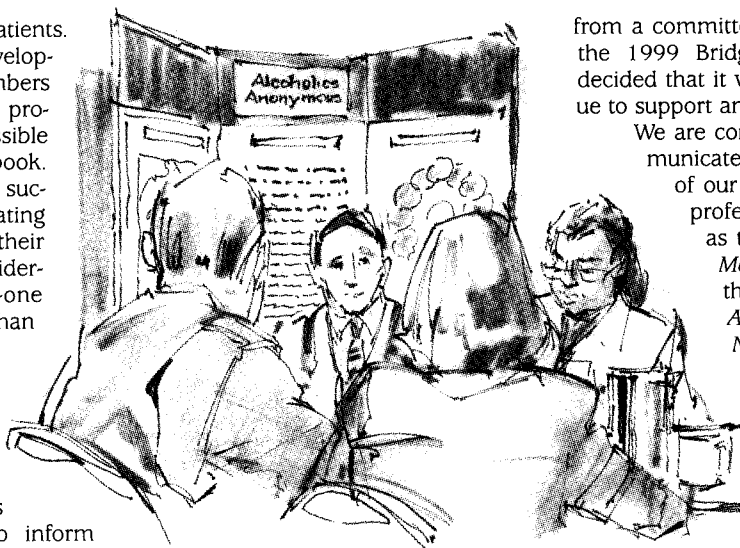
Treatment Facilities — The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities is to "... further the acceptance of A.A. in hospitals, rehabilitation centers, and similar facilities, and to bring additional help to alcoholics under treatment there." (1999-2000 Edition of *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. S65) The committee's attention is directed to having the A.A. message available to alcoholics in treatment facilities. Following is an overview of our work during the past year:

The committee forwarded a suggestion to change the Treatment Facilities Workbook and Handbook to "A.A. General Service Conference-approved literature," to the 1999 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities. They took no action, so the material remains service material.

Additionally, our committee unanimously agreed that the Workbook and Handbook be made consistent with that of the other three service committees (Correctional Facilities, Public Information, and Cooperation with the Professional Community). The 1999 Conference Treatment Facilities Committee agreed that "A soft-cover Treatment Facilities Kit... replace the current Workbook [3-ring binder]...." By early 2000, the new Treatment Facilities Kit was available from A.A.W.S. The Kit includes a soft-cover Treatment Facilities Workbook, A.A. Guidelines, and pamphlets—the most complete sharing of A.A. experience in doing this service work.

Our committee reviewed background on the Treatment Facilities information letter to treatment facilities professionals in the U.S. and Canada, and agreed on a letter which was sent in September.

We suggested that discussions of Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact efforts remain part of the Conference committees to which they currently belong. After hearing a thorough report



from a committee member who had attended the 1999 Bridging the Gap Workshop, we decided that it would be worthwhile to continue to support and participate in the Workshop.

We are considering ways to further communicate the inclusiveness and diversity of our Fellowship with our friends in professional fields, using such tools as the *Alcoholics Anonymous 1998 Membership Survey* pamphlet and the catalog of A.A. *Literature and Audiovisual Material for Special Needs*. The committee requested that an upcoming issue of *About A.A.* provide information on how the A.A. message is made available to those with Special Needs. One of the articles would point out that there is a catalog of A.A. items directed to the alcoholic with Special Needs.

Local Treatment Facilities committees are now carrying meetings into other noncorrectional institutional environments, e.g., shelters, nursing homes, hospices, half-way houses and not limiting their scope to "treatment facilities." The trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee continues to provide support for this special Twelfth Step Service.

George E. Vaillant, M.D., chairperson

Staff reports:

Cooperation With the Professional Community — The Cooperation With the Professional Community (C.P.C.) assignment is responsible for providing information about A.A. and establishing good communication with those outside A.A. who may have direct contact with the still-suffering alcoholic through their professional work. These professionals include the clergy, physicians, nurses, attorneys, correctional facilities personnel, social workers, counselors, educators, and those working in the field of alcoholism. The staff member on this assignment maintains communication with C.P.C. committee chairs throughout the U.S. and Canada. New chairpersons are sent a welcome letter and receive the C.P.C. Kit containing the C.P.C. Workbook, A.A. Guidelines, Conference and trustees' Committee History and Actions, A.A. pamphlets, a Catalog of Conference Approved Literature, Box 4-5-9, and a current issue of *About A.A.* Upon request, we assist C.P.C. committees by sharing C.P.C. experience and providing C.P.C. material. Currently, there are over 400 area, district and central office/inter-group C.P.C. committees. We receive committee meeting minutes from several committees and encourage all to share their experience for possible inclusion in Box 4-5-9.

In 1999 the C.P.C. staff member responded to over two thousand inquiries from professionals; 1,437 of these were requests for information which followed visits to our A.A. Web site. Today, many professionals can share that not only does A.A. respond in a friendly manner and provide literature, but many have been put

We A.A.s Are Everywhere

When Cookie Schamroth (Southeast New York) dropped her soda one evening a hotel employee hurried to pick up the broken glass, and said, "Don't worry, Cookie, it's progress not perfection. My sponsor told me to take good care of you."

in touch with C.P.C. committee members in their communities who are available to serve as A.A. resources. Thirty exhibits were coordinated for national professional meetings for 1999 and staffed by local C.P.C. committees. Fifty-one invitations were referred to area C.P.C. committees for local professional events. In addition, G.S.O. furnished C.P.C. material for several exhibits and events set up by local committees. Exhibits continued to be an effective tool in carrying the message to professionals and often result in requests for additional A.A. information, as well as requests to receive issues of our publication *About A.A.* Currently more than 21,000 professionals are receiving *About A.A.*

Meetings with students from Cornell University Medical Center continue to be set up throughout the year at G.S.O. The aim here is to make these future physicians aware that A.A. can be a valuable resource when working with the still-suffering alcoholic. The students are provided with literature, shown the video "Hope: Alcoholic Anonymous," given a brief introduction to the A.A. program, and a tour of G.S.O.

Warren Stafford

Treatment Facilities — The primary purpose of the Treatment Facilities assignment is to provide information and service material to assist the work of A.A. committees who wish to carry the message to alcoholics in treatment. We now have 89 area Treatment Facilities chairpersons, 202 district chairpersons, and 19 "Other" local chairpersons. We maintain an up-to-date list of these committee chairs and provide them with information and literature. Area T.F. chairs are sent the Treatment Facilities Kit, a comprehensive guide to carrying the message in Treatment Facilities. All T.F. chairpersons receive subscriptions to *Box 4-5-9* and *About A.A.*, as well as a listing of intergroups, central offices and answering services in the U.S. and Canada for referral purposes. They are also sent a list of the area Treatment Facilities chairs in order to share current experience.

Valuable treatment facilities sharing is provided to G.S.O. through minutes and reports sent in by treatment facilities committees. The information from these often serves as the basis for an article in *Box 4-5-9*.

Correspondence from local A.A.s who are active in treatment facilities work are answered by sharing information and literature. Inquiries are also received from newly sober alcoholics in treatment facilities and from treatment facilities personnel requesting information and assistance in setting up A.A. meetings. Each of these receives a response from the office, and area or local chairpersons are notified of the request. In order to carry the message into treatment facilities, committee members often meet with personnel in many different types of institutional settings, becoming familiar with the rules and regulations of the facility and complying with them. As an oldtimer once said, "If we can't get in, we can't carry the message!" It is helpful for the committee to present A.A. clearly, sharing what A.A. does and doesn't do, focusing on A.A.'s primary purpose, our nonprofessional status, and our Tradition of cooperation but not affiliation. A very useful tool, the video "Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous," is often shown to treatment center staff and clients.

Treatment Facilities committees often offer to bring meetings to clients. Local "Bridging the Gap" or "Temporary Contact" efforts may give clients lists of groups in their hometowns, or help them to get in touch with a hometown A.A. member. This member can then help the client get to meetings, explain A.A. sponsorship, and introduce them to other A.A. members. Helping someone just out of treatment get settled into a regular home group is the essence of Twelfth Step work.

The staff member on this assignment also serves as co-secretary to the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities and as secretary to

the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities. Responsibilities in this area include preparing agendas, background material, and minutes for meetings.

Rick Walker

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

Trustees' report: The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities is to recommend to the General Service Board actions that support carrying the A.A. message to those alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Since the 1999 General Service Conference, the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities has met three times. Following is an overview of our work during the past year: At the recommendation of the 1999 General Service Conference:

- We replaced the first six paragraphs on pages 18 and 19 under the heading "We Set Up A.A. Contacts," in the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in A Cell," with the changes selected by the Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities. Note: These paragraphs were added to the draft of the proposed new format of the pamphlet that was forwarded to the 2000 Conference Correctional Facilities Committee.
- A letter was sent to all delegates and Correctional Facilities Committee chairpersons explaining the Corrections Correspondence Service (CCS) and asking for volunteers to write to inmates on an individual basis.
- The committee discussed carrying the message into youth detention centers and agreed that the information in the Correctional Facilities Workbook, currently on pages 13 through 15, is sufficient to assist A.A. members carrying the message into youth detention centers and short term facilities. We reviewed A.A. literature created specifically for younger members and agreed to forward a request that a list of these items be included in the Literature Guide section of the Correctional Facilities Workbook to the 2000 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities for their consideration.
- We discussed an area's request to consider the 1984 General Service Conference Action regarding the designation of the Correctional Facilities Workbook as "A.A. General Service Conference-approved literature" and agreed to forward this request to the 2000 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities for discussion. It was the sense of this committee that the Correctional Facilities Kit and Workbook would best be designated as service material rather than "A.A. General Service Conference-approved literature."
- A subcommittee was created to consider the feasibility of developing a service piece to accompany the video: "Carrying the Message Behind These Walls." We discussed the subcommittee's report during the January meeting and requested that a draft be prepared for review at the July trustees' committee meeting.

Guido MacGuffie, delegate from Idaho, enjoyed early morning runs in Central Park before Conference sessions began. He was feeling especially fit midweek and decided that after his run he would work out in the Health and Fitness Club on the 15th floor of the hotel. In fact, he was feeling so good that he decided to run up the 15 flights rather than use the elevator. At the 4th floor he discovered that he could not re-enter the hotel from the stairwell. Thinking this would change on any given floor, he continued running up the stairs and was finally able to re-enter on the 28th floor. He confessed to being a little tired after his workout.

- Letters were mailed to all area delegates and C.F. Committee chairpersons regarding the need for "long-timer" stories for a proposed draft of "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell." The committee reviewed ten stories, two progress reports from the publications department as well as the new layout and illustrations for "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell." We agreed to forward a draft to the 2000 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities with these suggestions: The addition of Clyde's story; delete the story "Cool George, the Hell Raiser," and add two new stories depicting A.A. members with long-term sobriety while incarcerated.

Informational letters about Alcoholics Anonymous were mailed to 7,634 administrators, health professionals, and counselors, in prisons and jails at the federal, state and local levels. We discussed the increasing number of requests for free Big Books received by the General Service Office. A letter was sent to area and district Correctional Facilities, Hospitals & Institutions, and Bridging the Gap committee chairpersons asking areas or committees to share with us some of the wonderful and creative ways they have discovered for getting Big Books to men and women behind the walls.

Carl Budd, chairperson

Staff report: The Correctional Facilities assignment is responsible for carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Over 600 letters a month arrive from inmates, most asking for free literature, many asking for names of outside A.A. members with whom to correspond, or for help in making contact with A.A. upon release. We try to facilitate these requests, primarily through our network of area, district and local Correctional Facilities committees. The newsletter, *Sharing From Behind The Walls*, containing sharing from inmate letters sent to G.S.O., is also a responsibility of this assignment.

The Corrections Correspondence Service (CCS), coordinated by this desk, continues as one of our most valuable efforts. Many inmates are looking to turn their lives around and crave outside support in this effort from experienced A.A.s with whom they can share their experience, strength and hope. We have available a service piece about our CCS (F-26) which we include in new group packages and can be ordered for group literature stands. There is an ongoing need for "outside" A.A. members, particularly men, to participate in this service. Yet, whenever a G.S.O. staff member attending an assembly, convention, conference or other Fellowship function has mentioned the tremendous need for CCS volunteers and provided ample supplies of F-26 service pieces, there has been a substantial increase in the number of A.A.s wishing to correspond with those on the inside.

One of the more persistent questions asked by A.A. members involved in corrections service is how to get their fellow members on the "outside" to commit to speaking or sponsoring a meeting in a correctional facility. The fear of not having the inmate identify with an A.A. member who has not been to prison, and the amount of time institutions require for orientation seminars to qualify to go into correctional facilities are commonly pointed out as impediments to Fellowship participation. *Carrying the Message Behind These Walls*, a video created to encourage A.A. members to participate in correctional service, addresses many of the concerns that may hold members back from this rewarding Twelfth Step work.

In a recent letter, a corrections professional states: "The work done by A.A. volunteers has a profound impact on offenders fortunate enough to hear the volunteers speak, as well as those, such as myself, charged with helping them prepare to re-enter society."

Adrienne Brown

FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Trustees' committee: At last year's Conference we reviewed the proposed budget for 1999 and reported that the G.S.O. expected income from operations was \$174,000. This followed substantial, but planned, losses in 1995, 1996 and 1997 that helped to lower the Reserve Fund balance. Today I can report that actual results for 1999 were considerably better than the proposed budget. Having previously accomplished the objective of lowering the Reserve Fund balance and maintaining it in '98, we added approximately \$500,000 based on 1999 results. Today, after the transfer, the balance stands at just about 9.4 months.

General Service Office: As you know, our revenue essentially comes from two sources: profit from literature sales and contributions. We should all be encouraged that contributions in 1999 were higher than both those received in 1998 and the amount we had hoped to receive for 1999. This represents the third year in a row that contributions have increased over the previous year and hopefully reflects a positive trend. Contributions were \$203,000, or 5.0% higher than 1998 and \$142,000 (3.5%) higher than our budget as well. In any case, during 1999, \$4,242,000 in contributions were received from 24,355 groups. That, for comparison, represents 43.2% of the 56,266 groups registered with G.S.O., and is slightly less than the 44.6% that contributed in 1998. While contributions were up, the percent of groups contributing reached the lowest point of the past ten years.

Net sales of literature were \$9,145,000. This was \$420,000, 4.3% greater than budgeted, and \$233,000, or 2.6% greater than the previous year (which did not include SMAA). Keep in mind that some literature prices were adjusted upward in May 1997, following two years of lower prices and increased discounts. In fact, the number of actual books and booklets sold increased slightly (about 1% or 18,000 units) above the 1998 level, which was itself about 9.0% below 1997 levels. That means that book sales, as measured in units, finally stabilized after declining over the last ten years. In total, printing and other manufacturing costs, shipping expenses and royalty payments were somewhat ahead of budget, as were sales. Gross profit of \$5,132,000 was \$388,000 more than budgeted and \$612,000 more than realized in 1998.

The combination of contributions and net literature sales resulted in total G.S.O. revenue of \$9,382,000, some \$534,000, or 6%, greater than originally budgeted, and \$820,000, or 9.6%, greater than 1998.

Total operating expenses for G.S.O. during 1999 were \$8,516,000. This is \$164,000 less than budget, and essentially "flat" — just 1% higher — than the previous year. Therefore, compared to the budget, the increase in revenues was augmented by the reduced expenses, resulting in an operating profit of \$866,300 for the year, a substantial improvement to both the budget and over the previous year, thus enabling the transfer of \$500,000 to the Reserve Fund.

In 1994, G.S.O. lowered prices and increased discounts on literature. These changes were undertaken to lower the Reserve Fund, which was approaching the upper limit established by the General Service Conference. The Conference-approved limit is 12 months of combined G.S.O. and Grapevine operating expenses. We have accomplished the objective of lowering the Reserve Fund. At December 1999 it was just about 9 months, in my opinion, about where it should be in normal times. At \$7,332,900, the Reserve Fund amounts to \$131 per listed A.A. group. To give perspective to this number, contributions per group averaged about \$76 for the 56,266 registered, while expenses to support services to those groups averaged \$104. Also to give perspective, and lest we get too euphoric with our leveling unit book sales this past year, since 1990, our unit sales of books have declined at an aver-

age rate of about 4.5% per year. We are now selling almost one-third fewer Big Books than we were selling in 1989.

While we cannot ignore the reality of the prior trend of continuing decline in unit literature sales, the 1999 results give us pause to consider a slower decline; therefore, the 2000 G.S.O. budget assumes a more modest 2% decline in unit sales of books and booklets. In keeping with our Seventh Tradition of self-support, this year's budget includes a 2% increase in contributions. The budget envisions a larger than usual increase in operating expenses with three key factors helping to create this larger increase. First, much of the "Other Program Printing" that did not occur in 1999 will occur this year. Second, the World Service Meeting, which occurs every two years, adds about \$125,000 of expense to the G.S.O. budget. This is the net cost to G.S.O. after country contributions and fees. Third, a project to restore Archives treasures which are deteriorating is anticipated to cost about \$100,000 in 2000, with similar amounts for three or four years. Without these unusual expenditures total expense for 2000 would increase by approximately 4%.

Based on these primary assumptions — a 2.0% decrease in literature unit sales; a 2.0% increase in contributions; a 7.8% increase in total operating expenses — the projection for 2000 is for a modest excess of revenue over expense of \$148,500. As I have mentioned in prior reports, following three consecutive years of planned losses (1995-1997), the Reserve Fund is at the point where it is prudent to anticipate slightly better than break-even years, and we are!

Just to expand a bit on the use of the Fellowship's money in providing services back to the Fellowship, in 1999 we spent \$5,876,500 on services to the Fellowship, almost exactly the same as the \$5,867,700 spent in 1998 and \$79,000 less than the \$5,944,000 in 1997. Contributions provided 72% of this and 28% came from the profit from literature sales. This year, no funds were needed from the Reserve Fund for G.S.O. services.

Services spending amounted to \$104 per listed A.A. group, even with last year, while contributions were about \$76 per group. The 1999 service dollar was spent on the following activities: Group Services 38.7% (which includes the Group Services assignment; Box 4-5-9; A.A. Directories; records and files; contributions processing; and French services); the General Service Conference, 12.5%; Loners, Internationalists, and Overseas Services, 8.9%; Trustees' and Directors' activities, 7.7%; Regional Forums, 5.8%; Archives, 5.5%; C.P.C., 4.9%; Spanish Services, 4.2%; Public Information 3.7%; Correctional Facilities, 3.6%; current year Convention Assignment expense, 3.1%; and Treatment Facilities, 1.8%.

The Grapevine: At the Grapevine, magazine income was approximately even with last year, even though circulation was down slightly. Average circulation during 1999 was 114,900 compared with 117,300 for 1998, 120,679 for 1997, and 128,360 during 1996. Gross profit on the magazine was \$1,064,000, which was essentially the same as last year but \$31,000 more than budget. Revenue of Other Items was less than budgeted by \$95,000 and was also \$13,000 less than last year. Gross profit on Other Items, however, was approximately \$18,000 higher than 1998, due to Pocket Planner & Wall Calendar sales. Therefore, total income, including interest income, was \$1,427,000, slightly greater than last year but \$47,000 less than budgeted.

Costs and expenses for editorial, circulation and business, and administration were \$1,448,900. This was \$6,000 less than last year and \$55,000 less than budget. As a result, the Grapevine (excluding La Viña) reported a loss of \$22,000, some \$7,000 less than budgeted, and \$23,000 less than 1998.

The Grapevine's 2000 budget, excluding La Viña, calls for a \$21,000 reduction in magazine subscription income to \$1,732,800, compared with 1999, with magazine gross profit constant at \$1,062,500. Gross profit on Other Publishing Income is anticipated to increase \$23,000, while interest income should remain approximately the same. Costs and expenses are projected to increase by \$67,000. The net effect is a greater budgeted net loss, from \$21,900 in 1999 to \$66,100 in 2000. This is the sixth consecutive year of operating losses for the Grapevine. While both management and the Grapevine Board have worked diligently to get the Grapevine back to a self-supporting position, this 2000 budget reflects the continuing negative trend. With approval of the General Service Board, the trustees' Finance Committee has encouraged the Grapevine Board to seek outside consulting assistance to explore every avenue of business process improvement. Hopefully, the help of experienced professionals, new technologies and fresh approaches to the Grapevine's business practices will enhance financial performance.

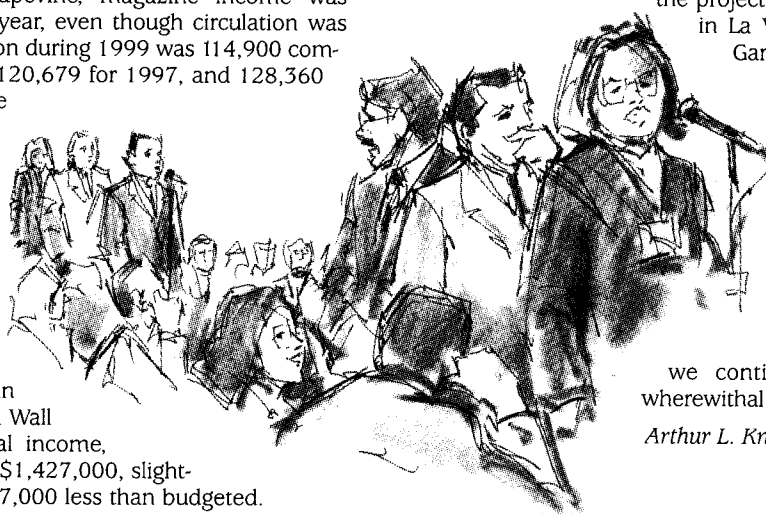
La Viña: As we all know, La Viña is the Spanish-language magazine project approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. Since then, the magazine has grown from an idea to a full-fledged publication with a 1999 average circulation of close to 8,000, (up slightly from 7,800 in 1998, but down from 8,400 in 1997). Personally speaking, La Viña appears to be a first-rate product. Hopefully, it will increasingly fulfill the needs of our Spanish-speaking members and we will see continued growth in circulation. To date, the project has incurred losses each of the past four and one-half years. During 1999, subscription income was \$58,600 and direct costs of publishing were \$53,400, resulting in a \$5,200 gross profit. Operating expenses directly associated with the publication were \$64,400. These include the editorial, circulation and administrative costs attributable to La Viña. Therefore, the overall loss on the project was \$59,200.

The Grapevine Board and management have worked hard to put out a quality product that is responsive to the needs of the Spanish-speaking members of the Fellowship on a cost-effective basis. For 2000, the loss on the La Viña project is budgeted to increase to \$66,200 and circulation is projected to remain around 8,000 copies. The Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee will continue to monitor progress against the original business plan and inform the Conference. Since the inception of the project, \$395,000 has been invested

in La Viña, and as you heard from Gary Glynn earlier, the General Service Board is carefully evaluating this project this year so we can make the best recommendation to the Conference next year.

In summary, the Fellowship's finances remain in good condition, the outlook for this year appears to be favorable, and we continue to have the financial wherewithal to carry the message.

Arthur L. Knight, Jr., chairperson



GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Trustees' report: The board held three General Sharing Sessions since the last Conference. The topic for the July 1999 session was "How to Improve Communications with All A.A. Groups"; for the October Sharing Session, the discussion focused on "The Hand of A.A.: Are We Truly Available to All Who Need Us?," and last January, the topic was "Anonymity in the 21st Century: Will We Be Able to Meet the Challenge?"

July 1999: Ron Gauthier, director serving on the A.A. World Services Board, addressed means of communications with groups in the U.S. and Canada, saying that our common efforts rely on a variety of processes that focus primarily on the relationship with the A.A. groups. Ron suggested ways to improve routine communications with groups and ideas to encourage participation by more groups.

Vinnie McCarthy, director of Publications at G.S.O., spoke about communication with non-English speaking A.A.s through translations. Noting that *Alcoholics Anonymous* has been translated into 40 languages, Vinnie shared her belief that translating literature is one of the most important services G.S.O. provides. Using the familiar format of what it used to be like, what happened and what it's like now, Vinnie described G.S.O.'s role in literature translations.

The thought-provoking presentations sparked interesting comments. For instance, that cyberspace and the Internet can provide vast opportunities for communication but it is important to not "disinter mediate" because of the value of one alcoholic communicating to another. Questions were raised about why recovering alcoholics drop out of sight and why groups disband. Reference was made to *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age* which points out that each member is responsible for the Fellowship.

With regard to improving communication with all A.A. groups, we were reminded to be mindful of aspects of the Fellowship outside of the General Service Structure — Intergroups and Central Offices, International Doctors in A.A., International Conference of Young People in A.A., as well as others, plus the many conventions and round-ups throughout the Fellowship.

G.S.O.'s job is to facilitate Twelfth Step work, and the session ended with poignant sharing about a letter from a twelve-year-old student who wrote to G.S.O. reaching out for help. Through communication, contact was made with an oldtimer in the mid-west who lives in the boy's neighborhood.

October 1999: Eastern Canada trustee Marne Hill encouraged us to focus on how each of us can emphasize our responsibility to individual Twelfth Step work by: participating in greeting and sharing with newcomers, stressing responsibility to those we sponsor, volunteering for the local Twelfth Step call list, and sharing the A.A. message with professionals who are often in contact with alcoholics with no awareness of A.A.

Pacific regional trustee Jim Clough shared that he came to A.A. because he was told that this might be the only place that he could stay sober. Early on, he was thrilled to hear about places such as Northern Ireland and South Africa, where A.A. members were able to put their political, religious, and racial issues aside and meet together to share sobriety.

During the general sharing, a member spoke of his experience during the Special Forum in Window Rock, Arizona, where he saw that Native North Americans are not convinced that A.A. is an adequate solution for alcoholics in their population. Do we each need to inventory ourselves to determine if our personal experiences limit our willingness to reach out to alcoholics who don't look like us?

Another member expressed concern that attendance in two meetings she regularly attends has been dwindling, and wondered if fewer people were coming to A.A. She asked if our ten-

Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 2000¹

	Groups	Members
United States	51,151	1,161,436
Canada	5,132	97,504
Sub-Total	56,283	1,258,940
Correctional facilities ²	2,519	64,723
Internationalists		114
Lone members		314
Total	58,802	1,324,091
Outside U.S. & Canada ³	40,222	666,413
Grand Total	99,024	1,990,504

1. The General Service Office does not keep membership records. The information shown here is based on reports given by groups listed with G.S.O., and does not represent an actual count of those who consider themselves A.A. members.

2. U.S. and Canada only.

3. We are aware of A.A. activity in approximately 145 countries, including 45 autonomous general service offices in other lands. Annually we attempt to contact those G.S.O.s and groups that request to be listed in our records. Where current data is lacking we use the previous year's figures.

dency to emphasize a narrow view of our primary purpose discourages newcomers and does not permit them to identify and determine if they belong. Another member shared how A.A.s in her region had increased the participation of Spanish-speaking members by making it a point to welcome and integrate those members into A.A. locally. She pointed out that this attitude of inclusiveness has led to the election of several Spanish-speaking delegates in her state.

January 2000: Panel 49 delegate Marita Hagen, chairperson of the Conference Report and Charter Committee, began the session on "Anonymity in the 21st Century: Will We Be Able to Meet the Challenge?" and shared that when anonymity is the topic, most A.A.s focus on Tradition Eleven and maintaining "personal anonymity at the level of press, radio and films." Marita said that our newest challenge will be in the area of the Internet, and asked "What about personal anonymity on-line?" Not all participants will have the same level of understanding about what A.A. is and is not, so it's up to us to gently remind each other to carry the A.A. message rather than our opinions.

Marita also shared that closest to her heart and our biggest challenge is the principle of self-sacrifice inherent in Tradition Twelve, the spiritual foundation of all our Traditions. She posed several interesting questions: Will we put aside our prejudices and what we want individually to focus on what is best for the groups? Are we willing to leave our personal agendas at the door to promote unity? And, will we set aside our best ideas to support the group conscience? In sum, she suggested that how we serve is as important as who we serve.

Northeast regional trustee Tony Taschner spoke of his experiences with differing interpretations of anonymity in A.A., including how those principles are applied posthumously. He reminded

us that the trustees' Public Information Committee is currently involved in considerations directly related to encouraging members utilizing Web sites and other Internet communications to be mindful of anonymity. While gathering his thoughts for this Sharing Session, Tony enlisted the assistance of a sponsee who said that, in his experience, he found no valid reason to set aside the practice of anonymity; he believes that by applying those principles to daily living, he helps avoid the potential for the public, newcomers and established members to misunderstand or neglect our fundamental values. In closing, Tony reminded us of the essay on Tradition Eleven that suggests that anonymity "... is a constant and practical reminder that personal ambition has no place in A.A. In it, each member becomes an active guardian of our Fellowship." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 183)

Class A trustee George Vaillant shared that anonymity for A.A. has two very different purposes: safety and spirituality. George said that anonymity allows members to speak with complete honesty and without fear of punishment. The second purpose is much more spiritual and much harder to achieve. He understands the practice of anonymity is to help members recognize that they are part of the whole that is greater than themselves; to put the group ahead of themselves, and to put principles above their "infinitely unique and fascinating personalities." Anonymity serves as a stand-in for humility and helps members to draw others into their lives, and encourages A.A.s to abandon the delusion that they are a power greater than themselves.

Following the three excellent presentations, a member spoke of the changes in public perception of Alcoholics Anonymous since he came in 1975, when early on he was fearful that even close friends would learn of his membership. Recently, he was approached by a co-worker who wanted to nominate him for an award in recognition of his "volunteer work in A.A." The member reacted with pride knowing that his volunteer service was superior to that of other candidates, until it dawned on him that the principles of anonymity so vital to his sobriety suggested that his ego was overboard. After reflection, the member declined any consideration for the award because his membership would be made public if he were nominated.

Another member spoke of his early fears that attending A.A. meetings in his community might damage his reputation as a practicing attorney. After becoming comfortable in local A.A. meetings, the member was asked to speak on our anonymity Traditions in a nearby community. Soon word came that a newspaper notice about the meeting included the member's full name and profession. Another member shared that he produced a successful radio program about A.A. in which the anonymity of participating members was protected. However, when the station wanted to produce a biography of him, he was willing to have his A.A. membership disclosed, until a nonalcoholic co-worker reminded him of the principles of anonymity. A personal inventory showed him that he had considered breaking his anonymity because of ego factors and wanting to "show others."

Another member shared that he heard early on that anonymity was A.A.'s guarantee to newcomers: no matter how humiliated or beaten down they are, they are welcome in our Fellowship. "A.A. gave me a wide berth to be whoever, whatever I needed to be, until I could become who I am."

"Mental discipline" in adhering to A.A. principles was stressed by another member who is striving for "emotional sobriety." While sharing with a newcomer at a meeting, the member passed on his home telephone number written on a business card describing his professional responsibilities, which had the potential of separating him from the newcomer.

Another member shared that the principles of anonymity within the Fellowship are vital to the sobriety of individual mem-

bers. She recalled that a famous pro football player came to A.A. and was soon featured in flyers advertising occasions when he was to speak at local meetings. Before long, the football star was drunk. At a previous General Service Conference, a member suggested, "Due to anonymity, you're as high as you can go when you walk through the doors of A.A."

Betty Stevens, chairperson

INTERNATIONAL/WORLD SERVICE MEETING

Trustees' committee: This committee is responsible for suggesting policies and actions to assure that the A.A. message is available around the world, especially in areas where there is no established service structure. We provide shared experience, support translations of A.A. literature in other languages and encourage the expansion of regional or zonal service meetings. The committee is the primary link between the international A.A. community and the U.S./Canada General Service Board of Trustees.

The World Service Meeting is a biennial meeting of delegates from countries with an organized service structure. The 16th World Service Meeting will be held October 22-26 in New York City, with the theme "A.A. — Our Future is Our Responsibility." We are anticipating over 38 delegates representing over 28 countries. Alex Palmer, trustee-at-large/Canada, will be a first-term delegate, and Dean Rinehart, trustee-at-large/U.S., will be a second-term delegate representing the General Service Board. G.S.O. general manager Greg Muth will be presiding at the event and staff member Eva Sanchez will serve as WSM coordinator. Other staff members who will serve as secretaries to WSM committees are Adrienne Brown, Doug Richardson and Susan Ulseth. John Kirwin will be in charge of the workroom and hotel facilities.

Literature Assistance — The 2000 Literature Assistance budget of \$102,500 will allow A.A. World Services to translate and publish a variety of foreign language books, pamphlets and reprints. A portion of this expense will be drawn from the International Literature Fund representing contributions from A.A. groups around the world. A.A.W.S. holds the copyrights on all foreign-language versions of our Conference-approved material and issues licensing agreements for publication and distribution to those countries which have an established general service office, board, conference or structure. If no structure exists, we translate and publish the material, subject to scheduling by Publications and approval of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Since April 1999, in addition to reprints in Benisaya, Hungarian, Lithuanian, Russian and Slovak, we completed the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* in Greek and Czech, the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, in Romanian, the pamphlets "This is A.A." in Ukranian and "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" in Slovenian. We also have received some sample chapters of the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* in Chinese.

Interim Zonal Meetings — The United States and Canada were represented at three zonal service meetings, which are held in the year when the World Service Meeting does not meet. In 1999, Richard Bush attended the Third Asia-Oceania meeting in Sydney, Australia; Dean Rinehart and Alex Palmer were delegates to the Eleventh Meeting of the Americas in San Salvador, El Salvador; and Eva Sanchez was at the Tenth European Service Meeting in Frankfurt, Germany.

Who Are They?

The average delegate age is 51.3, with the oldest being 71 and the youngest 33; average length of sobriety is 14.7 years, longest 36 years and shortest 8; average length of service 12.4, with longest 35 and shortest 5 years.

International Trips — The General Service Board and General Service Office responded to many invitations from other countries to attend events ranging from conventions, anniversary celebrations, conferences, board meetings, office visits or regional assemblies or events.

Trustees and staff members visited many countries, including Chile, Cuba, Dominican Republic, El Salvador, Finland, Great Britain, Guatemala, Honduras, Hungary, Iceland, Mexico, Peru, Poland, Russia, South Africa, Sweden, and Ukraine. We continue to be encouraged and inspired by the International A.A. community and General Service boards and offices in other countries, who carry our message to countless thousands in new regions and across difficult linguistic, cultural and economic barriers.

Dean Rinehart, chairperson

Staff report: The International Desk receives correspondence from groups, individual A.A.s and professionals interested in obtaining information about A.A. in countries outside of the U.S. and Canada. Additionally, the staff member corresponds with 45 international general service offices and literature distribution centers. Correspondence arrives at the International Desk in many languages and, with the help of outside translators, it is answered in the appropriate language, often accompanied by A.A. literature. Where there is a nearby office, we share the location and telephone number. The emphasis is on our faith that these members can maintain sobriety, help others and become independent in their own countries.

The International staff member benefits by the experience of G.S.O. staff, great cooperation with the Publications Department and, most importantly, the complete support of the trustees' International Committee, which he or she serves as secretary. Other responsibilities on the assignment are:

- Serving as coordinator for the biennial World Service Meeting (WSM) and maintaining contact with delegates and their offices throughout the year.
- Maintaining close communications with our Publications Department on requests for new translations of literature (most touching are the unanticipated translations of the Big Book lovingly prepared by an A.A. member), and the beginnings of new General Service or Information offices that may be able to distribute literature to local members and groups.
- Translation of A.A. literature: Each year, the A.A. World Services Board receives offers to translate our literature into foreign languages. Primary in consideration of each request is the need to ensure the integrity and authenticity of A.A.'s message. To that end, the Publications Department has the responsibility of having each translation checked against the English original. In countries where there is a general service board licensed to publish A.A. literature, an approved translation is often financed and published there. Where a stable A.A. structure is not yet present, the A.A.W.S. Board undertakes the new publication when funds are available. The Big Book has been translated into about 36 languages, and additional translations are pending approval and/or funding. Responsibilities in regard to translations include close cooperation with the Spanish Services staff member who may first receive up-to-date details on A.A. literature in a country where Spanish is the primary language.
- Communications related to overseas trips, including Interim Service Meetings, held biennially in the year between each World Service Meeting. Our board sends one or two representatives to the Asia-Oceania Service Meeting, the European Service Meeting and the Meeting of the Americas, (formerly the Ibero-American meeting).

Eva Sanchez

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ A.A. REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees' committee:

International Convention — Since the last Conference, our committee has met three times. We approved the 2000 International Convention Program with the understanding that some last-minute additions or adjustments might be needed. We accepted the list of non-A.A. speakers for the Convention panels; accepted the 2000 badge design format; and reviewed and accepted the list of speakers for the Friday and Sunday Big Meetings. The committee agreed to invite special guests who are surviving links to our co-founders, together with a spouse/companion each. We also reviewed a list of discount/subsidies for the 2000 International Convention.

The committee is presenting an Interim Report on the International Conventions Inventory requested by the 1999 Conference Committee. This Interim Report includes a proposed questionnaire to be used to evaluate the 2000 International Convention. We discussed and reviewed the proposed revisions to current Guidelines and Procedures for site selection for the 2010 International Convention for presentation to the 2000 Conference Committee. We also approved the recommendation from the A.A.W.S. Board that the following books: *Alcoholics Anonymous*, *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, *A.A. Comes of Age* and *As Bill Sees It* be available for sale at the Convention in English, French and Spanish.

The committee reviewed formats for the Big Meetings, and recommended that they be as follows:

Friday Night

- 1 Following the Flag Ceremony, the West Central regional trustee will introduce any special guests as a group and then introduce the chairman of the General Service Board.
- 2 The chairman of the General Service Board will say a few words and introduce, as a group, the General Service Board trustees and then acknowledge corporate board directors, past trustees, past and current delegates, G.S.O. employees, the Host Committee, Al-Anon members present, as well as "all trusted servants gathered here tonight."
- 3 The West Central regional trustee will chair the A.A. meeting, beginning with a sobriety countdown in five-year increments, until past 40 years — then the countdown will continue in year counts. Following the sobriety countdown the trustee will introduce three speakers: one from the U.S., one from Canada, and one from another country.

Saturday Night

- 1 The general manager of G.S.O., with the help of an assistant, will chair the Saturday night Oldtimers meeting. Participants will be selected from among members with 40 or more years of sobriety. (These members will be seated together in the front rows of the Stadium.)
- 2 Names of speakers will be pulled "out of the hat." A time limit will be imposed, with a bell to keep things moving along.

Sunday Morning

- 1 The chairperson will open the meeting and then introduce the Host Committee chair.
- 2 Three-speaker closing A.A. meeting.

A.A. Regional Forums — Four Regional Forums and two Special Forums have been held since the last General Service Conference. The Northeast, West Central, the East Central and the Southwest Regions hosted exciting and well attended Forums. A Special Forum was held in San Juan, Puerto Rico and was an

outstanding success. Another Special Forum described as "historic," was held on the Navajo Reservation in Window Rock, Arizona. Over seven different Native American tribes were represented at this Forum.

The committee discussed ways of improving Regional and Special Forums. It was suggested that some workshop topics be selected on-site to tailor some of the sharing to topics important to members of the region. It was also noted that consideration is being given to developing computerized presentations which may include a "virtual reality" tour of the General Service Office.

The following Forums and Special Forums are scheduled prior to the 2001 General Service Conference:

2000		
August 25-27	Pacific	Burbank, California
September 8-10	Eastern Canada	Kingston, Ontario
November 17-19	Southeast	Huntington, West Virginia
2001		
January 6-7	Special	Spokane and Yakima, Washington

Peter Roach, chairperson

Staff reports:

International Conventions — The International Convention assignment entails coordinating the myriad details involved in producing the A.A. International Convention, held every five years. Working with four committees—Trustees, Conference, G.S.O. Planning and Host—the International Convention coordinator is responsible for bringing the Convention to life — to ensure that thousands of A.A.s can share and celebrate A.A.'s anniversary. This time it's in Minneapolis, June 29 - July 2, 2000.

The 2000 Convention will be a wonderful event, with meetings, meetings, meetings, panels, workshops, marathons, mini-marathons, and stadium events. Events begin on Thursday evening with dances and a Block Party down the street from the Convention Center, along Nicollet Mall which will be closed to traffic for this event. Beginning at midnight on Thursday, two major marathon meetings get underway—one in English and one in Spanish—and run continuously until Sunday morning. Opening Ceremonies will be held Friday night at the stadium, complete with the Parade of Flags of those countries represented at the Convention followed by the Big A.A. Meeting. On Saturday night, there will be an Oldtimers Stadium Meeting and on Sunday morning, the customary Closing Meeting at the Stadium.

Local Minneapolis A.A. Host Committee volunteers expect to number 3,000 - 5,000 and these people will welcome the many visitors to Minneapolis. For the family members and loved ones that belong to Al-Anon or Alateen and will accompany us to Minneapolis, the Radisson, Marriott and Marquette hotels will offer daytime Al-Anon/Alateen meetings, workshops, marathons and other events. We trust that all attendees will experience a milestone event, gratitude and the language of the heart in wonderful, friendly Minneapolis.

Valerie O'Neill

Regional Forums — The staff member handling Regional Forums is responsible for coordinating and following through on all arrangements necessary for holding Regional Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These sharing weekends help foster wider communication and understanding among A.A. service workers in a region, the General Service Board, A.A. World Services, Inc., the Grapevine Corporate Board, and the Grapevine and General Service Office staffs. Regional Forums are held at the invitation of a particular

region every two years; there are four Forums annually. The work gets done with the help of a very able staff assistant.

The location and agenda for a Regional Forum are decided jointly by the regional trustee, area delegates and G.S.O. The responsibility for direct contact with the hotel is assumed by a local A.A. host contact working with the Regional Forums coordinator and regional trustee. The Regional Forums coordinator at G.S.O. distributes invitations and registration forms to groups and service workers throughout the region and, working with the host contact and regional trustee, coordinates the details of the Forum. The Regional Forums coordinator is also responsible for preparing and distributing a comprehensive report of the Forum to all who attend. A new addition to the format of Regional Forums has been a Full Forum Workshop which has proven to be an exciting and thought-provoking activity.

A region may request a Special Forum, which has fewer participants from the boards and staff over shorter time periods. Special Forums require the approval of the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums. They may be designed for remote, sparsely populated or urban areas. The Regional Forums coordinator works closely with the regional trustee and host contact tailoring each agenda to local needs. Two Special Forums were held in 1999—August 21-22, San Juan, Puerto Rico and October 9 on the Navajo Reservation in Window Rock, Arizona. Both Special Forums provided an opportunity for A.A. members to draw closer together. They were very productive in generating enthusiasm for service work and were well attended.

The staff member on Service Material/A.A. Regional Forums also serves as secretary of the trustees' Nominating Committee, Conference Committee on Trustees and co-secretary of the trustees' and Conference International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums Committees.

Doug Richardson

LITERATURE

Trustees' committee: This report offers a summary of the literature projects of the trustees' Literature Committee since the 1999 General Service Conference.

Progress Report on the Proposed Fourth Edition Big Book, Alcoholics Anonymous — The subcommittee on the Fourth Edition Big Book has met six times since the 1999 General Service Conference for a total of 20 meetings since its inception in May 1997. Rotation occurred on the subcommittee last summer. After two years of work, some members of the previous subcommittee moved on. The current subcommittee consists of four regional trustees, two nontrustee directors, the Publications director and the Literature coordinator.

In July, the rotating subcommittee members met with the new subcommittee members. The core ideas and ideals which guided the previous subcommittee members were reviewed. Bill Wilson's admonition that the stories in the Big Book are for the newcomer was emphasized as well as the importance that stories for the Big Book reflect a spiritual awakening. The previous subcommittee reviewed 1,222 new stories submitted by members of the Fellowship for possible inclusion in the Fourth Edition. As a result of the review process, the current subcommittee received 95 stories to review. Following a thoughtful assessment of each of these 95 stories by members of the subcommittee, there now remain 38 stories that are under further consideration for possible inclusion in a Fourth Edition. These 38 stories each meet the two major criteria the subcommittee has applied to its review of submitted stories:

- a) Each story must, as Bill Wilson recommended, reach out to the newcomer who is still looking for the A.A. solution.
- b) Each story must be a standard A.A. story that tells in a general way what the individual used to be like, what happened, and what the person is like now.

After receiving input from the Conference Literature Committee and other members of the trustees' Literature Committee about the 38 stories selected, the subcommittee will make its final selection of new stories and then pass the stories on to Publications for editing.

The subcommittee has also conducted a systematic review of all Third Edition stories to determine which of those stories it will recommend for inclusion in the Fourth Edition. As a result of this review the subcommittee has selected 17 Third Edition stories to recommend for inclusion in the Fourth Edition. All stories, both Third Edition stories and new stories, were evaluated through use of the same criteria. The goal is to propose a Fourth Edition that reflects the broadest possible sharing to reach newcomers. The new document will combine the selected new stories plus the continuing stories from the Third Edition. The proposed Fourth Edition will then go to the General Service Conference for approval. Following the selection of 95 stories, 1,127 A.A. members who submitted their stories for possible inclusion were informed that their stories are no longer under consideration for the Fourth Edition of the Big Book. A letter was sent expressing deep gratitude for their efforts and for their participation in this process.

Proposed Pamphlet for Black/African American Alcoholics — As a result of the 1999 General Service Conference Advisory Action, a subcommittee was formed to work in conjunction with the G.S.O. Publications Department to develop a pamphlet directed to Black/African American alcoholics as requested by the Conference Literature Committee. A call for stories was sent to all Conference members. By the end of the year, 34 stories had been received and were reviewed by members of the subcommittee. Those submitting stories were asked to write their story for the newcomer to A.A. — to help a Black/African American alcoholic identify. They were asked to describe, as our Big Book says, what they used to be like, what happened, and what they are like now. It was suggested that they might include the following experiences: their preconceived notions about A.A., their first impression about A.A., what surprised them about A.A., what did not happen when they came to A.A.

The subcommittee was pleased with the quality and variety of stories received and, following review and discussion, selected 14 stories to pass on to Publications for editing. The subcommittee looks forward to receiving the edited stories in May for further review.

Pamphlet to Replace "Time to Start Living" for Older Alcoholics — Following its review of the 1999 Conference Advisory Action, a subcommittee was formed to work in conjunction with the G.S.O. Publications Department to develop a new pamphlet for older alcoholics to replace the pamphlet "Time to Start Living" as recommended by the General Service Conference. A call for stories was sent to all Conference members and to all past trustees and past staff members. The subcommittee was pleased to receive 33 stories reflecting a variety of experiences. Following a review of the stories, the subcommittee selected eleven stories with four additional stories to be passed on to Publications on a provisional basis to be used if needed to cover all relevant points. The Publications Department will review and edit the selected stories and will let the subcommittee know if additional stories are needed to obtain a good balance. The subcommittee looks forward to receiving the edited stories in May.

"Special Interest" Literature Questionnaire — The trustees'

Literature Committee distributed a literature questionnaire as suggested by the 1999 Conference Literature Committee. Responses from 34 delegate areas were reviewed and discussed at the January meeting of the trustees' Literature Committee. The questionnaires will be forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee for their consideration.

Projects Forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee for Discussion

1 The trustees' Literature Committee is considering a pamphlet explaining that A.A. is spiritual rather than a religious program or a pamphlet that will speak to nonbelievers as well as those from non-Judeo-Christian religions. The committee would appreciate input from the Conference Literature Committee in regard to whether there is need for this sort of literature.

2 The trustees' Literature Committee is considering a special needs pamphlet and welcomes input from the Conference Literature Committee to help determine if there is a need for such a pamphlet.

Additional Trustees' Literature Committee Considerations

- The committee unanimously agreed not to include a section in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet and in *The A.A. Service Manual* to describe "La Vigne" for the following reasons: *The A.A. Service Manual* is a guide to the U.S./Canada structure; reference to "La Vigne," a publication of four areas, would not be appropriate. Including "La Vigne" information in *The A.A. Service Manual* and the pamphlet, "The A.A. Group," might create a precedent of including information about area and regional publications in Conference-approved literature. A corporate board with a direct link to the General Service Board oversees Grapevine operations; there is also Conference input. "La Vigne's" structure has been created by the groups it serves in four areas and really has no parallel to the Grapevine and the Spanish "La Viña."

- The committee agreed that it is inappropriate to add text from "Twelve Concepts Illustrated" to *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* because it would mean combining Bill Wilson's writing with text from another author. The committee unanimously agreed that there is not sufficient need to develop an additional publication combining the Steps, Traditions and Concepts at this time.

- Since the 1998 General Service Conference considered a request to add information about A.A. meetings in cyberspace to *Living Sober*, the committee unanimously agreed there is no need for action on this suggestion at this time.

Richard Roughton, chairperson

Staff report: As secretary to the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees, the literature coordinator works closely with the editor, writers and illustrators on preparing all new recovery pamphlets, books and audiovisuals, in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. Along with the editor, the coordinator follows the progress of writers and illustrators on the updating and revising of all recovery pamphlets. Final design and production of all this material is under the auspices of the A.A. World Services' Publications Department. The literature coordinator also serves as secretary to the subcommittee on the proposed Fourth Edition Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*.

The literature desk receives and responds to correspondence from A.A. members and groups about literature. Contact is maintained with all current area, district, intergroup/central offices and A.A. group literature chairpersons. Each newly elected literature chairperson receives a welcoming letter and guidelines to assist the chairperson in this vital responsibility. There are currently 52

area literature chairpersons, 185 district literature chairpersons and 187 literature chairpersons serving intergroups and individual A.A. groups.

The staff member handling literature also serves as editor of *Box 4-5-9*, published in English, French and Spanish with the following distribution: 58,000 copies in English, 5,600 copies in Spanish and 1,400 copies in French. *Box 4-5-9* (French) is translated and printed by Services Mondiaux des Alcooliques Anonymes, Inc. in Montreal, in cooperation with this office. The staff member works closely with the editor of the Publications Department and a small editorial committee to bring the Fellowship news and notes from G.S.O. as well as shared experiences from A.A. groups, committees and members worldwide. The editorial committee welcomes ideas and suggestions from the Fellowship.

Lois Fisher

LONERS, INTERNATIONALISTS, HOMERS

Staff report: As the name implies, "Loners" are A.A.s who are unable to attend meetings because there are no groups nearby. There are about 333 Loners in 87 countries, including the U.S. and Canada. Seagoing A.A.s, known as Internationalists, number about 115, with an additional 38 Port Contacts. Six Internationalist Groups meet aboard ships or in ports. "Homers," a fast-growing segment of the LIM community, are A.A.s who are housebound due to long-term illness or physical disability. We now have 186 Homers in the Loners/Internationalists Group. Loners, Homers, and Internationalists stay sober by reading A.A. literature and by sharing A.A. experience, strength and hope with other A.A.s around the world through letters, tapes and e-mail.

In addition, there are 551 Loner Sponsors. They are neither "sponsors" nor "Loners" in the traditional sense; they are available to share their A.A. group experience and activities with Loners, Homers and Internationalists through correspondence.

A complimentary literature package is sent to each new LIM member. Each receives a *Loners-Internationalists* and *Homers Directory* and a complimentary subscription to *Box 4-5-9* and the *Loners/Internationalists Meeting-by-Mail*, a bimonthly meeting in print which shares excerpts of letters from LIM participants received at the General Service Office. These bimonthly publications are sent to keep the lone member linked to the Fellowship.

Since January 1999, we have received sharing from every continent except Antarctica, and from over 60 countries, including: Armenia, Australia, Bolivia, Botswana, Cape Verde, China, Egypt, Ethiopia, Georgia, Ghana, India, Israel, Japan, Korea, Lithuania, Maldives, Morocco, Namibia, Nepal, Nigeria, Pago Pago, Papua New Guinea, Philippines, Poland, Romania, Russia, Saudi Arabia, Senegal, Sierra Leone, Solomon Islands, South Africa, Tanzania, Thailand, and Zimbabwe. A.A. truly is a worldwide Fellowship.

Loner Lawrence D. says, "I write with gratitude for my third sober birthday, one day at a time. Thanks to my Higher Power, the A.A. program, the Steps, the Fellowship and the precious Loners who I learn so much from. I'm grateful for the wonderful sharing which kept me going in isolation for more than three years."

No longer alone, Hugh D. of Bethel, Alaska wrote, "You can go ahead and remove my name from the mailing list. I now have a home group! Thanks for the years of meetings in print—they saw me through nearly seven years of sobriety."

Homer Arlette G. from Alberta, Canada writes: "I have been blessed with many wonderful LIM members who write to me regularly. The sharing and understanding has helped me realize that

I am not alone in my alcoholism and I never have to be alone again. Every time I receive a letter, it is a gift of gratitude."

It is a privilege to work on the LIM assignment and to coordinate service for so many A.A. members who show, on a daily basis, courage and commitment to their recovery and to Alcoholics Anonymous under very challenging circumstances.

Rick Walker

NOMINATING

Trustees' committee: The diversity statement recommended by the 1999 Conference Floor Action was implemented in the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedures, and in vacancy announcement letters.

A search for a Class A trustee was made and four excellent "friends of A.A." were interviewed. The committee recommended to the General Service Board that Leonard M. Blumenthal serve as a Class A trustee to replace Peter Roach, who will rotate in 2000.

Based on suggestions made by the General Service Board at a special sharing session, new procedures relating to appointed committee members and consultants were developed and recommended to the General Service Board. After the revised procedures were approved by the General Service Board, the vacancy announcement letter and standard resume form for appointed committee members, and the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedures were revised to reflect the changes.

The committee reviewed a request from the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee for a consultant, and a search is in progress.

We recommended to the trustees' Finance Committee that \$7,000 be budgeted to interview "friends of A.A." to fill vacancies when Gary Glynn and Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D. rotate in 2001.

We also discussed revising the letter announcing a vacancy for a Class A trustee to request information regarding the applicant's "...profound faith in the recovery program upon which the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous is founded." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, Page S60) It was recommended that the following wording be added to the vacancy announcement letter for Class A trustee: "In addition, please provide information as to why this applicant is interested in serving the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous."

The committee reviewed a proposal to utilize computerized tabulation for voting during regional trustee and trustee-at-large elections at the General Service Conference and took no action.

We forwarded to the Conference Committee on Trustees a proposal that the election of a regional trustee be made by regional delegates only. The trustees' Nominating Committee unanimously opposed the proposed change in the electoral procedures for regional trustee and strongly endorsed the current electoral procedures for regional trustee.

The committee recommended to the General Service Board the following nominations: *A.A. World Services Corporate Board* — Beth Rabren, Southwest regional trustee, replacing Jack L. Ostrem; *A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board* — Tony Taschner, Northeast regional trustee, replacing Betty Stevens; and Robert O. Miller, Class A trustee, replacing Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D.

The proposed slates of General Service Board members, officers of the board, A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine directors were forwarded to the 2000 Conference Committee on Trustees for disapproval, if any. The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of trustees to the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April, following presentation at the 2000 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Class A

Leonard M. Blumenthal	Arthur L. Knight, Jr.
Linda L. Chezern	Robert O. Miller, D.D.
Gary A. Glynn	George E. Vaillant, M.D.
Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D.	

Class B

Jim Clough	Beth Rabren
Ric Downey	Dean Rinehart
Marne Hill	Richard Roughton
Jacqueline Johnston	Betty Stevens
Tom Maguire	Ted Stoa
Jack L. Ostrem	Tony Taschner
Alex Palmer	Gregory Tobin

The committee recommended the following slate of officers of the General Service Board to be presented to the 2000 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

<i>Chairperson</i>	Gary A. Glynn
<i>First Vice-Chairperson</i>	Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D.
<i>Second Vice-Chairperson</i>	Linda L. Chezern
<i>Treasurer</i>	Arthur L. Knight, Jr.
<i>Secretary</i>	Betty Stevens
<i>Assistant Treasurer</i>	Donald Meurer
<i>Assistant Secretary</i>	Joanie Moncrief

The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., to be presented to the 2000 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Jim Clough	Greg Muth
Ronald J. Gauthier	Jan Polek
Jacqueline Johnston	Beth Rabren
John C. Koster	Richard Roughton
Joanie Moncrief	

The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of directors of A.A. Grapevine, Inc., to be presented to the 2000 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Susan Campbell	Arnold L. Ross
David V. Every	Ames Sweet
Marne Hill	Tony Taschner
Tom Maguire	Gregory Tobin
Robert O. Miller	

The committee recommended approval of William G. Herold and Jane Starke Lobdell to serve as appointed committee members on the trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee.

Jacqueline Johnston, chairperson

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' committee: The responsibilities of the trustees' Public Information Committee include: creating a greater public understanding of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous; producing television and radio public service announcements; producing films about A.A.; preparing press releases and reports to the public; coordinating health fairs and other community exhibits with local P.I. committees; conducting the A.A. Membership Survey; carrying A.A.'s message through electronic as well as print media.

The committee met three times since the last Conference. Much of the work of this committee was done through a sub-

committee and the Public Information staff coordinator in the office. Following is a list of some of our work over the past year:

- Following up on a suggestion from the 1999 Public Information Conference Committee, the committee appointed a subcommittee to review existing P.I. literature for possible inclusion of text on anonymity at the level of the "Internet." We received the subcommittee's report and expressed appreciation for their efforts. The proposed changes concerning anonymity at the level of the Internet in Conference-approved material were accepted and forwarded to the 2000 Conference Public Information Committee for their consideration. The proposed changes to the service material were accepted and forwarded to the Publications Department for implementation.
- Reviewed and approved the annual media Anonymity Letter mailed to media professionals (English, Spanish and French media outlets) in February 2000.
- Agreed to participate in the 2000 AARP (American Association of Retired Persons) Convention and welcomed this opportunity to bring the A.A. message to a segment of the population who we are seeking to reach.
- Reviewed background from the 1996 and 1998 A.A. Membership Surveys pertaining to Question #17 on the current Survey Questionnaire, "Do you have a physical disability which affects your ability to access, attend or fully participate in regular A.A. meetings?" It determined that the responses to the question are inconclusive and that the question should be removed from future Survey Questionnaires.
- Discussed a suggestion to remove Question #4, regarding race, from the Membership Survey Questionnaire. The committee reaffirmed their earlier motion to forward the Membership Survey Questionnaire, including Question #4, regarding race, to the 2000 Conference Public Information Committee for approval.
- Reviewed the report on responses from local P.I. committee's involved in distributing TV public service announcements and acknowledged with appreciation local efforts. In addition, the committee reviewed the year end P.S.A. distribution summary report, and formed a subcommittee to study alternative distribution methods.
- Discussed a suggestion from a group to discontinue television P.S.A.s, as that group felt that they promote A.A. The committee concluded that the current practice is in accordance with the spirit and letter of our Traditions.
- Reviewed extensive background material and met with the trustees' Archives Committee and representatives of A.A.W.S. and A.A. Grapevine to discuss the issue of our co-founders' anonymity. The committee continues to work on formulating a clear statement of this issue as it relates to its work.

Robert Miller, chairperson

Staff report: The goal of the Public Information assignment is to help to carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic, potential alcoholic and the general public through the media, health fairs, schools and G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site. A crucial part of Public Information work here at G.S.O. is to act as a resource and central repository of the sharing from P.I. Committees throughout the U.S. and Canada. Throughout the year the staff member and a staff assistant respond to hundreds of written and telephone inquiries that come in from the general public and the Fellowship. The staff member is also responsible for handling interviews with the media describing what A.A. is and what it can and cannot do. The assignment provides accurate and consistent information to the media, researchers, students and the general public about Alcoholics Anonymous.

Four times a year, the staff member communicates with over 500 P.I. Committee chairpeople at the area, district, intergroup/



central office and group level. All new Public Information chair-people are sent a "welcome" letter and receive the P.I. Kit and Workbook, A.A. Guidelines on Public Information, P.I. Discount Package Order Form, Box 4-5-9, as well as current P.I. information from the staff member. The results of the A.A. Membership Survey are also made available in display board and pamphlet formats to local P.I. committees.

During the past year, literature has been provided for a large number of local health and community fairs. In many cases, local Public Information committees provide this literature and participate in these events. Whenever possible, we try to connect the community resource with local P.I. committees, so that there can be a local group conscience decision about how A.A. can best participate in these local events. The Public Information staff person made available to local P.I. committees, in addition to the P.S.A. scripts, the service piece "Suggestions for Working with Your Local Television and Radio Stations to Help Carry the Message," to encourage and help committees set up P.S.A. contacts at local TV and radio stations. As a way of helping committees become familiar with the content of our P.S.A.s, a compilation copy of all the TV P.S.A.s was formatted onto VHS tape for use by those P.I. committees interested in distributing radio and TV P.S.A.s.

The P.I. desk receives information regarding anonymity breaks at the level of press, radio or film and most recently the Internet. If the local area is identified, this information is forwarded to area delegates. The delegate chooses whether to respond to each anonymity break on a case-by-case basis. In the past twelve months, approximately 46 articles were forwarded to area delegates. In February, all new Conference delegates were sent a letter explaining our procedures for forwarding anonymity break information to local delegates.

The annual Anonymity Letter to Media, including a return postcard for those professionals who wish additional information about A.A., was mailed in February to media outlets in the U.S. and Canada (English, Spanish and French) as follows: daily newspapers and wire services, 1,624; weekly newspapers, 4,500; AM/FM radio stations, 835; TV stations, networks and cable services, 5,775; all black publications, 228; all Hispanic publications, 167; the total mailing was 8,149.

We responded to numerous requests from newspaper, magazine, TV and radio professionals for information about Alcoholics Anonymous or information on subjects related to alcoholism. We referred inquiries not directly related to A.A. to the appropriate source. We also reviewed movie, television and radio scripts to see that references to A.A. were accurate and in keeping with our Traditions. We declined to comment on controversial issues in keeping with our Tenth Tradition of not entering into public controversy. In this instance, Alcoholics Anonymous is unique in that Public Information succeeds when we do not get media attention. Just as the strongest Twelve Step with the alcoholic is often the quiet power of our own sobriety, in dealing with the media, we try to present A.A. in a courteous and dignified manner. As our Eleventh Tradition reminds us: "Our public relations policy is based on attraction, rather than promotion . . ."

The success of any Public Information work at G.S.O. is measured in the same way as any other A.A. service: are we doing all that we can to see that the A.A. message is available to all, as we strive to see that information conveyed about A.A. is accurate and easy to understand.

Bill Archer

SERVICE MATERIAL

Staff report: To assist groups, the General Service Office provides service material to the Fellowship, based on an indicated need, to provide information and share experience not found in Conference-approved literature. A four-page list describes the service items in detail. Examples of service material include: Regional Forum Reports; A.A. Guidelines; Referral List of Fellowships Similar to A.A.; a catalog of A.A. Literature and Audiovisual Material for Special Needs. Current ongoing projects involving Service Material:

- Coordination of three A.A. Directories: Eastern U.S., Western U.S. and Canadian. The staff member on Service Material/Regional Forums works closely with the Special Projects manager regarding directories and central/intergroup offices' records and lists.

- Supervision of G.S.O. Service files. There is a variety of service material available, upon request, to A.A. members, groups, and for service workshops.
- Supervision/production of service material such as A.A. Guidelines, Group Handbooks, and G.S.R. Kits.
- Liaison with intergroup/central offices, including serving on the Policy and Site Committees of the Fifteenth Intergroup Seminar, which will next take place in Little Rock, Arkansas, October 2000.

Doug Richardson

SPANISH SERVICES

Staff report: Throughout the years, G.S.O. has provided services in several languages, including Spanish. But it was not until 1984 that the assignment of Spanish Services was formally initiated. In our general service structure there are more than 40,000 Spanish-speaking A.A. members. They meet in 1,500 groups in the U.S., Puerto Rico and Canada. The Spanish Services staff person, who does not rotate, coordinates and interfaces with the rest of the staff assignments and assists in providing services to the Spanish-speaking community which are as equal as possible to the services provided to English-speaking A.A. groups. All these groups that register with the G.S.O. in New York receive the Group Handbook, and every G.S.R. its corresponding kit, in Spanish. D.C.M.s also receive their service kit in Spanish, and each group receives a copy of *Box 4-5-9* in Spanish.

As more bilingual people come into A.A., communication between the Spanish- and English-speaking groups is improving. The groups are represented by G.S.R.s at district meetings, where they elect bilingual D.C.M.s who represent the districts at area assemblies. Many Spanish-speaking districts have been added recently to the areas in our service structure, and continue to grow in other parts of our Conference. Many service pieces are now available in Spanish, among them the General Service Board's *Quarterly Report*, with highlights of its activities, as well as the A.A.W.S. monthly report. The Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9* in Spanish is immediately available upon completion of our Conference, and a list of preliminary and final Conference Agenda items is distributed in Spanish to all delegates and alternate delegates.

The staff member on this assignment works closely with the two in-house translators, assisting, developing, updating and revising literature, pamphlets, and so on. More and more Conference-approved literature is published in Spanish by our Publications Department. All correspondence in Spanish from U.S.A./Canada comes to the Spanish Services desk and the Spanish Services coordinator also helps answer correspondence received in Spanish by most other assignments, especially by the International desk. The Spanish Services staff member may attend regional meetings, such as the Meeting of the Americas, World Service Meetings, Regional Forums, and many other activities in the Spanish-speaking world of A.A.

Danny Mooney

STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: Services to A.A. groups are the heartbeat of the General Service Office. Eleven A.A. members comprise the "G.S.O. Staff" with each person responsible for a functional assignment in addition to responding to requests from a specific region of Canada and the U.S., or from other countries. In 1999, the staff received 22,260 such requests by phone, mail, fax and e-mail. The staff coordinator helps to assure that letters are answered when staff members are involved in large projects, away from the office to attend large A.A. events, or at times of ill-

ness or vacation. Last year, staff participated in more than 90 conventions, assemblies, roundups and Regional Forums, where we provided information on services available through G.S.O. and gathered shared experiences to bring back to the office to be used to benefit other groups.

The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of staff trips to area assemblies, conventions, Regional Forums, and other large A.A. events, making sure that the office is adequately covered at all times. To further assure that the work flow is smooth and adequately covered, assignments are divided into two units. Unit A consists of Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, International Convention, Literature, Public Information and Treatment Facilities. Unit B includes Conference, Regional Forums/Service Material, International, Spanish Services and staff coordinator.

G.S.O. staff has the benefit of the experiences of A.A. groups gathered over many years, resources that are passed on to members who seek guidance for their group, central office, district or area assembly. Ideas received from the Fellowship are often brought to weekly staff meetings, chaired by the staff coordinator, where we focus on problems best addressed by a group conscience. Our weekly meetings also provide a forum for sharing ideas on ways to further improve services to A.A. groups and members.

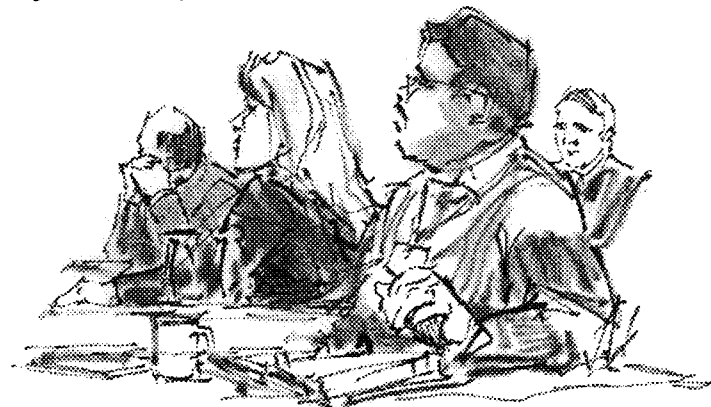
To fill a vacancy created by the retirement of long-time staff member Richard Bush, last summer we initiated the established process for selecting a new staff person. We were indeed fortunate to have Rick Walker join the G.S.O. staff in November. Criteria for applicants who want to be considered for an opening in the G.S.O. staff are: a minimum of six years sobriety, professional background, communication skills and A.A. service experience. The staff coordinator is involved with training new staff.

Each G.S.O. staff member serves as secretary to a Conference Committee and is a voting member of the General Service Conference. The staff coordinator is secretary to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.

During 1999, we welcomed 1,097 visitors to G.S.O. from around the world. Each visitor had an opportunity to see and hear "how G.S.O. works" during a tour of G.S.O. and Grapevine offices. Often visiting members and guests attend the weekly "open" A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on Fridays.

As assistant secretary of the General Service Board, the staff coordinator is responsible for scheduling committee meetings, distributing advance materials, preparing the minutes of the General Service Board meetings and the Quarterly Report, a summary of the boards' activities. The staff coordinator is also a director of A.A. World Services, Inc. in accordance with Concept IV, and serves as liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments. None of these activities would be possible without the assistance of very capable support staff.

Joanie Moncrief



Reports from the A.A. Grapevine

Directors' report: The Grapevine Board met six times since the 49th General Service Conference. The Grapevine Board holds four formal meetings yearly — three take place during General Service Board Weekends and another the week of the annual General Service Conference. During board meetings, a large agenda of policy and financial matters is placed before the board. In addition to the more structured meetings, the Grapevine Board holds four less formal planning meetings each year to focus on matters which may require long discussion. The hurricane which struck New Jersey last September prevented the board from holding its fall meeting in Newark.

On an as needed basis, the board holds telephone conference calls. Some are held to discuss matters that cannot wait until the entire group is in the New York area, while others are held to pre-plan agenda items which will come before the board when next it meets. Several years ago, the Grapevine Board initiated an annual March conference call with the entire Grapevine Conference Committee. This call, held just weeks before the Conference, allows the two bodies to get acquainted and to facilitate the flow of information.

Board Structure — In January the Grapevine Board put forth the name of Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee Bob Miller to replace Class A trustee Elaine Johnson, who will be rotating off the Grapevine Board after many years of service. The name of regional trustee Tony Taschner was forwarded to succeed Betty Stevens who will rotate from the board following this year's Conference. For a year the board has had an unfilled vacancy for a nontrustee directorship and another vacancy occurs with the rotation of Ray Stiver. In January the board put forth the names of past delegates Susan Campbell and Arnold Ross to fill these positions. The board has also forwarded the name of Marne Hill, regional trustee/Canada, to succeed general service trustee Tom Maguire as chair of the Grapevine Corporate Board following the 2000 Conference.

The Grapevine Office — July 1, 1999 saw the completion and final implementation of the Office Reorganization Plan. We have replaced the old Circulation and Bookkeeping Departments with the new Order Department, under the supervision of Mary Pat Hester (with her new title of director of Operations and Circulation), and the Finance Department, under supervision of

controller Bob Slotterback. Principal to the reorganization is the formation of a Customer Relations Team within the Order Department, which will be responsible for all customer services related to both subscriptions and special orders.

One cannot minimize the splendid work done by Grapevine controller Bob Slotterback. An important tool used by all magazine publishers is the "Bill Me Later" option. Making it as easy as possible for A.A.s to subscribe was seen as a surefire circulation booster, but what about bad-debt levels? Bob did an analysis of the costs involved in offering the "Bill Me" subscription option, and the actual income and circulation we derive from it. This was risky territory for the Grapevine, but Bob's thorough analysis was examined by our auditors who found that the option provided us with far more benefit than loss.

Grapevine Web site — The Grapevine Web site has been in operation since March 1998. During the summer of 1999 Maggie Keogh became Web site manager/Special Projects coordinator. One of Maggie's first challenges was to implement a secure network for ordering Grapevine materials on-line. This has turned out to be one of the bright lights for the Grapevine during 1999 with subscriptions and related item sales reaching \$27,000 for the month of October alone. Trends for the new year indicate that on-line subscriptions and especially audio tape sales will continue to grow during 2000.

Millennium Issue — A collectors item went to press as the Grapevine unveiled its 96 page Millennium Issue. Centered around the topic "A.A. in the Next Millennium," this special issue featured 11 articles on A.A. in the past century and Millennium to come, plus three terrific articles on Archives, including a 1996 Conference presentation by "The Happy Archivist," the late Frank Mauser.

New Grapevine Book Ready for Minneapolis — With the clock ticking down to the International Convention, work continues on the new book from the Grapevine, *A.A. Around the World: Adventures in Recovery*. The book will be a centerpiece at the International Convention Grapevine Booth and, at merely \$5.00 dollars, brisk sales are expected.

Finance 1999 Results — The Grapevine ended 1999 with a loss on operations, before the Spanish Magazine Project and the French Literature Services, of \$21,891. This was less than the





budgeted loss of \$29,698 and \$23,316 less than our actual losses in 1998. Among reasons for this improved financial situation were the efforts of Grapevine management to streamline internal operations. This resulted in greater efficiency and fewer costly overtime hours. In addition, circulation director & operations manager Mary Pat Hester moved our magazine fulfillment operation to a different firm bringing us a substantial savings in delivering the magazine to subscribers.

Magazine circulation for 1999 was budgeted at 117,000 copies per month, however circulation declined to 115,951 copies per month. On this circulation, the Grapevine realized \$1,427,041. Gross profit on the magazine was \$1,063,881, higher than the budgeted amount of \$1,032,598. Gross profit on related items was \$272,328, down from our hoped for \$349,665.

On the cost side, editorial costs were \$300,284, considerably below the budgeted figure for 1999 of \$340,885. Circulation and business expenses were \$1,054,772, slightly higher than the budgeted amount of \$1,046,665. Total costs and expenses for the year 1999 were \$1,448,932 and substantially less than the budgeted expenses of \$1,503,757.

La Viña showed circulation growth, reaching approximately 8,000 copies per bimonthly issue versus a 1999 budget of 7,500 copies per issue. Total La Viña magazine income was \$58,569 and better than the budgeted total magazine of \$55,394.

The board approved a budget for the Grapevine in the year 2000 that projects a loss of \$67,143. Among items contributing to this larger budgeted loss are salary increases. A salary freeze at the Grapevine was seriously considered; however, members of the Grapevine Board, the trustees' Finance Committee and the General Service Board felt that penalizing the Grapevine Staff with a one-year freeze would yield little in long-term solutions—and a four percent increase was budgeted for the year 2000. Escalating health insurance costs are a topic in every organization in the United States and the Grapevine is not exempt there. We have found it necessary to budget a 7% increase in health insurance benefit costs.

Obviously, paper is a substantial budget item for the A.A. Grapevine. We anticipate a possible increase during May and have budgeted for a 5% increase. To help us along this line, we have changed the grade of paper used for the magazine cover and this will help us stem increasing costs.

For La Viña, the budgeted loss for the year 2000 is \$66,214. For the year 1999 we had actually budgeted a \$69,602 loss; however, our Spanish editor left the magazine, saving a portion of that budgeted salary expense. I must add here that Ames and his staff stepped in and worked very hard to produce a quality Spanish-language magazine. The 500 copy bimonthly increase in circulation is testimony to that hard work. Obviously, La Viña is subject to the same inflationary pressures as the Grapevine and salary, paper and other costs put pressure on the year 2000 budget.

I have been privileged to serve as a director on the Grapevine Board since 1993—four years as a nontrustee director, three years as a trustee and seven years now as a Conference member. I can report to this Conference that in all the years, I have never seen a harder working Grapevine Board. Our Concepts tell us very plainly that we must operate our active-service corporations on a business model to ensure that we have the resources to provide our vital world services. The Grapevine Board, Grapevine Management, the trustees' Finance Committee and the General Service Board have spent 1999, and now 2000, engaged in very intense efforts to analyze the Grapevine operation and to plan whatever steps are needed to ensure that the Grapevine continues to be the independent voice of Alcoholics Anonymous. Currently, we are meeting with magazine fulfillment companies and exploring our various options to out source most noneditorial and non-A.A. service functions. Assuming all goes as hoped, our schedule calls for many of these cost cutting functions to be in place and fully operational in the early months of 2001.

We are all sitting in this room, 50 years and 50 General Service Conferences later, thanks in no small part to the existence of the A.A. Grapevine, and Bill's constant use of the magazine to build

support for this Conference as A.A. came of age. Needless to say, countless thousands have gotten the A.A. message from our meeting in print. The Grapevine Board and management asks for your support and prayers as we work to strengthen this vital world service.

Tom Maguire, chairperson

Staff report: The A.A. Grapevine has had many new and exciting developments in 1999-2000. News from the editorial department includes a new feature in the magazine, the Editor's Note, written by executive editor Ames Sweet, which presents material and information not now covered in the magazine and in a more informal way. January 2000 saw the publication of a special 96-page Millennium Issue that included special sections on A.A. Archives and A.A. in the New Millennium, an interview with the A.A.W.S. Director of Publications, and an editors' report on our 1999 Readership Survey. The survey was bound into the April 1999 issue and went out to over 117,337 readers. Close to 6,000 readers sat down and responded to the survey, giving the Grapevine a useful profile of its readership in terms of age, gender, and interests, as well as a wealth of suggestions for future material.

In spring 1999, Maggie Keogh became special projects coordinator/Web site manager and redesigned and improved both the Web site's graphics and content. It is now possible to place secure orders for Grapevine subscriptions and other materials from the new on-line catalog; the on-line ordering capability produced, in its first few months of operation, over 1,300 orders placed by more than 440 visitors. Another new feature is a bulletin board that allows Web site visitors to post messages on subjects related to the Grapevine magazine. The Web site also offers highlights of the upcoming issue, encourages correspondence and manuscript submission (via hard copy or e-mail), gives news of related material, and provides a Spanish-language description of La Viña. The Web site address is: < www.aagrapevine.org >

In July 1999, the Bookkeeping and Circulation Departments were reorganized into a consolidated Order Department and a separate Finance Department. At that time, Mary Pat Hester became director of Operations and Circulation, with Jeff Monasch assuming the new role of customer relations coordinator for both subscriptions and related items. This "one-stop shopping" concept allows Grapevine customers to get help by making one phone call, regardless of the nature of their business. A customer relations team, with three team members doing rotating dedicated service, has greatly improved efficiency and customer relations response. At our new "mail opening desk," a staff member maintains a daily mail count broken down by category, thus improving our ability to track fulfillment operations throughout the year.

In her capacity as circulation director, Mary Pat has continued to "aggressively attract" readers through a variety of strategies. A treatment facilities mailing in June 1999 produced a 4.16% response rate, including quite a few orders from treatment facilities for the Native American population. Improving renewal rates continues to be of critical importance, and in September 1999, a new four-effort renewal series, designed with the creative assistance of art director Ken Chaya, was launched. And more than 37 areas responded to the GvR Network Half-Price Offer which gave them the opportunity to purchase half-price subscriptions for the Grapevine and La Viña for institutional service work.

In 1999, Grapevine staff members attended many A.A. events around the country, including five Regional Forums. Executive editor Ames Sweet also attended the Special Forum in Window Rock, Arizona.

Cynthia Keyworth, senior editor

GRAPEVINE CIRCULATION — GEOGRAPHICAL BREAKDOWN

	CIRCULATION		INCREASE/ DECREASE	
	APRIL 2000	APRIL 1999		
UNITED STATES*				
Alabama	1,071	1,122	—	51
Alaska	504	547	—	43
Arizona	1,780	1,711		69
Arkansas	667	664		3
California	12,067	12,209	—	142
Colorado	1,768	1,763		5
Connecticut	1,909	1,893		16
Delaware	446	431		15
District of Columbia	214	231	—	17
Florida	5,591	5,635	—	44
Georgia	2,593	2,583		10
Hawaii	542	521		21
Idaho	636	631		5
Illinois	4,406	4,393		13
Indiana	1,614	1,625	—	11
Iowa	1,308	1,348	—	40
Kansas	1,347	1,393	—	46
Kentucky	996	1,009	—	13
Louisiana	1,100	1,040		60
Maine	692	722	—	30
Maryland	1,550	1,537		13
Massachusetts	3,263	3,301	—	38
Michigan	3,596	3,604	—	8
Minnesota	2,648	2,712	—	64
Mississippi	702	699		3
Missouri	1,946	1,928		18
Montana	651	641		10
Nebraska	1,073	1,088	—	15
Nevada	814	724		90
New Hampshire	738	767	—	29
New Jersey	2,868	2,976	—	108
New Mexico	686	697	—	11
New York	6,615	6,974	—	359
North Carolina	2,468	2,621	—	153
North Dakota	385	437	—	52
Ohio	3,328	3,320		8
Oklahoma	1,155	1,267	—	112
Oregon	1,470	1,420		50
Pennsylvania	5,009	4,902		107
Rhode Island	426	453	—	27
South Carolina	1,170	1,154		16
South Dakota	436	402		34
Tennessee	1,431	1,465	—	34
Texas	4,914	4,943	—	29
Utah	659	622		37
Vermont	400	413	—	13
Virginia	2,275	2,396	—	121
Washington	3,184	3,171		13
West Virginia	441	471	—	30
Wisconsin	2,631	2,712	—	81
Wyoming	329	328		1
Puerto Rico	44	55	—	11
U.S. Possessions	18	22	—	4
Subtotal U.S.	<u>100,574</u>	<u>101,693</u>		<u>—1,119</u>
CANADA				
Alberta/NWT	903	957	—	54
British Columbia/Ykn	1,044	1,057	—	13
Manitoba	366	382	—	16
New Brunswick/ Prince Edward Island	321	354	—	33
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	497	496		1
Ontario	3,236	3,083		153
Quebec	221	217		4
Saskatchewan	433	471	—	38
Subtotal Canada	<u>7,021</u>	<u>7,017</u>		<u>4</u>
FOREIGN				
	<u>1,755</u>	<u>1,686</u>		<u>69</u>
Grand Total*	<u>109,350</u>	<u>110,396</u>		<u>—1,046</u>

(*exclusive of monthly orders)

Literature Distributed - 1999

ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	405,119
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft cover)	344,913
Alcoholics Anonymous (large print)	20,880
Alcoholics Anonymous (pocket abridged)	101,869
Daily Reflections	121,606
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. ed.)	166,963
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift ed.)	13,744
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (soft cover)	136,219
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (large print)	9,493
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (pocket ed.)	46,938
A.A. Comes of Age	12,240
As Bill Sees It	43,811
As Bill Sees It (soft cover)	19,770
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	10,558
"Pass It On"	11,067
Total	1,465,190

Booklets

The A.A. Service Manual/ Twelve Concepts for World Service	34,317
Living Sober	140,417
Came to Believe	70,582
A.A. in Prisons: Inmate to Inmate	21,782
Total	267,098

Pamphlets

A.A. and the Armed Services	7,838
A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic	26,582
A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional	31,683
A.A. for the Native North American	15,442
A.A. for the Woman	115,112
The A.A. Group	80,831
A.A. in Your Community	52,738
A.A. in Correctional Facilities	27,118
A.A. in Treatment Facilities	25,408
The A.A. Membership Survey	70,744
The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs	106,305
A.A. Tradition - How It Developed	35,035
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	15,179
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	110,514
Circles of Love and Service	35,847
Bridging the Gap	24,385
Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.	23,451
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	18,899
Do You Think You're Different?	122,740
44 Questions	241,481
G.S.R.	43,491
Grapevine — Our Meeting in Print	8,846
How A.A. Members Cooperate	15,757
How It Works	60,797
If You Are a Professional	42,537
Inside A.A.	43,237
Is A.A. for You?	330,877
Is A.A. for Me?	103,612
Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?	21,684
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	89,367
It Happened to Alice	53,714
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	50,855
The Jack Alexander Article	26,064

Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	15,257
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	73,533
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	52,973
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	37,109
A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators	18,506
A Newcomer Asks	273,588
Problems Other Than Alcohol	112,843
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	247,226
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	19,436
The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated	35,905
The Twelve Steps Illustrated	81,283
Twelve Tradition Flyer	8,055
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	47,842
This Is A.A.	258,238
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	18,313
Time to Start Living	61,512
Time to Start Living (large print)	6,788
Too Young?	81,823
Understanding Anonymity	59,859
What Happened to Joe	58,462
Young People and A.A.	115,223
Total	3,761,944

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards-two-fold	367,632
Wallet cards-I Am Responsible	50,961
Wallet cards-Anonymity	40,600
Anonymity Display Card	2,884
Parchment-scrolls	2,851
Placards	451
C.P.C. Workbook	1,155
Correctional Facilities Workbook	1,060
P.I. Workbook	1,483
Treatment Facilities Workbook	212
Treatment Facility Handbook	2,195
Big Book on computer disk	986
Twelve and Twelve on Computer Disk	663
A.A. Guidelines	65,392
Group Handbook	2,182
Wire Racks	1,947
Cassettes (tape cassettes)	2,162
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	4,738
A.A. Comes of Age (cassette album)	391
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	2,322
TV Public Service Announcement	540
Radio Public Service Announcements	419
Twelve Steps Shade displays	1,788
Twelve Traditions Shade displays	1,742
Fact File	2,208
Table Top Display 12 & 12	490
Total	559,454
Grand Total	6,053,686

SPANISH

Books & Booklets

Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous soft cover)	22,320
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous hardcover)	5,407
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous abridged pocket size)	5,353

Como Lo Ve Bill (As Bill Sees It)	4,695
A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad (A.A. Comes of Age)	4,479
El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	3,166
Transmitelo (Pass it On)	4,293
Reflexiones Diarias (Daily Reflections)	7,848
Viviendo Sobrio (Living Sober)	12,319
El Manual de Servicios de A.A./Doce Conceptos para el Servicio Mundial (A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts)	3,021
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions)	21,001
Llegamos a Creer (Came to Believe)	6,781
A.A. en Prisiones de Preso a Preso (Inmate to Inmate)	6,208
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (pocket ed.)	5,074
Total	111,965

Pamphlets

A.A. en Su Comunidad (A.A. in Your Community)	8,706
44 Preguntas (44 Questions)	22,577
Esto es A.A. (This is A.A.)	22,363
Es A.A. para Usted? (Is A.A. for You?)	53,809
Carta a una Mujer Alcohólica (Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)	5,496
Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	5,269
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser Un Alcohólico (Memo to an Inmate)	4,445
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A. (A Member's-Eye View)	3,612
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander (Jack Alexander Article)	3,287
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Medicas por Bill W. (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	3,668
Un Principiante Pregunta (A Newcomer Asks)	11,016
Como Trabaja el Programa (How It Works)	7,154
Lo que le Sucedió a José (What Happened to Joe)	9,931
Comprendiendo el Anonimato (Understanding Anonymity)	3,958
El Grupo de A.A. (The A.A. Group)	10,240
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	9,221
El Miembro de A.A. - Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas (The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs)	6,209
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	4,328
A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento (A.A. in Treatment Centers)	2,794
Los Jóvenes y A.A. (Young People and A.A.)	10,389
La Tradición de A.A. - ¿Cómo se Desarrolló? (A.A. Tradition - How It Developed)	2,219
Una Breve Guía a A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	7,172
A.A. en las Instituciones Correccionales (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	3,711
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	9,897
Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda (It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell)	4,736
¿Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.? (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	2,665
Dentro de A.A. (Inside A.A.)	2,850
A.A. como Recurso para los Profesionales de la Salud (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	3,069
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A. (The Clergy Asks)	2,335

R.S.G. (G.S.R.)	3,430
¿Se Cree Usted Diferente? (Do You Think Your Different?)	5,926
Le Sucedió a Alicia (It Happened to Alice)	6,215
Hablando en Reuniones no-A.A. Speaking at non-A.A. Meetings	2,383
A.A. Para la Mujer (A.A. for the Woman)	5,617
Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A. (A.A. Membership Survey)	1,274
A.A. y los Programas de Alcoholismo Empresariales (A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs)	3,251
Es A.A. Para Mi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	9,385
Tiempo Para Empezar a Vivir (Time to Start Living)	2,844
Los Doce Pasos Ilustrados (The Twelve Steps Illustrated)	4,931
Círculos de Amor y Servicio (Circles of Love & Service)	3,140
Uniendo las Orillas (Bridging the Gap)	1,840
Los Doce Conceptos Ilustrados (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	2,555
A.A. para los alcohólicos gays/lesbianas (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	1,257
Total	301,174

Miscellaneous

Guias (Guidelines)	6,217
Parchments, Spanish	719
Tarjetas Tamaño Billetera (wallet cards)	14,346
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cassette album) (Big Book on cassette)	671
Los Doce Pasos (cassette album) (Twelve Steps on cassette)	755
Total	22,708
Grand Total	435,847

FRENCH

Livres (Books)

Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format relie)	3,603
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format souple)	2,031
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format poche)	936
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format relie)	1,175
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format souple)	2,749
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format poche)	853
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte (A.A. Comes of Age)	486
Reflexions de Bill (As Bill Sees It)	3,591
Reflexions Quotidiennes (Daily Reflections)	3,693
Dr Bob et les pionniers (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	725
Total	19,842

Plaquettes (Booklets)

Nous en sommes venus a croire (Came to Believe)	1,482
Vivre ... sans alcool! (Living Sober)	1,967
Le Manuel du Service et les Douze Concepts	1,723
Total	5,172

Brochures (Pamphlets)

Voici les A.A. (This is A.A.)	10,997
Les A.A.: 44 Questions (44 Questions)	1,125
Les A.A.: sont-ils pour vous? (Is A.A. for You?)	14,470
Les A.A. pour la femme (A.A. for the Woman)	977
Collaboration des membres des A.A. (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	229
Les A.A. et les programmes d'aide aux employes (A.A. & Employee Assistance Programs)	405
Le membre des A.A. face aux medicaments et a la drogue (The A.A. Member - Medications & Other Drugs)	1,149
Les A.A. - Article du Saturday Evening Post (The Jack Alexander Article)	279
Collaborons avec nos amis (Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends)	170
Questions et reponses sur le parrainage (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	1,684
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les medecins (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	558
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement (A.A. in Treatment Facilities)	275
La Tradition des A.A. et son developpement (A.A. Tradition/How It Developed)	1,142
Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme? (If You Are a Professional)	228
L'Histoire de Nicole (It Happened to Alice)	423
Jean face a son probleme d'alcool (What Happened to Joe)	389
Les A.A. dans votre milieu (A.A. in Your Community)	797
Problemes autres que l'alcoolisme (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	2,453
Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A. (A Member's-Eye View of A.A.)	409
Les Douze Traditions illustrees (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	1,280
Les A.A. dans les etablissements correctionnels (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	556
Ca vaut mieux que de languir en prison (It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell)	570
Petit guide pratique sur les A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	1,106
Les membres du clerge se renseignent (Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.)	483
Les deux fondateurs d'A.A. (The Co-founders of A.A.)	654
Message a l'intention d'un detenu (Memo to an Inmate)	915
Message aux Dir. d'Etabl. Correctionnels (Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators)	175
Le groupe des A.A. (The A.A. Group)	1,970
Les Douze Concepts illustres (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	601
Le sens de l'anonymat (Understanding Anonymity)	974
Trois causeries a des societes medicales (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	453
Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	1,401
Le R.S.G. (The G.S.R.)	1,553

Causeries a l'exterieur des A.A.

(Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings)	299
Trop jeune? (Too Young?)	1,396
La Structure de l'Association des A.A. (Inside A.A.)	1,297
L'Heritage des Services des A.A. (A.A.'s Legacy of Service)	238
Cercles d'amour et de service (Circles of Love & Service)	1,455
Vous croyez-vous different? (Do You Think You're Different?)	936
Lettre a une femme alcoolique (Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)	654
Sondage sur les membres des A.A. (The A.A. Membership Survey)	1,380
Les jeunes et les A.A. (Young People & A.A.)	874
Votre B.S.G. (Your G.S.O.)	1,371
Il est encore temps de vivre (Time to Start Living)	1,069
Un nouveau veut savoir (A Newcomer Asks)	3,663
Les A.A. sont-ils pour moi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	877
Favoriser de rapprochement (Bridging the Gap)	525
Les Douze Etapes Illustrees (Twelve Steps Illustrated)	1,762
Les A.A. et les gais et lesbiennes alcooliques (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	383
Les A.A. et les Autochtones d'Amerique du Nord (A.A. and the Native North American)	238
Total	69,267

Lignes de conduite A.A. (Guidelines)	Total	2,648
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Divers (Miscellaneous)

12 & 12 (cassette album)	60
Le Gros Livre (cassettes album)	84
Carte 12 Etapes/12 Traditions (Wallet card 12 Steps & 12 Traditions)	1,525
Carte anonymat (Francais/anglais) (Anonymity wallet card)	36
Cassettes	30
Notre Methode (How It Works)	3,288
Manuel de Groupe	43
Manuel de l'Information Publique	12
Manuel des Centres de Detention	1
Manuel de la CMP	3
Priere Serenite (Carte) (Serenity Prayer wallet card)	13,226
Manuel des Centres de Traitement	1
Dossier d'Information sur les A.A. (Fact File)	401
Total	18,710
Grand Total	115,639



Area Service Highlights — Panel 50 Delegates

(Only first-term delegates give Area Highlights.)

Alaska: Area 2 consists of 204 groups (down 33 from 1998) with more than 3,000 members served by 13 districts, ten of which are active; we have 656,000 square miles to carry the message. We hold two assemblies and either a state roundup or election assembly each year. Since we cannot drive to all the cities, towns and villages in this great state we must rely on air travel. It is an enormous challenge serving an area twice the size of Texas with less than 1/10 of the roads. For the past 20 years we have discussed the road system of doing business at the area level; we even talk about two areas, the Interior and Southeast — but it all came down to money! It's hard enough to support one delegate let alone two. For the past two years Districts 9 and 10 (Southeast Alaska) have reported 100% participation at district meetings via teleconferencing, a savings of hundreds of dollars in transportation cost. That hundred-dollar bill got that G.S.R. to his/her district meeting, but so far nothing has replaced the face-to-face sharing that comes with one alcoholic helping another. We are always attempting to increase service involvement with a committee system that mirrors the Conference committees. Our goal is to foster unity and recovery through an effective service structure. — *Harold Peterson*

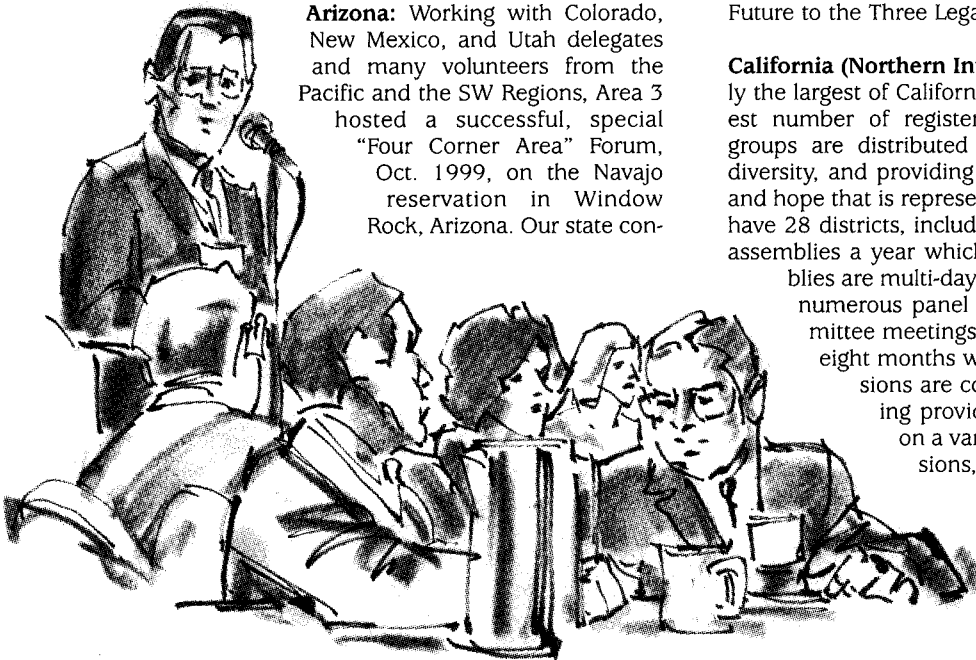
Alberta/Northwest Territories: Area 78 has 565 groups spread over 50 districts, which includes the province of Alberta, a portion of the Northwest Territories west of the 49th parallel, and the east Kootenays and Peace River block of British Columbia. At the fall assembly, guidelines were put forth for discussion involving redistricting within an area. We have a Webmaster and a Web site that has been up and running for about a year and a half. Last year our chairman for Remote Communities was from the NWT and his wife, fluent in other dialects, has translated the Serenity Prayer into Inuktitut. Our Archives is housed at the Central Office in Edmonton and makes the rounds at various events. We employ the Committee System and it is working very well. We meet four times a year. It's a privilege to serve the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous and have a chance to work with so many devoted members on finding ways to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. — *Carol Readman*

Arizona: Working with Colorado, New Mexico, and Utah delegates and many volunteers from the Pacific and the SW Regions, Area 3 hosted a successful, special "Four Corner Area" Forum, Oct. 1999, on the Navajo reservation in Window Rock, Arizona. Our state con-

tains a large Native American population and we have been actively involved in translating portions of the Big Book, Preamble, and Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions into Navajo. We have an active Spanish panel at the area level and the regular use of translation equipment at assemblies has aided in enhancing communication. The Remote Communities Committees throughout Arizona have begun to develop excellent resources and contacts and have furthered our efforts toward increased participation. We conduct area business and address Conference topics through the panel system. There are nine panels to which groups, districts, county districts and intergroups are randomly assigned. In March the assembly addresses Conference topics; May, the delegate's report back; August, area business; and in November we approve the budget. A.A. services are provided area-wide by the seven elected and two appointed coordinators of the standing committees: Archives; C.P.C.; C.F.; G.V.; Literature; Meeting List; Newsletter; P.I.; and T.F. Our structure is solid and so is our commitment to carrying the message. — *Vicky Jo Bigelow*

California (Mid-Southern): Area 9 has approximately 62,661 members in over 2,000 groups, with 23 districts, five of which are Spanish, with a total of 67 subdistricts. The area officers and the delegate visit the districts every month. We have three area assemblies and six area service committee meetings during the year. Other activities include the pre-Conference workshop, our Spanish Foro de MSCA, the Heritage Day and the Servathon. We have 12 standing committees with nine Spanish co-chairs and there are seven English and two Spanish H&I committees. Our central offices and intergroups consist of eight English and five Spanish. Twice a year C.P.C. and P.I. set up the Professional View of A.A. Literature which is translated into Spanish, and wherever needed simultaneous translation is provided. This year we will hold the first G.S.R. Appreciation Day. La Viña has an excellent distribution in our area and our Spanish districts are working hard on subscriptions. We look forward to serving at the International Convention in Minneapolis. Until then, may The Higher Power help us all in doing what we do best to carry the message to the alcoholic that is still suffering by "Trusting Our Future to the Three Legacies of A.A." — *Al Perez*

California (Northern Interior): Although Area 7 is geographically the largest of California's five delegate areas, it has the smallest number of registered groups. These approximately 700 groups are distributed throughout the area, representing its diversity, and providing a cross-section of experience, strength and hope that is representative of our Fellowship as a whole. We have 28 districts, including two Spanish districts, and hold four assemblies a year which are rotated. Three of our four assemblies are multi-day events allowing G.S.R.s to participate in numerous panel and roundtable discussions. Area committee meetings are held in a centralized location in the eight months without an assembly. D.C.M. sharing sessions are conducted at each area committee meeting providing a forum for the exchange of ideas on a variety of topics. These D.C.M. sharing sessions, together with an increased G.S.R. participation at assemblies, help our area's spiritual growth and unity by keeping our members involved and stressing the importance of information, education, and commitment as we "Come of Age" as an area. — *Woody Roderick*



California (San Diego-Imperial): Area 8 has 19 districts, three of them Spanish-language districts. We have a Spanish translation committee with enough members to ensure that all material flowing to and from our area will be available to all of our members, whether their primary language is English or Spanish. We hope this will provide Spanish-speaking members greater access to reports, agendas, minutes, and our area newsletter. Spanish area events will be translated into English to provide an opportunity for English-speaking members to plan and attend all Spanish speaking events in our area. We were able to see first-hand the process of an idea for the Fellowship come from an A.A. member, be discussed in their home group, taken by their G.S.R. to their district, and represented by their D.C.M. to the area, where it was discussed and sent back to the groups. Next, our area assembly voted with substantial unanimity that this motion be sent to the Conference for consideration. In April, the Conference voted this agenda item into an Advisory Action. To see the circles of love and service flow back and forth through our area was an affirmation that our process works, whether or not the end result was an Advisory Action. — *Mark Koons*

Delaware: We have 199 groups in 13 districts, covering the entire state of Delaware (Area 12). There are three intergroups, Northern, Central, Southern; each meets once a month. It has not always been easy to keep all of our service jobs filled. However, we do have a hard-working core which keeps most of our commitments. There are four assemblies a year which are preceded by five weeks by an area committee meeting with one additional committee meeting in the summer. Our nine standing committees are: Archives, C.P.C./P.I., Convention, Corrections, Finance, Grapevine, Literature, Newsletter, Treatment. We have a convention in May which we try to keep balanced between social and service events. We had our annual mini-assembly in January which is a service gathering with lunch at which we usually cover subjects deemed important to our area by the alternate delegate. Districts also put on workshops. The Octoberfest was held by Districts 12 and 13 last October and was a great success. Also, in January of this year, District 1 held the second annual Video Scene, attended by about 45 people. This is a display of all A.A.'s videos. Although it appears on the group level we work mostly on Recovery there is still attention paid to Unity and Service. — *Allen Rieken*

Georgia: Area 16 has 48 districts, 713 groups and approximately 18,000 members. Assemblies are held the third weekend of January, May and September in Macon, which is centrally locat-

ed. My first sponsor, who died 12 months after I came into A.A., suggested I attend the state assemblies and sit and listen. I have missed only one assembly since May 1984, and that was due to surgery. We have five active standing committees: P.I./C.P.C., T.F., C.F., Archives and Grapevine, that hold workshops at assemblies. We have a state office with one paid employee, augmented by volunteers, who distributes literature, maintains records, and publishes a bimonthly newsletter and an annual directory. We have a pre-paid state convention the third weekend of October that rotates around the state. We have seven cluster forums in seven geographical regions based on the Conference theme. With our assemblies, and cluster forums and our pre-paid convention, we are trying to carry the message of A.A. to every part of Georgia. Some of our goals for 2000 are to improve participation at our assemblies, and increase financial contributions and Grapevine subscriptions, but most importantly to increase membership in Alcoholics Anonymous in Georgia. — *Brookins Beck*

Idaho: Area 18 has ten districts with approximately 190 active groups, covering southwestern Idaho, parts of Oregon and a few groups in Wyoming. All groups are very service oriented, involved in area functions and supportive of other groups in their area. All conferences, assemblies and the many group workshops are well attended, with the area being especially "big" on camp outs and potlucks. We have two assemblies each year. The area committee meets three times a year. All assemblies are service oriented and focus on fellowship. One of the highlights of all assemblies is the Golf Tournament held the Friday before the assembly starts. This event has helped bring the east and west closer. To better serve A.A.'s needs, two committees are combined — Treatment and Institutions (H&I); C.P.C. and P.I. Four committees are formed: H&I - East; H&I - West; C.P.C./P.I. - East; C.P.C./P.I. - West. Our first group started in Idaho in 1945; since then we have grown in love and service. We look forward to growing and sharing our program with those who will come in the future. We believe that the service we do today will make sure the program will be there for those to come, as it was for us. — *Guido MacGuffie*

Illinois (Northern): Area 20 serves 1,055 reported groups in 24 districts with 22,000 attending meetings. We conduct area business through four committee meetings and four assemblies each year. We host a service conference every Spring and a Big Book conference in the fall. Each year we combine efforts with Southern Illinois and Chicago Areas in hosting a State Conference. Last year we were honored to host the 26th annual



Delegates/Past Delegates Conference. We have seven service committees: Answering service, Correctional Facilities, C.P.C., Grapevine, Literature, P.I. and Treatment Facilities. Our appointed service positions and Archives, editor of our newsletter, Special Needs coordinator and Web master meet specific needs in our effort to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. Our G.S.R. handbook is distributed at assemblies and G.S.R. schools. We had a pre-Conference workshop to help prepare our delegate for the Conference. This year that workshop was combined with the area's Spring assembly in an effort to increase participation and give more G.S.R.s and their groups access to the activities of the General Service Conference. — *Marcia Stiff*

Indiana (Southern): Area 23 has 26 districts and over 560 registered groups. We have five area assemblies a year and one area meeting. We have drafted guidelines for our area officers and 10 standing committees, which we hope will help committee chairpersons. We have added an April assembly to obtain area conscience on Conference agenda items. The Conference agenda is sent to the D.C.M.s prior to the assembly for discussion at district and group levels. The C.P.C. committee has held luncheons and workshops for professionals. The literature and archives committees are available to travel wherever asked. Our area intergroup liaison chairperson has held workshops to foster better communication between intergroups and the area. Some concerns are lack of attendance at workshops, and attracting and keeping trusted servants — from G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, and area committee chairpersons. How do we create the enthusiasm for all Three Legacies of Alcoholics Anonymous, Recovery, Unity and Service, that is displayed for miniconferences, campouts, and parties? We are working toward that goal. I owe my sobriety and my life to those who came before me through their service to Alcoholics Anonymous. — *Carolyn Chamberlain*

Kansas: Area 25 has 375 groups in 31 districts. One district is Spanish speaking with eight groups. We have two assembly meetings with two committee meetings yearly with good participation from groups, committees and past delegates. Members have the opportunities to attend several small conferences within our area. We hold an annual state conference that rotates based on districts that are willing to host the conference and place bids, at our January assembly, which are then voted on by the assembly. At these assemblies we have two-minute reports from our D.C.M.s and our 11 committees. Last year we added a Special Needs committee. Our Literature committee has done very well. Our Grapevine committee has been selling A.A.W.S. Literature and hopes to get back to focusing on Grapevine material. We are currently experiencing a downturn of contributions, and are hoping for a turn around soon. We are hosting a hospitality room with the rest of the Southwest Region at the International Convention. We have an area newsletter called the Grape Free Press that is printed four times a year, before each assembly and committee meeting. — *Jim Hall*

Kentucky: Area 26 covers the state of Kentucky, four counties in SE Indiana, three groups in SE Ohio and Metropolis, Illinois. We have 34 districts and our meetings rotate. We hold area committee meetings in January, April, and July, and every October we have an area assembly. Our April meeting is prior to the Conference to give everyone an opportunity to discuss the agenda items, so our delegate can be informed as to how our "Home Groups" feel about the items that will be discussed at the Conference. We have active standing committees: Archives, C.P.C., C.F., Grapevine, P.I., T.F., Special Needs and our *Kentuckiana* newsletter, and we have added a Registrar. We are

fortunate to have some of our past delegates share their experience, strength and hope; and they help us to learn about our A.A. history. Area 26 has some very dedicated A.A. members who are willing to keep carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. I am grateful for this opportunity to be a trusted servant for Alcoholics Anonymous. May our High Power keep us focused on our primary purpose, so that we can practice our Three Legacies and always have the hand of A.A. available when the alcoholic reaches out for help. — *Betty Scherer*

Maine: Area 28 has 470 registered groups in 21 districts. The area stretches from Kittery in the south to bilingual Fort Kent and Madawaska in the north, and from the New Hampshire border cities of Eastport and Lubec downeast. In addition, there are groups in the Saint John Valley of western New Brunswick that are part of Area 28. A strong commitment to general service is a tradition in Maine. Our two assemblies are very well attended, often with over a hundred voting members. Our standing committees are active in carrying the message. We hold a pre-Conference Forum in early March, and a post-Conference Forum in mid-May. There are two central offices in Bangor and Portland. We like to have sober fun up in Maine, and our annual Round-Up is held every year in the summer at the Sugarloaf Ski Resort. Attendance is between 700 and 1000! We often do workshops at the Round-Up on general service topics, to spread the word about service. We also host Love and Service Days in the various districts to bring the service message closer to home. These are often combined with a pot-luck supper and speakers' meeting. Area 28 continues its active role in general service and the Conference process. — *Jesse Mase*

Manitoba: Area 80 has 14 districts representing approximately 170 groups. We have four assemblies a year, usually two in Winnipeg and two outside the city. Our area assemblies pay the expenses of all D.C.M.s, special chairs and table officers to attend all assemblies. This insures full participation and enhances unity and effectiveness as an area. Our province is split into east and west to cut travel time and cost for the special chairs, P.I./C.P.C., Treatment and Correctional Facilities, to do their work and to carry the message of services. The reason we do this is because of the geographical area we have to cover. Manitoba covers 251,000 square miles. We as an area are continuing to travel north to carry the message and to host a northern assembly this spring. We are continuing to implement the committee structure into our service structure. Our central office is located in Winnipeg. — *Rhonda Worobey*

Maryland: Area 29 encompasses 21 of Maryland's 23 counties, has 965 registered groups in 47 districts and is served by ten intergroups. Maryland is a state of extremes, from Atlantic beach resorts in the east, through rolling farmland and high-density urban areas in the center to the remote Appalachian Mountains in the west. The area committee meets four times a year and the area assembly meets five. Our standing committees include Archives, C.P.C., Corrections, Finance, Grapevine, Literature, P.I., Registrar, Treatment and Workshops. We have two annual conventions, in the summer and fall. We also have a mini-conference for the purpose of advising the delegate of the area's views on Conference agenda items. To generate participation for the mini-conference, regional cluster meetings are held where specific agenda items are discussed. From time to time ad-hoc committees are created to handle special area needs. Currently there are two ad-hoc committees, one to look into the development of an area Web site and the other to host the Northeast Region Convention in the fall. — *Morgan Jopling*

Massachusetts (Western): In Area 31, we have 240 groups in six districts. Our area committee includes 12 D.C.M.s, chairpersons and co-chairs of the Archives, C.P.C., Grapevine, P.I., Roundup, Treatment Facilities, and Young People's Conference Committees. Each district and standing committee meets monthly, receives regular visits from the delegate and area chair, and reports at the area committee meeting which is also held once every month. We hold two weekend-long assemblies yearly. This June we will have our 31st Western Mass. Roundup which is mainly the forum provided for our delegate's Conference report. We enjoy good relationships with our two intergroups that maintain 24-hour phone coverage, meeting lists and supply literature to the groups. Our area teams up with Area 30, Eastern Mass., to co-host the Annual Massachusetts State Convention. To increase participation and awareness is an ongoing challenge. By offering more workshops, asking G.S.R.s for their ideas, we hope to attract more members to service. Though Area 31, may be small in size, the dedication of its trusted servants is enormous. — *Tracy Flematti*

Michigan (Western): Area 34 covers the western half of the lower peninsula and the eastern part of the upper peninsula. We have 468 registered groups in 16 districts with 14 of the districts being active. We hold area meetings monthly, rotating around the area. We have started an ad-hoc committee to look into how often we hold our area meetings, and to look at the format to see how we can better be of service to the alcoholic who still suffers. Area 34 also meets quarterly with the other two areas in Michigan (Areas 32 and 33), and for three years we have held a "Mock Conference" with the other two areas. At the "conference," each attendee is assigned to a committee and given background information for the committee agenda. In the morning they meet to discuss the agenda items; in the afternoon, the chairpersons report to the whole delegation making recommendations on the agenda items. Discussion and voting by the membership follows. Past delegates have found this "Mock Conference" to be helpful. They have a better understanding of how the Fellowship feels about the agenda items presented there. — *Bernard Rienks*

Minnesota (Northern): Area 35 has 500+ groups and 18 districts that carry the A.A. message using a committee system structured around the Conference committees. In addition, a Newsletter editor, Archivist and Group Records Secretary strengthen the unity and communication. The annual Service Workshop, plus two assemblies, are rotated through a 4-zone system. Conference agendas and background material are distributed to the appropriate action committees. The committees discuss the information, and then it is discussed at an area committee meeting and the spring assembly, prior to the Conference, to insure an informed delegate. Many service workers actively participate in the West Central Regional Conference and Forum. Communication is very good between the areas of the West Central Region. Many A.A.s from Northern Minnesota welcome the opportunity to serve at the International Convention in Southern Minnesota this summer. Contributions have increased significantly over the past two years, primarily by using the Seventh Tradition literature available from G.S.O. and distributing and discussing it in the districts and groups. Area 35 continues to maintain its unity by trusting its future to A.A. principles. — *Thomas Ardolf*

Mississippi: Area 37 encompasses the entire state of Mississippi. We have 212 groups and five districts, and rotate area conventions between the districts. Our standing committees include:

Treatment committee "Bridging-the-Gap," Grapevine, Web page, P.I./C.P.C., Archives, Corrections and Finance. Many cities have intergroups. Workshops are held by request with a minimum of four annually throughout the state. What we want to do is help you, your group and your district. Please let us know how we may be of service to you. — *Barrett Francis*

Montana: Area 40 extends from the wide-open prairies in the east to the Rocky Mountains in the west, from Wyoming on north to Canada. We have approximately 4,400 recovering alcoholics who would normally not mix, but somehow have formed themselves in 272 groups that are organized into 14 districts. We hold two assemblies each year and have seven standing committees plus an archivist. The highlight of the last two years was the Special Forum that was held in two different cities on two consecutive days. We had great attendance and energetic participation, and many people in our area believe it sparked a renewed enthusiasm in service work. More correctional facilities have opened up in our area and that has presented more challenges and opportunities to carry the message of recovery. We have a Bridging the Gap program and we publish an area newsletter, the *Triangle*. We are blessed with very active past delegates and our area continues to benefit from their participation in events all around the state. — *Loren Buettner*

Nebraska: Area 41 A.A.s have been busy with our new statewide hotline. The number is easy to remember and kind of catchy: 877-AA of NEB. The other major project we have going on is putting the rest of the Conference-approved books on tape. With the state being so spread out, many of us spend much of our time behind the wheel of our vehicles. Also, with our busy lives, there seems to be less and less time available for reading, so books on tape are a great solution. We are voting on the new web page (www.area41.org) position next meeting; before this the registrar handled the web page. We are also looking at creating a linguistic district in Area 41. We have a rather large Spanish-speaking population across the state. I am looking forward to working with everyone. — *John Sigerson*

New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island: Area 81 has 13 districts — four in Prince Edward Island and nine in New Brunswick, a bilingual province that has several French groups. The high cost of French literature continues to be a source of frustration and concern for these groups. There are 206 groups in the area and travel between the two provinces has been made easier with the opening of the Confederation Bridge. Assembly meetings are held in May and October with groups bidding to host them. They are held in conjunction with a Social Round-up and the weekend often becomes a family event. Area officers meet six weeks prior to the assembly to prepare an agenda. This allows each group to vote with an informed conscience. Service Workshops are held in January and June. Most districts have active P.I., Treatment, and Correction committees. We are fortunate to have a good rapport with the administration of Treatment and Correction facilities. This makes it easier for A.A. members to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic in treatment and to take the message of A.A. behind the walls. If there was one thing I could pass on effectively to my area during my term of being their trusted servant it would be a true understanding of the Seventh Tradition. — *Connie (Mike) Maes*

New Hampshire: Area 43 has 15 districts and over 9,000 members in over 550 groups in 10 counties. We have nine committees: Archives, Corrections, Literature/Grapevine, P.I./C.P.C., Treatment, Finance, Functions, *Pipeline* (our monthly publica-

tion) and our Area Service Office. Our Web site publishes meeting list information, corrections meetings information and general contact information. Our service office has two paid staff members, acts as a focal point for activities, sells Conference-approved literature, and maintains a computerized database of meetings, G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, districts and area committees. The area assembly meets four times a year; the area committee meets monthly, and meetings are well attended (75%+) but attendance at assemblies leaves something to be desired. We are considering an area inventory to see if we can boost attendance and enliven participation at assemblies. There are many A.A. events held throughout the year, from our annual state convention to district-sponsored service workshops, alcathons, breakfasts, family outings and weekend campouts. I always enjoy the opportunity to include my personal family with my A.A. family in my journey in recovery and service. A.A. is alive and well in Area 43. — *Mark Sawyer*

New Jersey (Southern): Area 45 has 512 registered groups. We are structured into four sections, each overseen by a section leader (D.C.M.-at-large). We are subdivided into 31 districts, including one Spanish-speaking district. We meet four times a year for area committee meetings and the progress reports of our 14 standing committees. Our newest area committee deals with our Web site on the internet. The Special Needs Committee has incorporated the area dealing with Remote Communities. We also meet four times in assembly and work closely with our three intergroups, appointing liaisons for communication between our entities. We host an "Annual Day of Sharing" to promote unity between our area and our intergroups. Our 36th Annual Area General Service Convention theme is "Working with Others." We expect to have over 1,500 participants. Our Correctional/Treatment Committee hosts an Inter-Area Conference attracting A.A.s from other committees throughout the Northeast. We recently established an All-Groups Day in each of our four sections. We are truly blessed with an active area in which all entities are harmoniously working together. Our theme for the next two years is "Walking Day-by-Day in the Path of Spiritual Progress." — *Stella Jenison*

New Mexico: Area 46 has 16 districts and approximately 324 groups. We meet quarterly at our assemblies for area business. Our June meeting is set aside for our State Convention that is hosted by various districts. We have nine standing committees that mirror the General Service Conference Committees, and have just added two more, our Bilingual Committee and our Web Site Committee. In New Mexico we are very proud of our Area Committees as they continue to do the work necessary to serve our Area and to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. This October we helped host a Four Corners Special Forum on the Navajo reservation in Window Rock, Arizona. It was a collaboration of four areas and two regions. Our New Mexico Conference of Young People in Alcoholics Anonymous (NMCY-PAA) is hosting this year's International Conference of Young People in Alcoholics Anonymous (ICYPAA) during the Labor Day weekend. We are expecting 3,000 plus for this Conference. I would like to express my gratitude in being able to serve my area here at the General Service Conference. This will be a cherished experience for me in the years to come. — *David Lozano*

New York (Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire): Area 48 has nearly 1,000 groups in 18 districts, covering 16 counties, with over 12,000 members. We have Area Fellowship Days every other month, hosted by district clusters, where our service committees meet, exchange and distribute information, report on cur-

rent activities, and plan for the future. We have two area assemblies per year. We have made significant progress in carrying the message to correctional facilities and have 32 state prisons — including one Federal, three shock treatments, three camps, and seven maximum security facilities. We hold regular meetings in more than 2/3 of the 32 facilities and host several all-day speaker jams each year where as many as 30 A.A. members speak at a prison on that day. We also conduct yearly "Correction Connections" (days of sharing) between the Department of Corrections administration and A.A. members in order to help facilitate where and how the needs of the inmates can best be served by the message of A.A. One of the facilities in our area was featured in the new videotape that G.S.O. recently released entitled, "Carrying the Message Behind These Walls." — *Quay Houchen*

New York (Western): As Area 50 enters the 21st Century, we are optimistic about the growth in our assembly. We now have 303 registered groups, four intergroups and over 5,800 members. There are over 400 meetings a week. As the Panel 50 officers and committee chairs review the past practices and renew their efforts to encourage the nonparticipating groups and members to spring into action, they know they face a new challenge and must "Trust Their Future to A.A. Principles." With this in mind, Area 50 will host a Service Spring Convention, N.Y.S. Informational Workshop, participate in the Niagara Frontier Central Committee Fall Convention, and place P.I. spots on local TV and radio stations. Our C.P.C. will host a booth at the Erie County Fair for 12 days in August. Approximately 1,000,000+ people attend this function yearly. The correctional and treatment facilities committees sponsor speakers meetings at (ten) different institutions. We have an active Grapevine committee and the Archives committee has been building an impressive Archives display. Many of our members are planning to attend the 65th A.A. Anniversary in Minneapolis. All in my area are alive and practicing the 'A.A.' Spiritual Principles in our affairs and Twelfth Step work. — *Michael Barnes*

North Dakota: Area 52 covers the entire state of North Dakota and has 170 groups in 12 districts. We hold three assemblies a year. Its location rotates among the several smaller communities whose districts do not have a city large enough to host a State Roundup. We meet in March and June for two days, and the third assembly is a one-day meeting concurrent with the North Dakota State A.A. Roundup in September. The March assembly begins with the delegate's discussion of the upcoming Conference agenda. This discussion helps the area and the delegate to become better informed of the concerns of the area and A.A. as a whole. It also provides the six standing committees a focus and direction. The committees are: Agenda/Structure,

Tracy Flematti, Panel 50 delegate from Western Massachusetts, is the daughter of the late John Dunn, Panel 38 delegate from Arizona.

Would you believe that a delegate had her room card-key in the same pocket with a souvenir magnet of a Michigan drivers license plate and —you got it— it demagnified the card-key! The reason the key didn't work was not discovered without a lot of chaos, of course! The same delegate, Nikki DeFelice, Louisiana, was scouring around for miniature bottles of Tabasco sauce (her area's souvenir) only to discover the hotel had many bottles.

Archives, Finance, Institutions, Literature/Grapevine, and P.I./C.P.C.; all area G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s are assigned to a committee. Since the implementation of our area committee system the actions and efficiency of the assembly have generated more interest from groups and districts; some of our group G.S.R.s travel over 400 miles to attend an assembly. With more group participation and financial support, Area 52 grows stronger every year. In a spirit of fellowship and unity, A.A. members accomplish much toward our common goal of carrying the message of hope to all of Area 52. — *Mike Bennett*

Ohio (Northwest)/Michigan (Southwest): Area 55 has a great enthusiasm and dedication for the continued future of our Fellowship. The message is carried by 300 registered groups, with a diversified area of English and Spanish-speaking meetings. We have three intergroups, one staffed central office and six answering services in outlying areas. With our new redistricting we now have 17 areas. D.C.M.s meet quarterly at our assembly meetings, which meet nine times a year. Our area holds workshops and this year started a "Unity Day." In March we will have our 18th Annual General Service Mini-Conference, a three-day weekend to communicate to the delegate the informed conscience of our area. All seven standing committees are fulfilling the area needs. In our assemblies we try to familiarize our new G.S.R.s with Traditions, Concepts and Warranties. We take our meetings to rural areas on occasion to encourage involvement and to generate activity in the assembly. It is with dignity and honor we serve our area, always remembering our primary purpose. We serve A.A. with dedication, love and service. — *Shirley Bair*

Ohio (Southwest): Area 56 consists of 29 districts, with 500 groups in the 16 counties we serve. We have six assemblies and six D.C.M. committee meetings yearly and an early spring mini-conference where we discuss upcoming Conference agenda items. This year we have three new officers and seven new standing committee chairpersons, who all bring new experience, strength and hope to the area. There are two intergroups operating in our area. This year the intergroups and the area are planning a Unity Day Workshop, to share what goes on in each entity. The Corrections committee is doing well in keeping in touch with the jails. The Grapevine and Literature committees maintain a display of items available. The Archives committee is working on getting a climate storage space to store and work on the Archives. The P.I./C.P.C. committee distributed the new PSAs to the local TV cable network. Area 56 is working on strengthening the districts in order to help carry the A.A. message. — *John Karch*

Ontario (Western): Area 86 covers the southwest portion of Ontario. Our area committee is very active and meets three times a year, together with two, two-day assemblies in May and October. The Saturday covers subcommittee workshops; D.C.M., alternate D.C.M. and G.S.R. schools; and all reports. Sunday is reserved for area business. There are 23 districts serving 516 groups and 145 meetings. Over the past two decades, our dedicated servants in the P.I., C.P.C., Treatment, Corrections and Grapevine committees have worked with the districts to develop informed and hard working committees. Some area groups, intergroups, and districts have fledgling but active Archives committees. We are discussing the development of an Archives and Registrar subcommittee. We have many active past delegates, from whom the area receives great experience. Over the last few years the Area Committee has become more focused on an informed group conscience, which helps to strengthen our service structure. We are concerned about the declining sales of

the Grapevine in Ontario, and are working to improve this situation. Like all areas we have our problems, but with teamwork our new committee will continue to build a better and stronger area. — *Ivan Gilbert*

Oregon: Area 58 has approximately 730 registered groups. About one-third of the groups participate in our area assemblies. We have a lot of support from past delegates. At the back of the business meeting room we have an "Elder Statesmen" Table. We have four assemblies a year and the G.S.R.s have the vote at each. We meet on a regular basis at service functions throughout the area, as well as at PRAASA, the Forum, and the Pacific Northwest Conference. Our officers and service committee chairs travel over our large state to do workshops and service functions. Five years ago we voted to have a district-at-large comprised of our Spanish-speaking groups. Those groups have the option of belonging to the district in which they reside geographically, or the Spanish District, which covers the entire state. This has been very successful and last year they hosted one of the area assemblies, which are rotated around the area. We recently went to the "committee system" to be more informed on the functions of the committees, give the delegate input on agenda items, and understand the connection between our area, G.S.O. and the Fellowship. Each G.S.R. and D.C.M. is appointed to a committee for the duration of their term. I am very honored to work in such a well-informed service oriented area. The work of the groups to reach the still-suffering alcoholic is something with which I'm impressed. — *Maria E. Emery*

Puerto Rico: Area 77 is divided into nine districts, 123 groups, and around 1,500 A.A. members. Our central office, serviced by two nonvoluntary A.A. members, receives requests for help (Twelfth Step) from the general public as well as requests for information about the program to schools, churches and companies. Requests are forwarded to the appropriate P.I. committee or to the nearest A.A. group. A monthly journal, *Despertar* (Awake) brings information about the program, the area, group activities, and meeting information to A.A. members. We have a monthly area meeting. Most groups have at least two meetings a week. We celebrate during the springtime an Annual Area Convention with seminars and workshops to share experience and for discussion of the Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions and Service Concepts. We have two assemblies every year. Last August we had a Special Forum in San Juan, Puerto Rico, with three days of wonderful sharing. About 250 to 300 A.A. members participated in this event. — *Erick Rossner*

Quebec (Northwest): Area 90 comprises 24 districts, 431 groups and some 8,000 members. In addition to the Conference committees, we have working groups, such as sharing sessions, Twelfth Step, regional bulletin, area structure, finance, and remote communities. Our area is a large one starting at the northern part of Montreal in the south running as far as the Hudson strait at the north end. Our remote communities committee is slowly making progress. There are now six groups in this Northern territory and the creation of a district for this particular area is still on the agenda. One month prior to the Conference we hold a weekend of workshops on the various Conference committees so members can share on the various subjects treated and discussed during the Conference. We have to remember it is now 50 years since our co-founders Bill W. and Dr. Bob turned over our Fellowship to its members, and we have the responsibility of "Trusting Our Future to A.A. Principles." In our area we intend to make this our slogan for the coming year. — *Gaetan Mongeau*

Quebec (Southwest): Area 87 has the smallest geographical territory among Quebec A.A. areas, but we host the largest number of groups and members in a 50-mile radius. Our area is officially bilingual (French-English) and also hosts some Spanish-speaking groups and other groups where different languages are spoken. We also have a group for deaf-mute members. The area numbers approximately 15,500 members and around 600 registered groups dispatched in 30 districts: 23 French-speaking districts, six English-speaking and one Spanish-speaking district. The urban concentration allows us to provide a gamut of centralized services manned by 12 committees. Our Service Training program has been instrumental in keeping ignorance at bay and fostering more commitment from more members for service. The Conference theme, "Trusting our Future to A.A. Principles," is on the agenda of the Service Training seminars. Since the buyout of the Service des publications françaises (A.A. French Publications) by A.A.W.S., everything runs smoothly with the new entity dubbed Services Mondiaux des AA du Québec (A.A.W.S. in Quebec). We've had temporary problems with La Vigne (our own independent Grapevine), but we are straightening the situation. Area 87 is doing fine, just like its delegate and his provocative Havana cigars which reflect the area's prosperity and open mind. — *Vincent Cousineau*

Rhode Island: Greetings from the Biggest Little, Area 61, Rhode Island. This year proposed changes to the area assembly format are aimed at increased turnout. District attendance has strengthened over the past two years, and many groups attend their monthly district meeting in one of our eight districts, yet they won't come to assembly. In a state 40 by 70 miles a 15 minute ride constitutes a "road trip." We have taken our inventory and some suggested answers are: more workshops, increased discussion items, and less committee reporting. We have added group and district concerns to our agendas. Many interesting group problems have been shared and solved. Our Twelfth Step work continues to be a strong point. Our treatment committee, in serious trouble two years ago, now carries the message to over 17 facilities. Our corrections committee has a strong foundation. Coordinators go behind the walls over 60 times a month. Archives was in rotation chaos, but they pulled together. This year, we have our first nonvoting, nonrotating archivist. Grapevine has a popular "Pass the Book" program where groups can sponsor a subscription to local facilities. We host a Convention in March and a Round-up in September. Lastly, I'd like to congratulate our Hispanic District. They celebrated their first anniversary in January. — *Jim Cotta*

Saskatchewan: Area 91 has 21 districts and about 315 groups, 35% of which are represented at our assemblies, but all districts are represented. We hold an area committee meeting in January, which I believe, has created a unity that is the backbone of our strength. We have a diverse population, rural, urban and many different ethnic backgrounds. We take responsibility for funding all members of the committee to attend its service functions. We have an elected Corrections coordinator and Archives chairperson; and a Literature, Grapevine and Archives Display that can be borrowed for Round Ups and service functions. We have a District Development Fund that is available to all districts to encourage sponsorship of service workshops in remote communities. The area committee has an active group conscience ready to make informed decisions. We are aware of the need for background information and try to address this whenever we are discussing topics. We have dances at our assemblies where members get a chance to socialize, let off energy and have a good time. Recently, we reconnected with Areas 78, 79 and 80 which, with us, make up the Western Canadian Region. Anyone is like-

ly to see one or more of us at each other's assemblies or quarterlies. Most important, we have a strong sense of unity, we care about each other and we practice the Traditions. — *Jean Dudley*

South Carolina: Area 62 has 330 active groups and approximately 6,500 members. Our state assembly is two days and meets three times a year. We have 23 active districts and four intergroups and all participate. Separate meetings are held for G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s to enable them to discuss information from their respective groups and districts. Our workshops for the coming year will correspond with the theme and workshops of the Conference. Our alternate secretary is also our registrar and we have a laptop computer to update data at the assembly. A newsletter keeps members informed of area A.A. news and upcoming events; Betty S., our trustee, starting our first newsletter. We have also started an area Web site. We have an active Archives committee with a traveling display. We host a state convention yearly and its site is rotated to different cities. Our goal in 2000 is to encourage sponsorship of individuals into service work at the group, district and the assembly level. As one of our past delegates once told me, "You have to make service work interesting to get people interested in service." This is what we in Area 62 are striving to accomplish. — *Darwin Haines*

South Dakota: Area 63 covers 400 miles east to west and 200 miles north to south and is divided by the Missouri River. We have 15 districts and 163 groups, and hold two conferences a year, and two workshops. At our workshops we discuss motions and at our conferences we vote on them, thus allowing each G.S.R. and D.C.M. to vote their informed group conscience. G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, committee chairs, and area officers are all voting members of the assemblies. Our literature chair has displays containing most of the Conference-approved material and most of the GV materials. This along with Archives, Institutions, C.P.C. and P.I. displays are at our area assemblies and are available at other A.A. events. We have a Minorities Committee that does outreach work with the Native American population. We are researching establishing an area Web site, pending the OK of the assembly. We strive, in Area 63, to stay united and always keep in the forefront our primary purpose, to carry the message of A.A. to the best of our ability. — *Paul Jacob*

Tennessee: Area 64 has approximately 500 groups in 38 districts; we have quarterly assemblies (attendance about 325) and an annual state convention. Our delegate and alternate delegate are funded to attend the assemblies, the Southeast Delegate meeting, the Southeast Forum, and the Southeastern Conference. Area officers are funded to attend the assemblies and the Regional Forum. We have active standing committees in P.I., Corrections, Grapevine, Archives, C.P.C., and Treatment. The Correctional Facilities Committee inventory was featured in the Holiday Issue of *Box 4-5-9*. All committee chairs are willing to travel to groups and districts to share their experience on carrying the message. We have a permanent location for our Archives where anyone in the Fellowship can go and see the memorabilia from the past and look up the history or information on their individual group or district. The nickname for Tennessee is the 'Volunteer State' and this has been very evident in our area this last year. The establishment of the facility for the Archives was very costly, depleted our area funds, and warranted going into our prudent reserve. However, when the groups of Tennessee were fully informed of this, our contributions more than doubled for that quarter, and they continue to be high. This only goes to show that when the need is there, the Fellowship will rise to the occasion. — *David Parrish*

Texas (Northwest): Diversity is a word which describes Area 66. Surrounded on the north and east by Oklahoma, New Mexico on the west and Mexico on the south, the NW Texas Area covers approximately 96,000 square miles. Over 6,500 members in 235 registered groups are served by 10 active districts. Rotating to a different location, assemblies are held on a quarterly basis. The majority of the districts are rural, and the D.C.M. sometimes provides the only connection between groups and the service structure. The Correctional Facilities Committee has served a vital role in carrying the message behind the walls. Our Literature Committee has provided workshops and information on Conference-approved literature. A past delegate serves as area archivist, and a permanent repository has been established in a central location. Some standing committees have struggled due to the lack of participation from members. During 1999, we added two linguistic districts and additional translation equipment has been purchased. In 1998, we hosted the Southwest Regional A.A. Service Assembly, and in 1999, the Regional Forum. As we continue to search for ways to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers, these assemblies have helped to keep our focus on our primary purpose. Our area continues to be responsible financially and has become more aware of a place where money and spirituality mix. We are looking forward to the next two years in the Northwest Texas Area and the unity that has begun to evolve. — Linda Counts

Texas (Southwest): Area 68 has approximately 500 registered groups, served by 33 districts, six of which serve Spanish-speaking groups. Two-day assemblies are rotated throughout the area quarterly. Our standing committees, are: Corrections, Treatment Facilities, Archives, P.I./C.P.C., Grapevine, Newsletter, and Bilingual/Spanish. The alternate delegate keeps the assembly members updated on the literature published by A.A.W.S.; the alternate area chairperson is also the standing committee coordinator and intergroup liaison. The area encourages participation of Spanish-speaking A.A. members and provides translation equipment when needed. The area's agendas and minutes, procedures manual and guideline handbook are available in both English and Spanish. An area committee meeting and G.S.R. Workshop are scheduled at each assembly. Each year an Area Correctional Facilities Conference is rotated within the area. Many of our past delegates attend area functions and willingly share their experiences and information. One of our goals is to increase the mini-workshops in our districts. All of our service committees and officers actively encourage participation in all phases of general service so that we may better carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic who still suffers. — Yolanda Flores

Vermont: Area 70 has 224 registered groups in 11 districts. The individual districts meet monthly and share the hosting responsibility of the four assemblies. Each assembly is preceded by committee meetings. We have a pre-Conference sharing session where we discuss agenda items to form a consensus. We have a State convention every year and recently decided to try an area service workshop every year. We are currently riding a wave of ample area funds, which sometimes seems to create as much controversy as those times when the treasury is low. We try to seek a balance to carry the message of A.A. in our area, while aiding in the work worldwide; maintaining lines of communication throughout our state and A.A. as a whole. Sometimes we seem to lean towards isolation, other times to the apparent neglect of a struggling group in a remote district. When we start to get some recovery and service going, we tend to forget about unity; when we get some unity back, we race to shore up the gaps in our area service needs. The same direction

we receive from older members and sponsors in our individual recovery is really needed in conducting our area business. But still there is a sense of fun, fellowship and love in it all as we trudge the road of happy destiny together, leaning on each other. — Mike Perry

Washington State East: Area 92 covers the state of Washington east of the Cascade Mountains and small parts of British Columbia, Idaho, Oregon, and Montana. We have 400 groups and 22 districts, with two of these districts being Spanish. The structure consists of three area committee quarterly meetings, two pre-Conference workshops, two preassembly workshops, and one full assembly. We have just taken an area inventory from which Area 92 will continue to focus on our Primary Purpose of carrying the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. We continue to see positive growth in group contributions, Grapevine subscriptions, increased districts, and group participation. We will be hosting a Special Forum in January 2001, and PRAASA in March 2001. Our area standing committee chairpeople continue to support the districts and groups with four committee quarterly meetings per year. For the first time this year, through a substantial unanimity vote at our assembly, the standing committee chairpeople will be given the right of full participation at all area quarterlies and assembly. — Rusty Kidder

Wisconsin (Northern)/Upper Peninsula Michigan: Area 74 serves over 600 groups in 24 districts, and has two conferences and two assemblies a year. We have a delegate's pre-Conference workshop prior to our spring assembly where the committees discuss the agenda topics and background material for the Conference. The topics are then presented to the assembly. We continue to move our area forward towards a true committee system. We have asked the D.C.M.s to serve on one of the seven standing committees. Our archives and literature committees have extensive displays. There are many A.A.s going into treatment facilities doing presentations and trying to "Bridge the Gap." Our registrar has been updating group information and creating mailing labels for our officers and the area newsletter. We are working with our friends in Area 75 to jointly host the East Central Regional Conference in 2001, which will also be the kickoff to a joint Unity Conference with our two areas. We continue to strive to find better ways to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic in Area 74. — Bob Mayer

Wyoming: Area 76 serves some 112 registered groups in 12 districts within 97,914 square miles. The state of Wyoming stretches 403 miles from the western border of Utah or Idaho to the eastern border of Nebraska or South Dakota, 359 miles from the southern border of Colorado to the northern border of Montana. Just a short drive anywhere to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic! The city of Sheridan had the pleasure of hosting the West Central Regional Forum this past fall, and 255 sober drunks were on hand to enjoy the fellowship and information. Area 76 holds two assemblies, winter and summer, each year to conduct the business of A.A. in Wyoming. There are two conventions, spring and fall, to promote fellowship, unity, and cooperation of groups and individuals within the boundaries of Area 76. Alcoholics Anonymous is alive, well and growing in Wyoming, as demonstrated by the fact that I am standing here before you safe, sane and sober today. — E.R. "Moose" Messerly

For 25 years, Al Herr, New York artist and A.A. member, has been sketching the Conference. This year, a delegate did a sketch of Al sketching the general session.

Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the Conference Evaluation Form and agreed that the headings remain the same for the 51st General Service Conference Evaluation Form. The committee suggested that the Conference Evaluation Form be printed on brightly colored paper and placed in the front of the Conference Manual, and that frequent announcements to fill out the form and hand it in be made throughout the Conference week.
- The committee discussed the Spanish Translations and Remote Communities meetings that were held prior to the 50th General Service Conference and suggested that a Presentation/Discussion topic on Spanish Translations be included on the agenda of the 51st General Service Conference.
- The committee asked the staff secretary to prepare a letter and form to be sent out annually in August to all Conference members to gather suggestions for the Conference theme, presentations and workshop topic.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the Composition, Scope and Procedure and made a minor change.
- The existing Archives policy on anonymity was reviewed and discussed at length. The committee was satisfied that the trustees' committee's discussion on this topic significantly reflected the views of the Fellowship and accepted the trustees' committee's assurance that the topic would continue to receive the attention it deserves.
- A progress report was presented on the Archives Kit. The committee members expressed their appreciation for the ideas and suggestions they received from a number of areas. Several Area Archives Handbooks were consulted for this work. The committee was pleased with the suggested contents of the draft. Since the Kit format provides flexibility that allows for updates and potential additions, the committee encouraged the trustees' Archives Committee to complete and make the new Kit available as soon as possible.
- The committee discussed the roles of area archivists, archives chairs, and collectors and suggested that the new Archives Kit include a discussion of these roles.
- After brief discussion regarding an archives service piece pamphlet the sense of meeting was to encourage the trustees' Archives Committee to continue development.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee discussed ways of providing A.A. information to professionals and made the following suggestions:

The committee agreed with the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities' consensus that one-on-one sharing was a more successful way than providing A.A. literature alone in helping professionals feel competent in working with those afflicted with alcoholism.

The committee suggested that Information on Alcoholics Anonymous (F-2) along with profession-specific literature be used to supplement one-on-one contact with professionals.

The committee suggested that A.A. members offer to accompany professionals to open A.A. meetings as a way of sharing hope with the professional community.

- The committee reviewed contents of the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook and made the following suggestions:

That the sentence on page 10 of the C.P.C. Workbook which reads, "There are no requirements for A.A. membership" be deleted.

That the initial paragraph on page 18 of the C.P.C. Workbook, under the heading Basic Guidelines on C.P.C. Presentations, be changed to read, "Here are two suggested formats for presentations."

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee considered a request to change the designation of the Correctional Facilities Kit and Workbook from Conference-approved literature to service material and took no action.

FINANCE

- The committee discussed the 1988 Advisory Action #2 concerning using literature prices as the primary mechanism to adjust the Reserve Fund and requests the trustees' Finance Committee to prepare examples of a floating cap plan for the 2001 Conference Finance Committee. This may include such items as historical data, average number of months of operating expenses covered by the Prudent Reserve over a period of years, methods used to monitor the Reserve Fund, and any other items the trustees' Finance Committee deems appropriate. This is requested to help study alternatives to price reductions which apparently sends a mixed message to the Fellowship.
- The committee discussed increasing the delegate fees, and determined no change be made at this time, but in the spirit of self-support encourages areas to make a contribution, over and above the suggested figure, if possible, to defray the average cost per delegate.
- After a discussion the committee noted the use of visual aids is very helpful in generating interest in service pieces and correspondence, such as the quarterly mailing, and suggests they continue to be used. Also, members are encouraged to use tools such as Birthday Plan, Memoriam Contributions and Gratitude Month.
- In expectation of continuing discussion of Self-Support, the committee invites areas to share their experience in Self-Support with the committee.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee reviewed the five-year history of La Viña. Being mindful of the demonstrated effectiveness of La Viña and the strong support for it expressed by the A.A. membership as a whole, and considering its spiritual benefits as a Twelfth Step tool, the committee wishes to express strong support for its continued publication.

- The committee discussed the advisability of producing the Grapevine magazine on tape and decided this is not a viable project because of the high cost and lack of expressed need.
- The committee discussed returning the About Alcoholism section (the "gray pages") to the Grapevine and felt that no action was necessary. The committee saw no need or desire in the Fellowship for the section. Information from the alcoholism field does not promote A.A.'s primary purpose and is readily available elsewhere.
- The committee considered several suggestions for related items for production in the year 2002 or later, and forwarded to the Grapevine Corporate Board its suggestion that the Grapevine produce a booklet on spiritual experience and a booklet on emotional sobriety.
- The committee considered a suggestion that a service position of Grapevine Subscription Chairperson be adopted by A.A. groups in the U.S. and Canada and concluded that there was no need for such a position.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹:

- After considerable discussion, the committee accepted the proposed draft Guidelines and Procedures for 2010 International Convention Site Selection with one minor revision. These draft Guidelines and Procedures were forwarded to this committee by the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.
- The committee discussed a progress report on the International Conventions Inventory requested by the 1999 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums. The committee requests that all Conference members encourage their areas to discuss the need and purpose of International Conventions and to submit written reports of these discussions to the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums. The committee noted that this International Conventions Inventory is a general inventory of all International Conventions and not specifically the 2000 International Convention.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the proposed distribution plan and text for the 2000 International Convention Questionnaire.
- The committee reviewed and discussed the 2000 International Convention Budget.

LITERATURE

- The committee reviewed the trustees' Literature Committee's progress report on the development of a pamphlet for

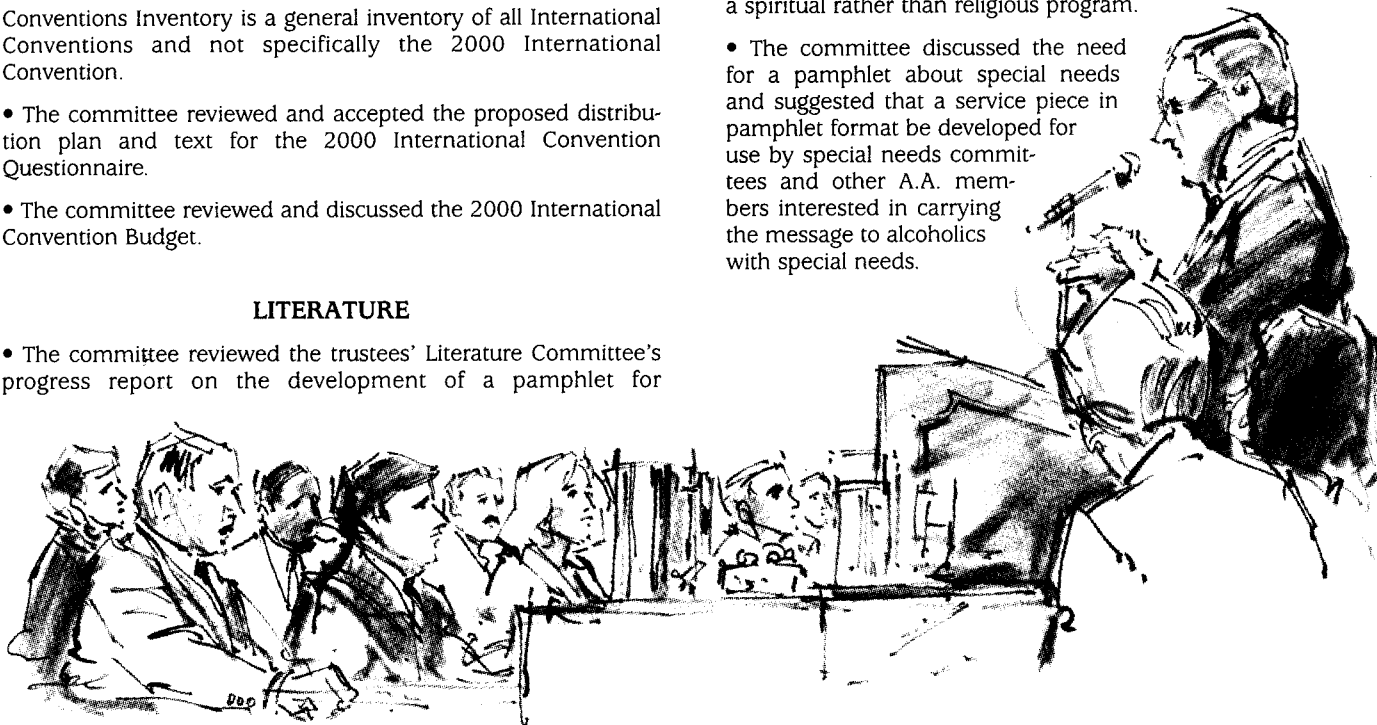
Black/African American alcoholics, expressed appreciation for the wide net cast to obtain stories and looks forward to reviewing a draft of the proposed pamphlet at the 2001 General Service Conference.

- The committee reviewed the trustees' Literature Committee's progress report on a pamphlet for older alcoholics to replace "Time to Start Living," expressed appreciation for the wide net cast to obtain stories and looks forward to reviewing a draft of the proposed pamphlet at the 2001 General Service Conference.
- The committee suggested that the pamphlet for older alcoholics to replace "Time to Start Living" be available in both standard size print and large print and that the latter be formatted to fit the literature racks used by most groups.
- The committee also suggested that the A.A.W.S. Board consider one price for both the standard type print and large print versions of the pamphlet for older alcoholics to replace "Time to Start Living."
- The committee appreciates the work of the delegates who responded to the special interest literature questionnaire and agreed that the results were inconclusive in terms of answering the question about whether there is a need for the continued development of special interest literature asked by the 1999 Conference Literature Committee for the following reasons:

- 1) The nature of the questions.
- 2) The timing of the survey.
- 3) Only 35 % of the delegates/delegate areas responded.

As a result of reviewing responses, it was noted that some of the special interest literature needs to be updated.

- The committee discussed the need for a pamphlet for the non-believer or a pamphlet explaining that A.A. is a spiritual rather than a religious program and could not reach consensus regarding the need. If the trustees' Literature Committee proceeds to develop a pamphlet, it was suggested that the focus be on A.A. as a spiritual rather than religious program.
- The committee discussed the need for a pamphlet about special needs and suggested that a service piece in pamphlet format be developed for use by special needs committees and other A.A. members interested in carrying the message to alcoholics with special needs.



POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee reviewed the Composition, Scope and Procedure and agreed to revise the "Composition" to reflect current procedures for Conference committee assignments.
- The request for an additional delegate area by Southern California Area 05 was considered and the committee took no action because they were unable to reach consensus.
- The committee strongly suggested that the 2001 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee consider revising the "Application for Additional Delegate Area" in order to ensure that adequate information is provided for evaluating future applications.
- The committee suggested that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference consider a workshop on "Future Growth of the Conference" during the 2001 General Service Conference.
- The committee suggested that the 2001 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee consider developing guidelines for the use of personal computers by Conference members during the General Service Conference.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed the inclusion of text emphasizing Anonymity at the Level of the Internet in Public Information service material and welcomed the addition of this most valuable information.
- The committee considered the suggestion to remove Question #4 — regarding race, and decided to leave the question in the survey. The committee determined that the question is helpful to the Fellowship in discovering the degree of diversity and make-up of the membership, determining trends in diversity and ascertaining the need for future out-reach to groups where the numbers are smaller than the national averages.
- The committee suggested that the G.S.O. staff member serving as "special needs" liaison consider gathering local experience on the accessibility of A.A. meetings to members with "special needs." The committee further suggested that "special needs" information be added to the G.S.O. A.A. Web site.
- The committee requested that in preparing the 2004 Membership Survey Questionnaire consideration be given to the following suggestions:

Question 3 — Marital Status

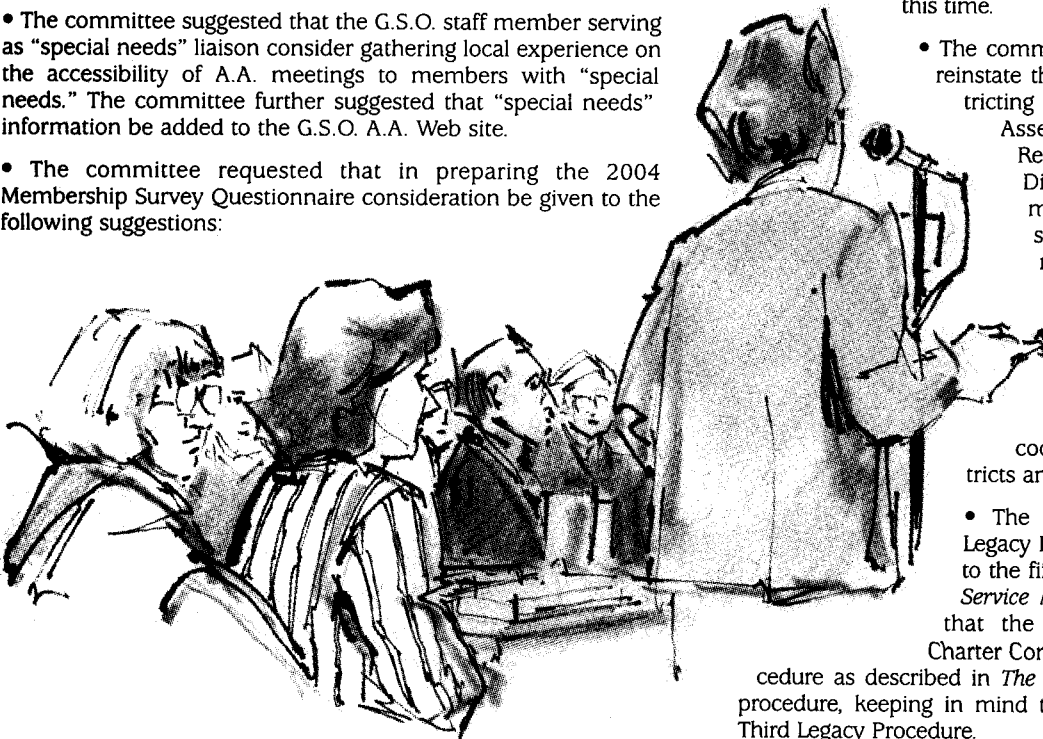
- Add a choice for those members who live in a domestic partnership, yet who are not married.

Question 12 — Employment Status

- Examine the list of choices to determine if the current listing offers those with a skilled trade a clear choice.
- The committee reviewed the 1999 and current reports on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site activity and were encouraged by the growing effectiveness of this most valuable P.I. vehicle. The effectiveness the G.S.O. A.A. Web site's continued role in providing opportunities for local Twelfth Step work was underlined.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook and suggested that a sheet highlighting Public Information audiovisual materials be added to the Public Information Kit.
- The committee discussed the trustees' Report on the Posthumous Anonymity of the Co-founders and suggested that the trustees' Public Information Committee continue its discussion of the issue of our co-founders' anonymity and develop a coherent policy to be forwarded to the 2001 Conference Committee on Public Information for their consideration, in the hope that wider sharing on this issue will clarify this matter. The committee also requested that, pending a final policy resolution of this question, the G.S.O. Public Information Coordinator continue to make Conference-approved material available to the media.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee discussed the suggestion to reinstate the section "How I got interested in General Service" to Chapter Six: "The Delegate" and agreed that in order to maintain the continuity of the 1999-2000 *The A.A. Service Manual*, that adding "Personal Views" from a previous edition manual was not desirable at this time.
- The committee discussed the suggestion to reinstate the sentence "The proposed redistricting should be approved by the area Assembly" in the section on Redistricting in Chapter Three: "The District and the DCM" and unanimously agreed that the sentence should not be reinstated. The committee felt that adding such a sentence was not consistent with the autonomy reflected in the Fourth Tradition and agreed that the section adequately stressed the importance of good communication and cooperation amongst groups, districts and areas.
- The committee discussed the Third Legacy Procedure specifically in reference to the fifth ballot as described in *The A.A. Service Manual*. The committee suggests that the 2001 Conference Report and Charter Committee review the fifth ballot procedure as described in *The A.A. Service Manual* to clarify the procedure, keeping in mind the 1984 Advisory Action on the Third Legacy Procedure.



TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee discussed the Treatment Facilities Kit. The committee considered whether additional pamphlets might be helpful for those doing this service work, and concluded that the Kit contained complete information for local Treatment Facilities committees.

- The committee members shared about the Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact efforts in their areas. A variety of contact methods were discussed, and it was noted that A.A. contacts are particularly important for clients in short-term facilities.

Concern was expressed about the inconsistency in Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact efforts throughout the United States and Canada. The committee stressed that efforts to help alcoholics coming out of Treatment Facilities are vital whether done by committees named Hospitals and Institutions, Treatment Facilities, or Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact.

- Several committee members shared specific ways that local Treatment Facilities committees have obtained finances to purchase A.A. literature, including budgeting funds to purchase literature for Treatment Facilities committees, a "pink can" set out at meetings to collect spare change designated specifically for literature, and local service events.

- The committee requested that the Treatment Facilities staff person collect sharing from areas on formats used for institutional meetings for the purpose of possible inclusion in Treatment Facilities materials.

TRUSTEES

- The committee discussed at length the proposal that the selection of a regional trustee be made by delegates of the region only and unanimously agreed that no change be made to the current procedures at this time.

COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATIONS WHICH DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The Correctional Facilities Kit be designated as service material, and that the contents of the Correctional Facilities Kit not be changed prior to review by the Conference Correctional Facilities Committee; however, literature catalogs, A.A. guidelines, Box 4-5-9, and service material contained in the kit would be the current versions.

FINANCE

- To adjust the General Service Board's Reserve Fund, the trustees continue the policy to consider other projects and ways of carry



ing the message such as, additional free literature, foreign translations, and increased discounts before adjusting selling prices. The committee felt this was necessary to clarify trustees' options during the budget process.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS'

- The time frame for the 2010 International Convention be expanded from July 4th weekend, 2010 to May 1 through September 15, 2010. Expanding the time frame provides flexibility to the bidding cities.

LITERATURE

- Prior to being asked to vote approval of the Fourth Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, all Conference members be given the titles and a brief synopsis of both the new stories and those stories carried forward from the Third Edition. The synopsis of the stories will be similar to the brief descriptions found in the table of contents of the Third Edition.

FLOOR ACTIONS WHICH DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

- That the Grapevine not move forward with a Web site message board, forum, or other online meeting format until this issue can be fully discussed by the 51st General Service Conference and go through the committee and Conference process. **(Not approved)**

- That in selection of regional trustees, two-thirds of the voters be the delegates from the region involved and one-third be divided between the Conference Committee on Trustees and the Trustees' Nominating Committee. **(Not approved)**

- That all work on the Black/African American pamphlet cease as it does not promote unity or our common welfare. **(Conference voted not to consider)**

(Note: Two Floor Actions from "Delegates Only Meeting" were withdrawn.)

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION

December 31, 1999 (with comparative totals for 1998)

	General Service Board of A.A.							
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund	Convention Fund	A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	Consolidated 1999	Consolidated 1998
ASSETS								
Cash	\$ 734,096	\$ 584,840		\$ 926,585	\$ 1,465,944	\$ 122,492	\$ 3,833,957	\$ 1,525,415
Accounts and interest receivable		116,081			194,403	55,728	366,212	530,285
Intercompany balances	(696,448)	(1,573,449)		479,306	240,671	1,549,920	-	-
Inventories								
Books, pamphlets, etc.					1,500,671	155,983	1,656,654	1,479,613
Paper, pre-publication costs, etc.					154,157	69,139	223,296	222,319
Investments - at fair value (Note 2)								
U.S. Treasury Notes, due 2000/2005 (Cost: 1999 - \$8,244,047; 1998 - \$8,237,981)		8,205,390					8,205,390	8,507,334
Property and Equipment								
Leasehold improvements, computer hardware and software, (net of accumulated depreciation - 1999 - \$2,837,396; 1998 - \$2,534,941)			\$731,798				731,798	1,034,253
Deferred charges and deposits	77,244			695,434	75,155	82,284	930,117	358,801
Prepaid pension cost (Note 3)		924,974					924,974	568,481
Total Assets	114,892	8,257,836	731,798	2,101,325	3,631,001	2,035,546	16,872,398	14,226,501
LIABILITIES								
Accounts payable	\$ 47,862				\$ 491,293	\$ 69,155	\$ 608,310	\$ 1,129,810
Accrued royalties					40,090		40,090	54,232
Deferred income								
Orders and subscriptions, etc	10,017				46,143	1,434,427	1,490,587	1,563,628
Advance registration fees				\$ 2,101,325			2,101,325	-
Accrued postretirement health benefit obligation (Note 5)		\$ 2,453,519					2,453,519	2,506,768
Total Liabilities	57,879	2,453,519	\$ -	2,101,325	577,526	1,503,582	6,693,831	5,254,438
Net Assets (Exhibit B)	57,013	5,804,317	731,798	-	3,053,475	531,964	10,178,567	8,972,063
Total Liabilities and Net Assets	114,892	8,257,836	731,798	2,101,325	3,631,001	2,035,546	16,872,398	14,226,501

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF ACTIVITY

Year Ended December 31, 1999 (with comparative totals for 1998)

	General Service Board of A.A.			A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.		Consolidated 1999	Consolidated 1998
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund		English	Spanish Magazine		
INCOME AND COST OF LITERATURE								
Gross Sales				\$ 9,418,014	\$2,289,075	\$58,569	\$11,765,658	\$11,547,996
Less: Discounts				272,709	31,302		304,011	332,920
Net Sales				9,145,305	2,257,773	58,569	11,461,647	11,215,076
Cost of Literature Distributed								
Printing				(2,895,990)	(407,196)	(34,739)	(3,337,925)	(3,469,041)
Royalties on books				(164,542)	-	-	(164,542)	(589,035)
Direct shipping and warehousing				(952,941)	(515,018)	(18,605)	(1,486,564)	(1,312,603)
Gross Profit from Literature				5,131,832	1,335,559	5,225	6,472,616	5,844,397
CONTRIBUTIONS - A.A. Groups and Members	\$ 4,242,052						4,242,052	4,038,921
INVESTMENT INCOME (Note 2)	1,043	\$ 116,939		7,100	90,830	-	215,912	650,871
Total Income	4,243,095	116,939		5,138,932	1,426,389	5,225	10,930,580	10,534,189
FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES (Exhibit C)								
Program	3,652,079			1,335,593	934,625	64,449	5,986,746	6,028,008
Supporting services	2,224,425	(409,742)	\$ 302,455	1,303,591	514,307	-	3,935,036	4,203,652
Total Expenses	5,876,504	(409,742)	302,455	2,639,184	1,448,932	64,449	9,921,782	10,231,660
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	(1,633,409)	526,681	(302,455)	2,499,748	(22,543)	(59,224)	1,008,798	302,529
Receipt of net assets of Canadian non-profit corporation (Note 7)				197,706			197,706	-
INTERCOMPANY AND INTERFUND TRANSFERS	1,633,409	(225,000)	-	(1,633,409)	165,776	59,224	-	-
CHANGE IN NET ASSETS FOR YEAR	-	301,681	(302,455)	1,064,045	143,233	-	1,206,504	302,529
PRIOR PERIOD ADJUSTMENT (Note 3)								(88,533)
NET ASSETS								
Beginning of year	57,013	5,502,636	1,034,253	1,989,430	388,731	-	8,972,063	8,758,067
NET ASSETS								
End of year (Exhibit A)	57,013	5,804,317	731,798	3,053,475	531,964	-	10,178,567	8,972,063

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES

Year Ended December 31, 1999 (with comparative totals for 1998)

OPERATING EXPENSES	Group Services	Fellowship Services	General Service Conference	World Service Meeting	Regional Forums	Publishing	Grapevine	Spanish Grapevine	Supporting Services	1999 Total	1998 Total
Salaries	\$ 589,235	\$ 677,552	\$ 130,250		\$ 87,205	\$ 831,492	\$ 457,210	\$ 38,249	\$ 1,922,575	\$ 4,733,768	\$ 4,628,499
Payroll taxes	41,197	50,057	8,454		5,761	60,477	34,815	3,248	146,449	350,458	345,743
Health and group insurance	108,355	98,484	13,156		9,835	118,319	85,836	8,236	389,064	831,285	796,679
Retirement expense - funding	37,224	45,229	7,638		5,206	54,646	23,047	2,500	125,774	301,264	312,015
Other program printing	179,930	46,799	43,200		2,764				6,315	279,008	323,856
Mailing labor	131,883	10,717			9,432				2,017	154,049	143,051
Postage and express	267,669	68,719	31,897		28,431	8,720	17,725		27,944	451,105	374,723
Writers fees	28,805	4,271	8,890		4,513	7,397			538	54,414	159,089
Foreign literature assistance		113,645								113,645	83,839
Selling expenses						56,389	166,223	6,104		228,716	210,809
Professional fees								120	289,539	289,659	254,416
Contracted services	1,422	48,381	4,422		5,325	29,734	3,273		52,011	144,568	163,207
Occupancy	63,116	93,055	6,762		4,704	108,953	73,474		244,617	594,681	675,400
Telephone	22,368	18,988	3,390		1,886	24,571	18,388		56,486	146,077	154,317
Equipment maintenance	3,970		150			1,126			56,693	61,939	66,684
Furniture and equipment	47,466	2,505				2,503		2,206	30,142	84,822	47,031
Stationery and office supplies	51,703	6,174	9,534		7,705	5,675	27,317		91,674	199,782	173,913
Office service and expense	5,456	7,683	12,801		3,087	7,783	27,317	2,115	212,629	278,871	265,756
Travel, meals and accommodations	1,078	34,968	343,608		53,187	17,808		49	363,422	814,120	953,416
Bad debts								1,622	24,434	26,056	34,441
Delegate fees			(109,218)							(109,218)	(216,378)
Total Operating Expenses	1,580,877	1,327,227	514,934		229,041	1,335,593	934,625	64,449	4,042,323	10,029,069	9,950,506
Postretirement health benefits									(53,249)	(53,249)	329,001
Depreciation									302,455	302,455	254,413
Retirement expense adjustment (Note 3)									(356,493)	(356,493)	(302,260)
Total Expenses	1,580,877	1,327,227	514,934		229,041	1,335,593	934,625	64,449	3,935,036	9,921,782	10,231,660
Allocation of supporting services to activities	916,446	769,404	298,511		132,777	1,303,591	514,307	-	(3,935,036)	-	-
Total Allocated Expenses	2,497,323	2,096,631	813,445		361,818	2,639,184	1,448,932	64,449	-	9,921,782	10,231,660
Services	\$2,497,323	\$2,096,631	\$813,445	\$ -	\$361,818					\$5,769,217	\$6,148,865
Publishing	-	-	-	-	-	\$2,639,184	-	-	-	\$2,639,184	2,555,073
Grapevine	-	-	-	-	-	-	\$1,448,932	\$64,449	-	1,513,381	1,527,722
										9,921,782	10,231,660
COMPARATIVE TOTALS - 1998	\$2,650,745	\$2,234,871	\$816,682	\$125,643	\$320,924	\$2,555,073	\$1,454,674	\$73,048	-	\$10,231,660	

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
Consolidated Statement of Cash Flows
Year Ended December 31, 1999
(with comparative totals for 1998)

CASH FLOWS PROVIDED (USED)

	<u>1999</u>	<u>1998</u>
FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES:		
Change in net assets for year (Exhibit B)	\$ 1,206,504	\$ 302,529
Prior period adjustment to prepaid pension cost	-	(88,533)
Realized and change in unrealized gains on investments	302,893	(115,878)
Amortization of bond premiums	12,237	5,776
Depreciation	302,455	254,413
Changes in assets and liabilities:		
Accounts receivable	164,073	(110,156)
Inventories	(178,018)	46,179
Deferred charges and other assets	(571,316)	(17,306)
Accounts and accruals payable	(535,642)	213,105
Deferred income	2,028,284	25,698
Prepaid pension cost	(356,493)	(213,727)
Postretirement health benefits obligation	(53,249)	329,001
<u>Net Cash Flows Provided (used)</u>		
<u>By Operating Activities</u>	<u>2,321,728</u>	<u>631,101</u>
FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES:		
Office construction project	-	(480,414)
Proceeds from sales of investments	3,000,000	1,500,000
Purchases of investments	(3,013,186)	(2,007,819)
<u>Net Cash Flows Provided (used)</u>		
<u>By Investing Activities</u>	<u>(13,186)</u>	<u>(988,233)</u>
Net Increase (Decrease) in cash	2,308,542	(357,132)
Cash, beginning of year	<u>1,525,415</u>	<u>1,882,547</u>
Cash, end of year	<u><u>3,833,957</u></u>	<u><u>1,525,415</u></u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

Report of the Independent Auditor

AUDITORS' OPINION

March 3, 2000

The Board of Trustees
The General Service Board of
Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
475 Riverside Drive
New York, New York 10115

Members of the Board:

We have audited the accompanying consolidated statement of financial position of THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC., ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC. and ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC., as of December 31, 1999 and the related consolidated statements of activities, functional expenses and cash flows for the year then ended. These financial statements are the responsibility of the Organizations' management. Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audit.

We conducted our audit in accordance with generally accepted auditing standards. Those standards require that we plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements are free of material misstatement. An audit includes examining, on a test basis, evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements. An audit also includes assessing the accounting principles used and significant estimates made by management, as well as evaluating the overall financial statement presentation. We believe that our audit provides a reasonable basis for our opinion.

In our opinion, the consolidated financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the financial position of the three Corporations named above as of December 31, 1999 and the changes in their net assets and their cash flows for the year then ended in conformity with generally accepted accounting principles.

Respectfully submitted,

Owen J. Flanagan and Company
Certified Public Accountants

**THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC.
NOTES TO CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
DECEMBER 31, 1999**

Note 1 Organization: The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. are not-for-profit corporations organized for the purpose of assisting in the formation of A.A. Groups and coordinating the A.A. program of rehabilitating alcoholics throughout the world, and publishing books, magazines, pamphlets and other material directly related to that purpose.

The activities of the General Service Board of A.A. itself are conducted in four separate funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND — This fund was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which during 1977, was re-defined by a special General Service Board Committee as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The committee also rec-

ommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That advisory action was approved by the Board of Trustees and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. have been amounts held for unfulfilled subscriptions reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund. Any withdrawals from the Reserve Fund must be specifically authorized by the Board of Trustees upon recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The CAPITAL PROJECTS FUND — This fund was established in 1990 to account for the costs of leasehold improvements and computer hardware and software incurred under major capital projects, and to record annual depreciation on such assets.

The CONVENTION FUND — A separate fund established to record the income and expenses of the International A.A. Convention to be held in Minneapolis, Minnesota in July 2000. This event, which is held every five years, is separate from the regular operations and structure of the General Service Office, but the General Fund receives any excess of income, or pays any excess of expense, resulting from the activity.

At December 31, 1999, cumulative outside costs incurred of \$695,434 and advance registration fees recorded of \$2,101,325 have been deferred and are reflected on the balance sheet of the Convention Fund on Exhibit B. Salaries, benefits and other internal costs related to General Service Office staff assigned to the convention have been expensed as a program activity of the General Fund.

The GENERAL FUND — This fund is comprised of those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purpose for which the Corporation was formed. These purposes presently include activities related to communication and information services to A.A. groups and members, public information, cooperation with the professional community and various regional, national and international meetings, conferences and conventions.

All net assets of the Corporations are free of donor restrictions.

Note 2 Accounting Policies: The Corporations use the accrual method of accounting, where income is recorded in the period earned and expenses are recorded in the period incurred and to which they pertain. The Organizations do not receive or solicit pledges, so contributions are recorded as income when the cash is received.

Intercompany balances and transfers have been eliminated in the consolidated totals in the accompanying financial statements. Amounts reported by A.A. World Services include Services Mondiaux Des Alcooliques Anonymes, Inc.; "S.M.A.A.", a controlled non-profit Canadian corporation formed during 1999.

Operating expenses of the General Service Office are shared between the General Service Board of A.A. and A.A. World Services. Expenses related to service activities are charged to the General Service Board, while expenses in connection with publishing activities are allocated to A.A. World Services. Administrative and overhead costs are apportioned between the program activities they support.

Occupancy costs related to A.A. Grapevine's share of office space at the General Service Office have been allocated based on its proportionate square footage; substantially all other expenses related to magazine activities are paid and recorded directly by A.A. Grapevine under its separate accounting system.

The consolidated financial statements include certain prior year summarized comparative information. Such information does not include sufficient detail to constitute a presentation in

conformity with generally accepted accounting principles. Accordingly, such information should be read in conjunction with the organization's financial statements for the year ended December 31, 1998, from which the summarized information was derived.

Cash: For purposes of the consolidated statement of cash flows, cash is defined as cash on hand, checking and money market accounts and short term cash investments.

Cash in excess of federally insured limits are potentially exposed to concentrations of credit risk. However, the Organization only maintains accounts with quality financial institutions with high credit standings, so as a consequence, such risks are limited.

Inventories: Inventories held are recorded at lower of cost or market under the first-in, first-out, "FIFO" method of accounting. Proper allowance has been made for slow-moving or damaged merchandise.

Literature distributed without charge is not accounted for separately, but is included in the cost of printing as a reduction of inventory.

Property and Equipment: The costs of major capital projects involving leasehold improvements and computer system acquisitions are capitalized and depreciated over the term of the applicable lease, or the useful life of the equipment, in the Capital Projects Fund.

Normal recurring expenditures for furniture and equipment are considered to be immaterial and are charged to expense in the year of purchase.

The following table sets forth, by classification of assets, the depreciation lives, the provision for depreciation for the year ended December 31, 1999 and the accumulated depreciation at that date:

	Life	Cost	Current Year	Accumulated Depreciation
Leasehold improvements	Terms of			
475 Riverside Drive	Leases	\$2,105,871	\$ 219,143	\$1,374,073
Furniture	8 Years	689,598	83,312	689,598
Computer—hardware	5 Years	502,054		502,054
—software	5 Years	271,671		271,671
		<u>3,569,194</u>	<u>302,455</u>	<u>2,837,396</u>

All depreciation is provided on the straight line basis.

Investments: As described above, all of the investing activity of the operating entities is consolidated in the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board. In accordance with established policy, the Fund invests in short or medium term U.S. Treasury Notes normally held to maturity. The investments are recorded at fair value. Gains and losses on sales or redemptions are recorded by comparison of proceeds to amortized cost on a specific identification basis.

Investment income for 1999 and 1998 is comprised of the following:

	1999	1998
Interest	\$522,870	\$538,970
Realized gains on redemptions	5,117	6,459
Change in unrealized gains	(308,010)	109,419
Investment expenses	(4,065)	(3,977)
	<u>215,912</u>	<u>650,871</u>

Functional Expenses: The consolidated statement of Functional Expenses (Exhibit C) provides detail as to program costs by major activity and supporting services. In addition to the program costs reflected on that Exhibit, amounts shown on the consolidated statement of activities (Exhibit B) as cost of literature distributed also relate to the publishing and magazine programs.

Two of the major program activities described on Exhibit C are for "Group Services" and "Fellowship Services". Group Services includes those activities most closely associated with serving A.A. groups, including the group services staff assignment, the Box 459 newsletter, directories, group records and files, the contributions department and services to French speaking groups in North America. Fellowship Services include activities outside of the group, such as public information, co-operation with the professional community, treatment and correctional facilities, archives and loners and overseas services.

Supporting services include costs of the General Service Office which can not be attributed to any specific program activity. These include administrative management, data processing and information systems, editorial and clerical support, trustee and director activities, copy center, accounting, human resources and other miscellaneous administrative functions.

The allocation of supporting services to program activities on Exhibit C is done on a pro rata basis to program expenses by entity, and is provided for informational purposes only.

Operating Expenses: For purposes of the Statement of Functional Expenses, operating expenses are defined as recurring items requiring the current outlay of cash.

Management Estimates: The management of the Corporations uses estimates and assumptions in preparing financial statements in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles. These estimates and assumptions affect the reported amounts of assets, liabilities, revenues and expenses. Actual results could vary from the estimates that management uses.

As described in Note 5 of this report, management made certain significant estimates in the calculation of liabilities for postretirement health benefits. These estimates include employee retention, health care cost trends and the actuarial lives of present and projected retirees eligible for benefits. It is reasonably possible that a change in these estimates will occur in the near term. The effect of changes in these estimates can not be determined.

Note 3 Retirement Plan: The Organizations adopted a defined benefit pension plan effective January 1, 1965 to provide retirement benefits to eligible U.S. employees who have completed one year of service.

The plan provides an annual benefit equal to 2% of final average compensation multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 35 years), less 0.65% of average social security earnings multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 30 years). The social security offset can not reduce the gross benefit by more than 50%.

Pension expense is recorded in accordance with SFAS 87, in which pension costs are accrued ratably over an employee's years of service based upon factors which are not necessarily the same as those used to calculate the annual funding requirements. In addition, SFAS 87 requires, on a deferred recognition basis, an employer to report an asset or liability on the Organization's balance sheet depending upon a comparison of the Plan's assets to its benefit obligations.

The contributions made to fund pension benefits are recorded by the operating companies as an expense. The difference between the amounts actually paid and the net periodic pension cost under SFAS 87 is recorded by the Reserve Fund as an adjust-

ment to retirement expense since it is a non-cash item that does not affect current operations.

The following tables set forth the Plan's funded status, assumptions, benefit cost and payments and employer contributions for 1999:

Fair value of plan assets (at December 31)	\$13,713,279
Benefit obligation (at December 31)	10,543,314
Funded status	<u>3,169,965</u>

Prepaid pension cost recognized in consolidated statement of financial position	<u>\$ 924,974</u>
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The difference between the Plan's funded status and recognized prepaid pension cost asset is attributable to deferral and amortization of Plan assets and obligations as prescribed under SFAS 87.

Weighted-average assumptions (at December 31)	
Discount rate	7.5%
Expected return on plan assets	9.0%
Rate of compensation increase	5.5%

Benefit cost	\$ (107,891)
Employers contribution	248,602
Benefits paid	542,227

Classification of benefit costs:	
Operating expense (cash funding)	\$ 248,602
Non-operating expense (non-cash adjustment to pension cost)	(356,493)
	<u>(107,891)</u>

Plan assets at December 31, 1999 were comprised as follows:

Short term cash and receivables	\$ 504,378
Common and preferred stock	8,458,650
Government bonds	2,411,169
Corporate and other bonds	2,292,707
Other investments	46,375
	<u>13,713,279</u>

During 1998, it was determined that an actuarial error had occurred in the calculation of the net periodic pension cost for 1997, resulting in the omission of the benefit obligations attributable to certain employees. As a result, a prior period adjustment of \$88,533 has been shown on Exhibit B as a decrease to beginning net assets.

Employees of S.M.A.A. in Canada participate in a separate retirement plan under which 5% of their annual salaries are contributed by that Organization.

Note 4 Lease Commitments: At

December 31, 1999, A.A. World Services, Inc. as fiscal agent for the General Service Office, was subject to the following non-cancellable leases (exclusive of future operating increases) in New York City:

\$471,128
yearly office
rental lease at
475 Riverside

Drive effective January 1, 1999 through December 31, 2008.

\$97,915 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective January 1, 1999 through December 31, 2008.

In addition to the above lease commitments, S.M.A.A. was subject to a lease for office space in Montreal, Canada. The lease is effective through December 31, 2004. The current rent for 1999 is \$24,774, with annual escalations of 3%.

The minimum lease commitment at December 31, 1999 is \$4,688,000.

Note 5 Postretirement Health Benefits: The Corporations provide health care benefits for retired employees, substantially all of whom become eligible if they attain retirement age while working at the General Service Office. Benefits are provided through health insurance contracts maintained by the Corporations, 25% of the cost of which is borne by the retirees.

The plan is unfunded. The assumed health care cost trend rate used to measure the expected cost of benefits covered by the plan is 5%. A discount rate of 7.5% has been used to measure the accrued postretirement health benefit obligation shown on Exhibit B. The following table sets forth the information regarding the Plan for 1999:

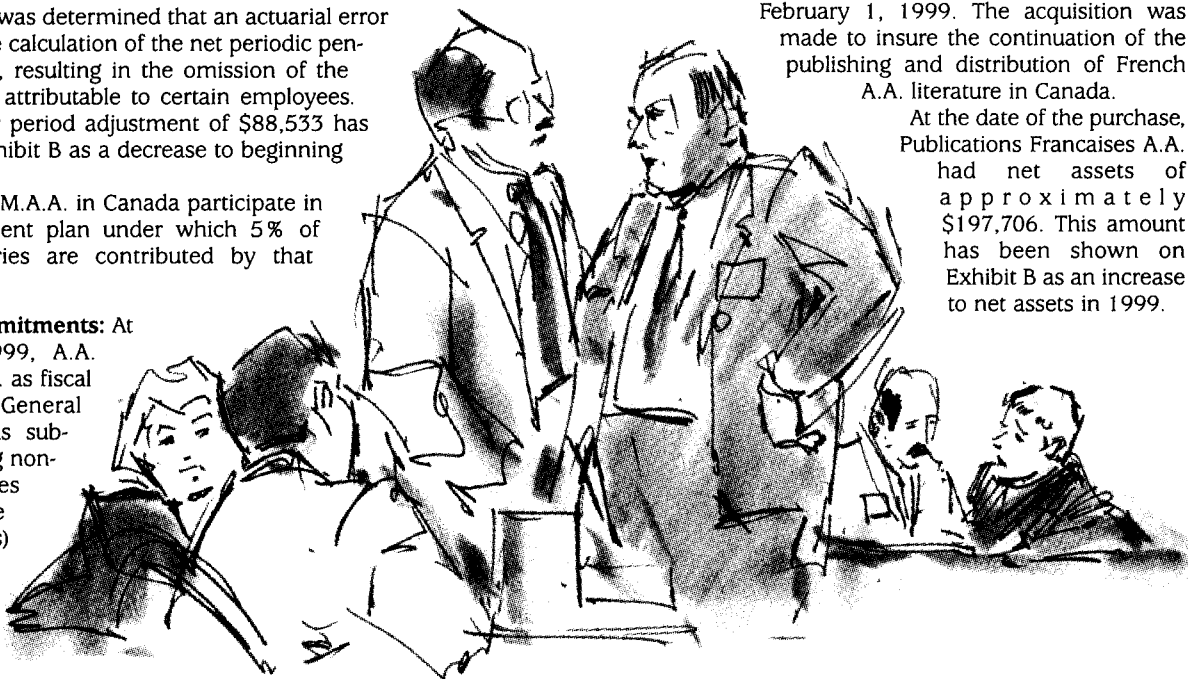
Benefit obligation (at December 31)	<u>\$2,453,519</u>
Benefit cost	\$ 62,437
Benefits paid	115,686

The excess of the payments for benefits over the cost of benefits of \$53,249 has been reported on Exhibit C as an offset against non-operating expenses since it does not affect the current outlay of cash.

Note 6 Tax Status: The Organizations are exempt from Federal income taxes under section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code, and are classified as public charities. They are also exempt from New York State franchise and sales taxes.

Note 7 Canadian Non-Profit Corporation: In January 1999, A.A. World Services formed S.M.A.A., a controlled Canadian non-profit corporation, for the purpose of acquiring the assets, liabilities and operations of Publications Francaises A.A. for \$1 effective February 1, 1999. The acquisition was made to insure the continuation of the publishing and distribution of French A.A. literature in Canada.

At the date of the purchase, Publications Francaises A.A. had net assets of approximately \$197,706. This amount has been shown on Exhibit B as an increase to net assets in 1999.



Budget Highlights

2000 G.S.O. Budget

This budget describes the "OPERATIONS" of the General Service Office. It includes expenses of A.A. World Services (the Publishing operation) and the General Fund (Service activities). It excludes any activities reported separately in the Reserve Fund or the Capital Projects Fund. The Grapevine operations are described below in a separate report.

Income: The 2000 sales budget of \$9,237,000 is approximately 2% less than the 1999 actual results. The budget reflects a "moderated" continuing trend of declining unit sales. Book & Booklet unit sales are estimated approximately flat when compared with 1999, (compared with a 6% decrease in last year's budget). Net sales after discounts allowed are projected at \$8,989,300, approximately \$156,000 less than 1999.

Manufacturing costs are budgeted \$40,000 less than 1999's actual results, primarily a result of lower sales volume. Royalties, budgeted at \$161,400, are on a par with 1999.

Shipping and warehousing costs are budgeted about 2% higher than 1999. Even though we anticipate an increase in postage and freight rates, a change in vendors should actually reduce our warehousing costs, thus stay approximately the same.

Gross profit from literature is budgeted at \$4,991,500, approximately \$140,000 less than 1999, primarily a result of the decline in sales.

Contributions for 2000 have been budgeted at \$4,331,900, approximately a 2% increase over 1999.

Total Operating Revenue for the period is anticipated at \$9,327,000, .5% less than 1999.

Total Operating Expenses for 2000 have been budgeted at \$9,178,425, approximately 7.8% higher than 1999. Included in that larger than usual increase are costs to restore Archives treasures that are deteriorating, as well as the every other year cost to G.S.O. of the World Service Meeting.

An excess of revenue over expenses of \$148,500 is budgeted. This compares with a \$866,300 net income for 1999, \$139,600 net income for 1998, a \$245,000 loss for 1997, \$1,264,000 loss for 1996, a \$1,147,000 loss for 1995. The three years of losses, followed by moderated profits, has accomplished the goal of reducing the Reserve Fund balance to a 9-month level.

2000 Grapevine Budget

The 2000 Grapevine Budget calls for an average circulation for 2000 of 115,000, down slightly from the 1999 average of 116,000 copies, and with the 1998 117,300 average.

Income: Magazine income of \$1,732,800 is expected, just \$21,000 less than 1999. Other Publishing Income from books, cassette tapes, and miscellaneous items is budgeted at \$541,000, approximately \$35,000 higher than 1999 as a result of anticipated calendar and pocket planner sales.

Total Gross Profit: Combining the magazine and other publishing items, the gross profit of \$1,357,672 is budgeted, as compared to \$1,336,200 achieved for 1999.

Total Operating Expenses for 2000 are budgeted at \$1,515,795, approximately \$67,000 more than the 1999 actual of \$1,448,932.

Net Income: For 2000 a net loss is budgeted at \$67,143 after interest earned as compared with a net loss of \$22,540 achieved in 1999.

2000 Spanish Grapevine Budget

Following the 1995 General Service Conference Advisory Action #7, the publication of the Grapevine magazine in Spanish was approved by the Grapevine Board of Directors and the trustees' Finance Committee of the General Service Board. Recognizing this publication as a new venture, both boards will review the financial impact on the Fellowship and the progress of circulation and continue to monitor the viability of this venture.

For 2000 La Viña expects a gross profit on the magazine of \$5,960 compared with a \$5,225 gross profit for 1999 and a \$6,864 loss for 1998. Circulation for 2000 is estimated at 8,000 approximately equal with the 7,986 1999 average. Total costs and expenses are estimated at \$72,174 for 2000, compared with \$64,449 in 1999. The 2000 budget projects a net loss of \$66,214 compared with a \$59,224 loss in 1999.

To date the La Viña project has incurred start-up costs/operating losses of \$29,500 in 1995, \$138,290 in 1996, \$102,140 in 1997, \$66,182 in 1998, and \$59,224 in 1999, approximately \$395,000 in total.

The General Service Office 2000 OPERATING BUDGET

INCOME	1999 Actual	2000 Budget
GROSS SALES	\$9,418,014	\$9,236,531
Discounts allowed	272,709	247,200
<u>Net Sales</u>	9,145,305	8,989,331
Cost of Literature Distributed		
Manufacturing	2,895,990	2,857,532
Royalties	164,542	161,400
<u>Gross Margin</u>	6,084,773	5,970,399
DIRECT SHIPPING AND WAREHOUSING	952,941	978,845
<u>Gross Profit from Literature</u>	5,131,832	4,991,554
Contributions Received	4,242,052	4,331,900
Interest Income	8,142	3,500
<u>Total Revenue</u>	9,382,026	9,326,954
OPERATING EXPENSES		
Salaries	3,948,528	4,195,000
Payroll taxes	289,503	295,000
Insurance	674,122	745,000
Retirement expense	261,669	232,300
Other program printing	279,007	375,000
Mailing, labor, etc	152,783	152,800
Postage & express	434,645	428,000
Writers' fees	54,414	82,500
Other literature assistance	113,645	139,500
Selling expenses	56,389	93,400
Professional fees	267,973	250,000
Contracted services	140,297	251,850
Occupancy	496,715	517,250
Telephone	121,562	128,700
Equipment maintenance	61,939	65,600
Furniture & equipment	75,815	50,000
Stationery & office expense	167,138	190,400
Office service & expense	244,112	210,525
Travel, meals, & accomodations	665,852	765,600
Bad debts	9,579	10,000
TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES	8,515,687	9,178,425
Income (loss) for period	866,339	148,529

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

2000 BUDGET

	1999 Actual	2000 Budget	LA VIÑA	
			1999 Actual	2000 Budget
PAID CIRCULATION—AVERAGE # OF COPIES	<u>115,951</u>	<u>115,000</u>	<u>7,986</u>	<u>8,000</u>
INCOME FROM MAGAZINE				
Subscription income	\$1,708,255	\$1,698,780	\$58,569	\$58,640
Single copies and back issues	<u>45,471</u>	<u>34,000</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
<u>Total magazine income</u>	<u>1,753,726</u>	<u>1,732,780</u>	<u>58,569</u>	<u>58,640</u>
<u>Total direct costs</u>	<u>689,845</u>	<u>670,331</u>	<u>53,344</u>	<u>52,680</u>
GROSS PROFIT ON MAGAZINE	<u>1,063,881</u>	<u>1,062,449</u>	<u>5,225</u>	<u>5,960</u>
OTHER PUBLISHING INCOME	504,047	541,047		
<u>Total direct costs</u>	<u>231,719</u>	<u>245,824</u>		
GROSS PROFIT ON SPECIAL ITEMS	<u>272,328</u>	<u>295,223</u>		
<u>TOTAL GROSS PROFIT</u>	<u>1,336,209</u>	<u>1,357,672</u>		
COSTS AND EXPENSES				
EDITORIAL COSTS				
Salaries, including temporary help	170,524	182,658	18,630	24,137
Payroll taxes and benefits	43,669	48,380	7,069	6,776
Occupancy costs	61,242	64,175	0	0
Office supplies and expenses	21,576	17,168	1,456	2,000
Product development	<u>3,273</u>	<u>9,000</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
<u>Total Editorial</u>	<u>300,284</u>	<u>321,381</u>	<u>27,155</u>	<u>32,913</u>
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS				
Salaries, including temporary help	576,467	611,613	19,619	24,000
Payroll taxes and benefits	200,059	203,905	6,540	6,741
Occupancy costs	61,190	64,175	0	0
Office supplies and expense	33,108	35,320	0	0
Subscriber services	11,505	13,500	0	0
Selling expense — regular	127,772	121,550	6,104	6,000
— GvR program	26,946	27,957	0	0
Postage	<u>17,725</u>	<u>19,200</u>	<u>659</u>	<u>650</u>
<u>Total Circulation and Business</u>	<u>1,054,772</u>	<u>1,097,220</u>	<u>32,922</u>	<u>37,391</u>
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE				
Consultant fees	999	0	0	0
Insurance	4,589	4,626	375	350
Professional fees	21,566	22,500	120	120
Meetings and conferences	39,001	44,108	49	0
Furniture and equipment	6,801	7,000	2,206	0
Canadian exchange and other	5,590	3,600	0	0
Bank service charges	474	360	0	0
Bad debts	<u>14,856</u>	<u>15,000</u>	<u>1,622</u>	<u>1,400</u>
<u>Total General and Administrative</u>	<u>93,876</u>	<u>97,194</u>	<u>4,372</u>	<u>1,870</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>1,448,932</u>	<u>1,515,795</u>	<u>64,449</u>	<u>72,174</u>
Interest earned	90,830	90,980		
French Literature Sales-Net	<u>(650)</u>	<u>0</u>		
NET INCOME (LOSS) FOR PERIOD	<u>(22,543)</u>	<u>(67,143)</u>	<u>(59,224)</u>	<u>(66,214)</u>

() denotes red figures

1999 Contributions From Groups — by Delegate Area

(in U.S. dollars)

AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA	AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
1.	Ala./N.W. Fla.	398	219	55.0%	31,083.54	8,564	\$3.62	59.	Pennsylvania						
2.	Alaska	204	88	43.1	9,289.38	3,684	2.52	60.	East	1,377	736	53.4	125,004.84	32,662	3.82
3.	Arizona	789	377	47.7	80,042.08	17,089	4.68	61.	West	753	376	49.9	44,422.33	10,760	4.12
4.	Arkansas	230	137	59.5	13,904.45	4,206	3.30	62.	Rhode Island	243	110	45.2	18,759.87	5,377	3.48
	California							63.	South Carolina	300	191	63.6	35,109.07	6,552	5.35
5.	Southern	1,925	721	37.4	129,812.86	59,020	2.19	64.	South Dakota	159	60	37.7	4,873.63	3,978	1.22
6.	N. Coastal	1,889	1,048	55.4	207,286.93	56,575	3.66		Tennessee	482	238	49.3	39,915.35	10,816	3.69
7.	N. Interior	699	341	48.7	51,051.00	20,257	2.52		Texas						
8.	San Diego/Imp.	831	358	43.0	59,970.45	24,963	2.40	65.	Northeast	407	201	49.3	54,481.52	16,910	3.22
9.	Mid-South	1,840	718	39.0	108,751.87	59,303	1.83	66.	Northwest	236	96	40.6	14,693.29	6,128	2.39
10.	Colorado	635	345	54.3	65,570.67	14,681	4.46	67.	Southeast	508	217	42.7	37,312.70	15,885	2.34
11.	Connecticut	1,457	543	37.2	70,061.99	35,681	1.96	68.	Southwest	484	225	46.4	45,618.34	11,441	3.98
12.	Delaware	199	117	58.7	22,994.42	3,158	7.28	69.	Utah	253	132	52.1	23,937.24	5,156	4.64
13.	D.C.	467	219	46.8	40,199.82	14,934	2.69	70.	Vermont	226	108	47.7	13,530.28	4,262	3.17
	Florida							71.	Virginia	1,187	626	52.6	88,862.79	23,324	3.80
14.	North	659	363	55.0	67,642.36	15,012	4.50	72.	W. Washington	1,050	524	49.9	94,932.87	23,352	4.06
15.	South/Bahamas/	1,554	801	51.5	144,425.66	33,706	4.28	73.	West Virginia	293	123	41.9	9,119.60	3,351	2.72
	V.I.								Wisconsin						
16.	Georgia	711	432	60.7	69,176.51	16,381	4.22	74.	N. Wis./Upper	618	269	43.5	24,654.15	10,122	2.43
17.	Hawaii	294	151	51.3	25,099.49	5,571	4.50		Pen. Mich.						
18.	Idaho	208	103	49.5	13,192.90	3,463	3.80	75.	South	933	396	42.4	40,690.23	18,389	2.21
	Illinois							76.	Wyoming	112	56	50.0	7,153.85	2,033	3.51
19.	Chicago	1,174	317	27.0	52,300.25	28,645	1.82	77.	Puerto Rico	141	79	56.0	6,704.80	1,687	3.97
20.	North	1,030	402	39.0	48,065.06	21,660	2.21	78.	Alberta/N.W.T.	570	214	37.5	29,841.06	8,418	3.54
21.	South	432	165	38.1	21,572.27	7,348	2.93	79.	B.C./Yukon	733	371	50.6	47,826.63	13,992	3.41
	Indiana							80.	Manitoba	145	66	45.5	5,710.73	3,684	1.55
22.	North	658	262	39.8	42,534.69	9,883	4.30	81.	N.B./P.E.I.	204	93	45.5	6,606.17	3,492	1.89
23.	South	564	250	44.3	28,844.91	10,789	2.67	82.	N.S./Nfld./Lab.	233	93	39.9	7,348.25	3,278	2.24
24.	Iowa	622	308	49.5	33,627.75	12,887	2.60		Ontario						
25.	Kansas	375	171	45.6	26,082.01	9,258	2.81	83.	East	594	234	39.3	29,817.32	15,075	1.97
26.	Kentucky	627	312	49.7	58,362.17	9,743	5.99	84.	Northeast	173	46	26.5	5,038.52	2,364	2.13
27.	Louisiana	517	184	35.5	25,326.26	10,748	2.35	85.	Northwest	89	18	20.2	1,700.06	1,511	1.12
28.	Maine	448	140	31.2	15,779.47	7,633	2.06	86.	West	518	185	35.7	28,693.72	10,132	2.83
29.	Maryland	929	373	40.1	64,100.65	14,650	4.37		Quebec ¹						
	Massachusetts							87.	Southwest	580	336	57.9	15,483.29	15,068	1.02
30.	East	1,519	545	35.8	94,660.29	51,813	1.82	88.	Southeast	226	172	76.0	7,515.78	3,561	2.10
31.	West	244	142	58.1	22,940.86	5,302	4.32	89.	Northwest	358	286	79.9	6,348.55	7,131	0.88
	Michigan							90.	Northwest	390	293	74.9	19,828.71	7,527	2.62
32.	Central	542	226	41.6	36,532.15	12,254	2.98	91.	Saskatchewan	321	99	30.8	6,653.29	3,951	1.68
33.	Southeast	710	279	39.2	56,503.46	18,034	3.13	92.	Washington East	440	187	42.5	16,464.55	6,296	2.61
34.	West	469	194	41.3	30,040.35	8,948	3.35		Total U.S./	56,266	24,889	44.2	\$3,732,196.81	1,261,691	2.96
	Minnesota								Canada						
35.	North	533	242	45.4	21,573.40	8,085	2.66		Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings				223,831.71		
36.	South	991	381	38.4	54,005.46	22,089	2.44		Specials				256,741.32		
37.	Mississippi	238	105	44.1	15,420.07	4,364	3.53		Total for U.S. & Canada				4,212,769.84		
	Missouri														
38.	East	539	251	46.5	43,645.16	9,103	4.79		FOREIGN AND OTHER						
39.	West	210	111	52.8	14,805.18	6,465	2.29		A.A. On Line				2,103.00		
40.	Montana	273	126	46.1	16,843.11	4,305	3.91		IYPCAA				500.00		
41.	Nebraska	662	323	48.7	46,880.15	14,610	3.20		Correctional Facility Groups				196.50		
42.	Nevada	456	175	38.4	27,148.84	9,744	2.78		Foreign				25,218.14		
43.	New Hampshire	547	195	35.6	21,065.35	9,036	2.33		Internationalists				100.00		
	New Jersey								Loners				975.65		
44.	North	1,305	470	36.0	65,006.85	33,225	1.95		Internationalists Groups				20.00		
45.	South	512	247	48.2	44,334.69	9,512	4.66		Canal Zone				96.50		
46.	New Mexico	314	160	50.9	21,697.78	5,683	3.81		World Hello				72.00		
	New York								Grand Total				4,242,051.63		
47.	Central	705	243	34.4	32,517.25	11,498	2.82								
48.	H./M./B.	777	241	31.0	23,530.10	12,167	1.93								
49.	Southeast	1,764	786	44.5	173,060.13	57,083	3.03								
50.	West	304	106	34.8	12,123.60	5,751	2.10								
51.	N. Carolina	900	457	50.7	76,730.12	14,652	5.23								
52.	North Dakota	155	70	45.1	7,904.84	3,064	2.57								
	Ohio														
53.	Cent. & S.E.	644	203	31.5	24,705.11	9,350	2.64								
54.	Northeast	1,277	279	21.8	30,736.53	22,628	1.35								
55.	N.W. Ohio/	278	100	35.9	11,300.59	4,036	2.79								
	S.E. Mich.														
56.	S.W. Ohio	529	210	39.6	30,879.60	10,691	2.88								
57.	Oklahoma	377	225	59.6	32,560.17	6,488	5.01								
58.	Oregon	791	376	47.5	52,240.37	14,554	3.58								

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1999-1998

(in U.S. dollars)

	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
U.S. & Canada						
1999	56,266	24,889	44.2%	\$3,732,196.81 ²	1,261,691	\$2.96
U.S. & Canada						
1998	56,440	25,175	44.6%	\$3,539,847.76 ²	1,268,713	\$2.79
Increase (Decrease)	(174)	(286)	-0.4%	\$192,349.05	(7,022)	\$0.17

¹ Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists of percentages submitted by areas).

² Group contributions reported on this schedule do not include contributions received as special, individual, in-memoriam, and special meetings.

2000 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

Darwin Haines
Jim Hall
¹Mickey Hardesty
Jack Howley
Stella Jenison
Mark Koons
²Bob Peden
Jean-Rock Tremblay

Secretary: Susan Ulseth

Finance

Brookins Beck
¹Gary Colvin
Jim Cotta
Vincent Cousineau
Joe Deneault
²Grace Edwards
Maria Emery
Bonnie McConnell

Secretary: Donald Meurer

Policy/Admissions

Tom Ardolf
¹Scott Castillo
Eric Rossner
Janiece Rydell
Mitch Savage
Mark Sawyer
²Boyd Snook
Marcia Stiff

Secretary: Joanie Moncrief

Treatment Facilities

John Karch
Earl Knowles
²Gene Lesser
Guido MacGuffie
Mike Maes
¹Shirley Rapp
Betty Scherer
John Zinn

Secretary: Rick Walker

³Archives

Grace Edwards
Ivan Gilbert
Marita Hagen
John Karch
²Jamie Rude
¹Mitch Savage
Betty Scherer
John Sigerson

Secretary: Judit Santon

Cooperation With the Professional Community

²Rick Barr
Keith Boyd
Tracy Flematti
Arthur Hobbs
¹Sandy Luetjen
Moose Messerly
David Parrish
Harold Peterson

Secretary: Warren Stafford

Grapevine

Shirley Bair
Loren Buettner
Kenny Gusner
Rusty Kidder
Morgan Jopling
²Luis Pineda
Brenda Sadera
¹Barry Watson
Rhonda Worobey

Secretary: Cynthia Keyworth

Public Information

Ivan Gilbert
Quay Houchen
Paul Jacob
¹Bill Noonan
Kathy Peek
Al Perez
Bernie Rienks
Jamie Rude
²Clayton Vandivort

Secretary: Bill Archer

Trustees

Mike Barnes
Carolyn Chamberlain
Linda Counts
Barrett Francis
¹Nancy Haynes
Laura Hummel
Murray McIntosh
²Don Miller

Secretary: Doug Richardson

Correctional Facilities

Mike Bennett
Vicki Bigelow
Rolly Boyer
¹Murray Cameron
²Bob Fox
Ar Houston
David Lozano
Jesse Mase

Secretary: Adrienne Brown

Literature

¹Bill Aldred
Yoli Flores
²Dick Hill
Dick Martin
Bob Mayer
Carol Readman
Al Ricken
Woody Roderick
Cookie Schamroth

Secretary: Lois Fisher

Report and Charter

Nikki DeFelice
Mike Divin
Jean Dudley
¹Marita Hagen
Gaetan Mongeau
Mike Perry
²Rob Sebastian
John Sigerson

Secretary: Eva Sanchez

³International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Bill Aldred
Scott Castillo
Jim Hall
²Arthur Hobbs
¹Ar Houston
Paul Jacob
Bob Mayer
Carol Readman

Co-secretaries: Valerie O'Neill
Doug Richardson

2001 CONFERENCE CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS⁴

Committee	Chairperson	Alternate
Agenda	Darwin Haines, South Carolina	Jim Hall, Kansas
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Tracy Flematti, W. Massachusetts	David Parrish, Tennessee
Correctional Facilities	Vicki Jo Bigelow, Arizona	Jesse Mase, Maine
Finance	Brookins Beck, Georgia	Maria Emery, Oregon
Grapevine	Rhonda Worobey, Manitoba	Morgan Jopling, Maryland
Literature	Yolanda Flores, SW Texas	Carol Readman, Alberta/NWT
Policy/Admissions	Marcia Stiff, N. Illinois	Tom Ardoff, N. Minnesota
Public Information	Quay Houchen, New York, H/M/B	Alvaro Perez, California, Mid-Southern
Report and Charter	Mike Perry, Vermont	Jean Dudley, Saskatchewan
Treatment Facilities	Guido MacGuffie, Idaho	John Karch, SW Ohio
Committee on Trustees	Mike Barnes, New York, Western	Linda Counts, NW Texas
³ International Conv./Regional Forum	Bob Mayer, N. Wisc./U.P. Mich.	Paul Jacob, South Dakota
³ Archives	John Sigerson, Nebraska	Ivan Gilbert, Western Ontario

¹Chairperson

²Alternate Chairperson

³Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment and not a primary committee assignment.

⁴The 2000 committee chairs rotated at the end of the 50th General Service Conference.

2000 Trustees' Committees

Archives

Linda Chezem, *chairperson*
 Carl Budd
 Garry McAuley
 Jan Polek
 Betty Stevens
 Greg Tobin
 Judit Santon, *secretary*

Conference

Jim Clough, *chairperson*
 Linda Chezem
 Ronald Gauthier
 Beth Rabren
 Dean Rinehart
 Tony Taschner
 Susan Ulseth, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community/ Treatment Facilities

George Vaillant, M.D., *chairperson*
 *Paul Cleary
 *Calvin James
 Elaine Johnson, Ph.D.
 *Robert McCoy
 Robert Miller, D.D.
 Alex Palmer
 Beth Rabren
 Ray Stiver
 Warren Stafford, *secretary*
 —C.P.C.
 Rick Walker, *secretary*
 —Treatment Facilities

Correctional Facilities

Carl Budd, *chairperson*
 Linda Chezem
 *Mark Gornik
 *Bruce Henry
 Jackie Johnston
 *Sharon Stone
 Betty Stevens
 Adrienne Brown, *secretary*

Finance & Budgetary

Art Knight, *chairperson*
 Carl Budd
 David Every
 Ron Gauthier
 Tom Maguire
 Jack Ostrem
 Tony Taschner
 Dennis Manders, *senior advisor*
 Robert Slotterback, *GV controller*
 Kevin Sunkel, C.P.A., *independent auditor*
 Donald Meurer, *secretary*

International

Dean Rinehart, *chairperson*
 Marne Hill
 Alex Palmer
 Peter Roach
 Ray Stiver
 George Vaillant, M.D.
 Eva Sanchez, *secretary*

International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Peter Roach, *chairperson*
 Elaine Johnson, Ph.D.
 Art Knight
 Garry McAuley
 Alex Palmer
 Richard Roughton
 Greg Tobin
 Valerie O'Neill, *secretary*
 —International Conventions
 Doug Richardson, *secretary*
 —Regional Forums

Literature

Richard Roughton, *chairperson*
 Jim Clough
 David Every
 John Koster
 Garry McAuley
 Jan Polek
 Beth Rabren
 *David Sahatdjian
 Richard Roughton
 George Vaillant, M.D.
 Vincina McCarthy, *consultant*
 Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
 Lois Fisher, *secretary*

Nominating

Jackie Johnston, *chairperson*
 Marne Hill
 Art Knight
 Robert Miller, D.D.
 Jack Ostrem
 Dean Rinehart
 Peter Roach
 Doug Richardson, *secretary*

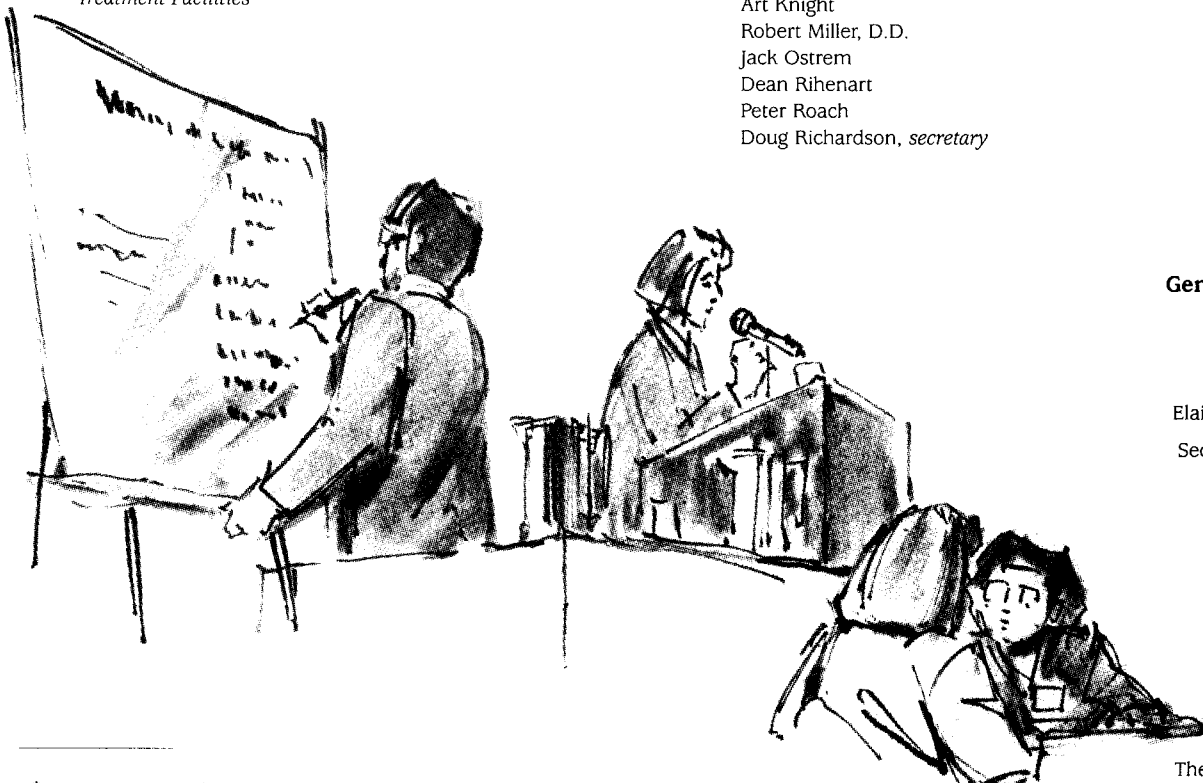
Public Information

Robert Miller, *chairperson*
 *Burke Dykes
 *Tony Hurley
 John Koster
 *Lindajo Loftus
 Tom Maguire
 Tony Taschner
 Bill Archer, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

Betty Stevens, *chairperson*
 Joanie Moncrief, *secretary*

All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."



Officers of the General Service Board

Chairperson
 Gary Glynn
 First vice-chairperson
 Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D.
 Second vice-chairperson
 Peter Roach
 Secretary
 Garry McAuley
 Treasurer
 Art Knight
 Assistant secretary
 Joanie Moncrief
 Assistant treasurer
 Donald Meurer

The new slate of officers is given on page 41

*Denotes appointed committee members

**Gary Glynn and Greg Muth are ex officio members of all committees.

2000 Conference Members

NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

Gary A. Glynn (1112 Park Ave., New York, NY 10128) was elected chairman of the board at the meeting following the 1997 Conference. He has been a member of the board since 1993 and has served as treasurer of the General Service Board, as well as chair of the Finance & Budgetary Committee. A graduate of the University of Vermont and the Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania, he has been an investment analyst and portfolio manager for over 30 years, and is active in various professional organizations and committees.

Linda L. Chezem, J.D. (530 Denny Dr., Mooresville, IN 46158) was elected to the board in April 1997. A graduate of Indiana University School of Law, Linda is a former judge, Court of Appeals of Indiana. She started the first certified court alcohol and drug program in Indiana, and has conducted seminars and written articles on such subjects as DWI, family and addiction. Linda chairs the Archives Committee and also serves on the Correctional Facilities and Conference Committees.

Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D. (6631 Hunters Wood Circle, Baltimore, MD 21228) was elected to the board in May 1992. Elaine has a distinguished background in the fields of alcoholism and substance abuse. She has lectured widely, been a consultant to national and international government and professional organizations and published many articles in professional journals. She is a former professor of social work at Morgan State University. For eight years she served as the director of the Center for Substance Abuse Prevention, and was the former acting administrator of the Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration under U.S. Dept. of Health and Human Services. Elaine serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities and the International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums Committees, and is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Arthur L. Knight, Jr. (560 Stockbridge Court, Lake Forest, IL 60045-2680) was elected to the board in 1995. Art's professional background is in the field of business, where he has held positions as president, director, and chief executive officer of manufacturing, distribution and financial services companies. He is a graduate of Dartmouth College and holds an M.B.A. from the University of New York, Buffalo. While Art is no longer involved in day-to-day business operations, he serves on a variety of business, professional and civic boards. He is treasurer of the General Service Board, chairs the Finance & Budgetary Committee and also serves on the International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums and Nominating Committees.

Robert Oran Miller, D.D. (2104 Vestavia Lake Dr., Birmingham, AL 35216) was elected to the board in 1995. Elected ninth Bishop of the Diocese of Alabama in 1988, Bob has served as deacon and rector in several parishes in Alabama and held positions on various councils of the Episcopal church. He received an honorary Doctorate of Divinity from the University of the South, where he serves on the board of trustees. Bob chairs the Public Information Committee and also serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities and Nominating Committees.

Peter Roach (1332 Edmison Dr., Peterborough, Ontario K9H 6V3, Canada) was elected to the board in 1994. Peter has been an elementary and secondary school teacher. When he retired in 1992, he had completed 18 years as director of education for Peterborough Separate School Board. Since his retirement he is involved extensively in the community by serving on the Hospital Board, United Way, the Ontario Superannuated Teachers' Board and on a standing committee of the Community College. He is also chair of the Pastoral Council for his parish. Peter chairs the International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums Committee and also serves on the International and Nominating Committees.

George E. Vaillant, M.D. (Brigham and Women's Hospital, 75 Francis St., Boston, MA 02115) was elected to the board in 1998. He is a graduate of Harvard Medical School and the Boston Psychoanalytic Institute. George is professor, Dept. of Psychiatry, Harvard Medical School; senior physician, Brigham and Women's Hospital; and on the faculty of Boston Psychoanalytic Institute. He has lectured widely and is the author of many articles on alcoholism and addiction. George chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committee and also serves on the Literature and International Committees.

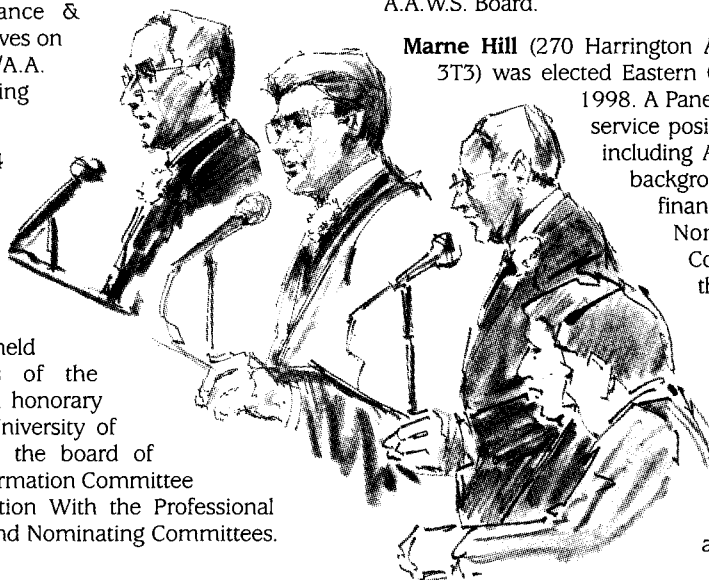
ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

Carl Budd (1405 Collins St., Rock Springs, WY 82901) was elected West Central regional trustee in April 1996. A Panel 30 delegate, Carl has remained active in his area, particularly in collecting material for the area archives. After many years in the oil and gas industry, he retired in 1995 from the Department of the Interior, after 14 years of service. Carl chairs the Correctional Facilities Committee and is a member of the Archives and Finance & Budgetary Committees.

Jim Clough (1873 Parkview Circle, Costa Mesa, CA 92627) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 1998. A Panel 42 delegate, Jim has been active in his area and has served as an appointed committee member on the trustees' Literature Committee. A retired naval architect and marine engineer he is currently co-owner of a company involved in the publishing, wholesaling, and retailing of art. Jim chairs the Conference Committee and also serves on the Literature Committee. He is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Marne Hill (270 Harrington Ave., Thunder Bay, Ontario P7A 3T3) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 1998. A Panel 41 delegate she has held many service positions at the local and area level, including Area 85 archivist. Marne, whose background is in banking, is currently a financial planner. She serves on the Nominating and International Committees and is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Jacqueline Johnston (78213 Sunrise Mountain View, Palm Desert, CA 92211) was elected general service trustee in April 1998, after serving as a nontrustee director on the A.A.W.S. Board. Jackie has been active for many years in area and district service work and



¹ Rotating at the close of the 2000 Conference meeting.

was Panel 41 delegate from Southern California. Now retired, she worked as a C.P.A. for a national accounting firm in both New York and California, and as a teacher in Los Angeles. Jackie serves on the A.A.W.S. Board, chairs the Nominating Committee, and serves on the Correctional Facilities Committee.

Garry McAuley (#13 Kendrew Dr., Red Deer, Alberta, Canada T4P 3V2) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in April 1996. A Panel 40 delegate, he was safety and environmental advisor for an oil and gas company and retired in 1997. Garry is a member of the International Conventions/Regional Forums, Archives and Literature Committees.

Tom Maguire (941 Pineview Circle, Live Oak, FL 32060) was elected general service trustee in April 1997. Tom served four years as a nontrustee director on the Grapevine Board. He is general manager for a national radio network, and has had a long career in television station management. He serves on the Public Information and Finance & Budgetary Committees and chairs the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Jack L. Ostrem (913 Grand Blvd., Joliet, IL 60436) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 1997. A Panel 34 delegate, Jack has long been active in his area, especially in corrections service work. Now retired, his major occupation for many years was in warehouse management. Jack chairs the A.A.W.S. Board and serves on the Nominating and Finance & Budgetary Committees.

Alex D. J. Palmer (33439 Huggins Ave., Abbotsford, BC, V2S 2R8, Canada) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada, April 1999. A Panel 45 delegate from BC/Yukon, Alex has held many service positions in his area. He has been a CGA (certified general accountant) and controller for different organizations and small businesses, and is currently executive director of a recovery house and business director of an alcohol and drug program for youth. Alex serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities, International and International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums Committees.

Beth Rabren (224 First St., Brazoria, TX 77422) was elected Southwest regional trustee in April 1999. As a Panel 39 delegate she chaired the Conference Committee on Trustees, she continues to be active in her home group, area and region. Beth's professional background is in education, as teacher and administrator, and in treatment as a licensed counselor and administrator. Beth serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities, Conference and Literature Committees.

Dean Rinehart (613 Matthews, El Reno, OK 73036) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 1997. As a Panel 37 delegate, he chaired the Grapevine Conference Committee, and has continued to be active in service work in the area and region. A practicing attorney, Dean is also engaged in cattle and farming activities. He chairs the International Committee, as well as serving on the Conference and Nominating Committees.

Richard Roughton (70 W. Huron, Apt. 806, Chicago, IL 60610) was elected general service trustee in April 1997. A Panel 34 delegate from Rhode Island, Richard served as a nontrustee director on the A.A.W.S. Board, 1993-1997. He has a Ph.D. in history and is dean of the College of Arts and Science at a university in Chicago. Richard chairs the Literature Committee and serves on the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committee and the A.A.W.S. Board.

Betty Stevens (1420 Nunamaker Dr., Columbia, SC 29210) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 1997. A Panel 31 dele-

gate, Betty has held various service positions in her area and was active in committee work for her local district. Now retired, she has worked in EAP and as an alcoholism counselor. Betty serves on the Archives and Correctional Facilities Committees, and is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Tony Taschner (16 Cindy Lane, Berlin, CT 06037) was elected Northeast regional trustee in April 1999. Tony served as a Panel 45 delegate, where he chaired the Conference Treatment Facilities Committee, and has held many service positions in his district and area. He is an assistant vice president in Data Management of a large financial service company. Tony serves on the Conference, Finance & Budgetary and Public Information Committees.

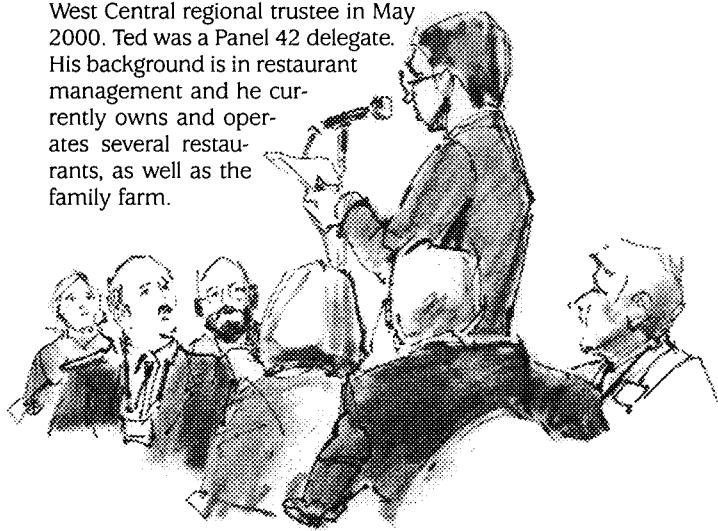
Greg Tobin (64 Duffield Dr., South Orange, NJ 07079) was elected general service trustee in April 1999, after serving for three years as a director on the Grapevine Corporate Board. He has been active in various service committees in his home area and district. Greg has had a long career in the book-publishing industry and is currently editor-in-chief of a large publishing house. Greg serves on the Archives and International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums Committees and is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Trustees elected by the General Service Board following 2000 Conference

Leonard M. Blumenthal (Rolly View, Alberta T0C 2K0, Canada), was elected a Class A trustee in 2000. In 1998 Len retired as chief executive officer of the Alberta Alcohol and Drug Abuse Commission, where he had worked for 30 years. He remains active in the alcoholism field as speaker, consultant and a resource person.

R.J.M. (Ric) Downey (PH4-9541 Erickson Dr., Burnaby, BC V3J 7N8, Canada) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in May 2000. A Panel 47 delegate, where he chaired the Policy Admissions Committee, Ric has remained active in his area. He has been involved in programming and training for a computer operating system and is part of a maintenance management team for the Vancouver area.

Ted Stoa (402 S. Kline St., Aberdeen, SD 57401) was elected West Central regional trustee in May 2000. Ted was a Panel 42 delegate. His background is in restaurant management and he currently owns and operates several restaurants, as well as the family farm.



A.A. World Services Directors

Richard Roughton, *chairperson, general service trustee*
 Ron Gauthier, *nontrustee director*
 Jacqueline Johnston, *general service trustee*

John Koster, *nontrustee director*
 Garry McAuley, *regional trustee*
 Greg Muth, *G.S.O. general manager*
 Jack Ostrem, *regional trustee*
 Jan Polek, *nontrustee director*
 Joanie Moncriaf, *G.S.O. staff member*

A.A. Grapevine Directors

Carl Budd, *chairperson, regional trustee*
 David Every, *nontrustee director*
 Elaine Johnson, Ph.D., *Class A trustee*
 Thomas Maguire, *general service trustee*

Betty Stevens, *regional trustee*
 Ray Stiver, *nontrustee director*
 Greg Tobin, *nontrustee director*
 Ames Sweet, *Grapevine executive editor*

General Service Office Staff

Greg Muth, *general manager*
 Tom Jasper, *services director*
 Bill Archer
 Adrienne Brown
 Lois Fisher
 Joanie Moncrief
 Daniel Mooney

Valerie O'Neill
 Doug Richardson
 Eva Sanchez
 Warren Stafford
 Susan Ulseth
 Rick Walker

Grapevine Staff

Ames Sweet, *executive editor*
 MaryPat Hester, *circulation director*

Cynthia Keyworth, *senior editor*

Others Assisting the Conference (*nonvoting*)

Caryl Bertolino, *staff assistant*
 Ellie Biscuti, *staff assistant*
 Rosa Blanco, *financial secretary*
 Daniel Brown, *designer/typesetter*
 Shawn Bunkley, *general office clerk*
 Ramona Cabrera, *staff assistant*
 Angel Calvillo, *translator*
 Sheila Copin, *staff assistant*
 Joseph Dennan, *staff assistant*
 John de Stefano, *Spanish-language editor*
 Al Herr, *artist, Conference Report*
 John Kirwin Jr., *assistant controller/business administration*
 Marsha Levine, *GV editorial staff assistant*
 Vinnie McCarthy, *publications director*
 Dennis Manders, *senior advisor, finance committee*
 Don Meurer, *controller, A.A.W.S.*
 Lillianna Murphy, *information services manager*
 Ivelisse Rivera, *staff assistant*
 Miguel Rodriguez, *general office clerk*
 Linda Samuels, *staff assistant*
 Judit Santon, *archivist*
 Frank Segui, *staff assistant*
 Robert Slotterback, *GV controller*
 Elaine Soroka, *special projects manager*
 Kevin Sunkel, *independent auditor*
 Yee Tully, *staff assistant*
 Stephen Turchyn, *data processing supervisor*
 Andre Washington, *purchasing agent*
 Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, Conference Report*
 Nannie Williams, *staff assistant*

Trustees emeritus

Michael Alexander
 W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr.
 Gordon Patrick

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 50th Conference includes Panel 49 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 50 (new delegates).

UNITED STATES

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	49	Janiece Rydell Box 7456 Spanish Fort, AL 36577
Alaska	2	50	Harold Peterson, Jr. 2921 W. 29th Ave., #5B Anchorage, AK 99517
Arizona	3	50	Vicki Jo Bigelow 2602 W. Hayward Phoenix, AZ 85051
Arkansas	4	49	Sandy Luetjen 301 E. Tahlequah Siloam Springs, AR 72761
California Southern	5	49	Marita Hagen 514 E. Elmwood Ave., #F Burbank, CA 91501-2589
Northern Coastal	6	49	Nancy Haynes Box 151 St. Helena, CA 94574
Northern Interior	7	50	Woody Roderick 615 DuPont Dr. Stockton, CA 95210-2013
San Diego/Imperial	8	50	Mark Koons Box 33026 San Diego, CA 92163-2026
Mid-Southern	9	50	Alvaro (Al) Perez 1379 San Bernardino Rd., #E Upland, CA 91786
Colorado	10	49	Don Miller 213 S. Hoover Ave. Louisville, CO 80027
Connecticut	11	49	James (Jamie) Rude 141 W. Main St. Milford, CT 06460-3338
Delaware	12	50	Allen (Al) Rieken RR1, Box 146J Laurel, DE 19956
District of Columbia	13	49	Earl Knowles 2709 Keystone Lane Bowie, MD 20715
Florida North	14	49	Kathy Peek 6968 N.W. 57th Ave. Ocala, FL 34482
S. Florida/Bahamas/V.I.	15	49	Brenda Sadara Box 3 Sanibel, FL 33957
Georgia	16	50	C. Brookins Beck 287 W. Lakeview Dr. Milledgeville, GA 31061
Hawaii	17	49	Scott Castillo 94-1139 Moolelo St. Waipahu, HI 96797
Idaho	18	50	Gerald (Guido) MacGuffie 832 N. Damask Pl. Boise, ID 83702

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>		<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Illinois				Montana	40	50	Loren Buettner 409 N. Wilson, #31 Bozeman, MT 59715
Chicago	19	49	William (Bill) Noonan Box 268020 Chicago, IL 60626	Nebraska	41	50	John Sigerson 3725 S. 116th Ave. Omaha, NE 68144
Northern	20	50	Marcia Stiff 52 Hilltop Rd. Lake in the Hills, IL 60102-1458	Nevada	42	49	Richard (Dick) Hill 305 Surprise, Box 72 Searchlight, NV 89046
Southern	21	49	Dick Martin 1011 Perrysville Rd. Danville, IL 61832	New Hampshire	43	50	Mark Sawyer 2 Lincoln Dr. Bow, NH 03304-3209
Indiana				New Jersey			
Northern	22	49	Bob Peden 188 Brookside Manor Goshen, IN 46526	Northern	44	49	James (Keith) Boyd 21 Hemlock Rd. Rockaway, NJ 07866
Southern	23	50	Carolyn Chamberlin 241 S. Fourth St. Clinton, IN 47842	Southern	45	50	Stella Jenison 237 Pomona Ave. Glassboro, NJ 08028
Iowa	24	49	John Zinn 203 E. 21st St., Apt. 1 Spencer, IA 51301	New Mexico	46	50	David Lozano Box 2453 Carlsbad, NM 88221
Kansas	25	50	Jim Hall 2512 Century Lawrence, KS 66049	New York			
Kentucky	26	50	Betty Scherer 644 Halifax Dr. Lexington, KY 40503	Central	47	49	John (Jack) Howley 99 Etna Rd. Ithaca, NY 14850
Louisiana	27	49	Dominique (Nikki) DeFelice 2014 Pecan Ridge Ave. Baton Rouge, LA 70816	Hudson/Mohawk/ Berkshire	48	50	Quay Houchen 80 Lincoln Ave. Albany, NY 12206-1404
Maine	28	50	Jesse Mase 51 Myrtle Ave. South Portland, ME 04106	Southeast	49	49	Clarisse (Cookie) Schamroth 242 E. 19th St., #14F New York, NY 10003
Maryland	29	50	Morgan Jopling 1668 Wilkshire Dr. Crofton, MD 21114	Western	50	50	Michael (Mike) Barnes 5923 Java Lake Rd. Arcade, NY 14009-9623
Massachusetts				North Carolina	51	49	William (Bill) Aldred 101 Blackford Ct. Durham, NC 27712-9497
Eastern	30	49	Robert (Bob) Sweeney 83 High St. Quincy, MA 02169	North Dakota	52	50	Michael (Mike) Bennett Box 137 Kenmare, ND 58746-0137
Western	31	50	Tracy Flematti 3201 Main St. Box 668 Bondsville, MA 01009	Ohio			
Michigan				Central Southeast	53	49	Richard (Rick) Barr 4092 Berrybush Dr. Gahanna, OH 43230
Central	32	49	Robert (Murray) Cameron 2800 Ridge Rd. Ossineke, MI 49766	Northeast	54	49	Robert (Rob) Sebastian 261 Schrop Ave., #1 Akron, OH 44312-1204
Southeast	33	49	Laura Hummel 36895 Green St., #8 New Baltimore, MI 48047	NW Ohio/SE Mich.	55	50	Shirley Bair 4615 N. Holland Sylvania Rd., Condo 7 Toledo, OH 43623
Western	34	50	Bernard (Bernie) Rienks 1509 North St. NE Grand Rapids, MI 49505	Southwest	56	50	John Karch 3449 Frahm Pike Celina, OH 45822
Minnesota				Oklahoma	57	49	Mitchell (Mitch) Savage 221 East 20th Tulsa, OK 74119
Northern	35	50	Thomas (Tom) Ardolf 2992 County Rd., 137 Waite Park, MN 56387	Oregon	58	50	Maria Emery Box 69 White Salmon, WA 98672
Southern	36	49	Bonnie McConnell 2815 20th Ave. NW Austin, MN 55912	Pennsylvania			
Mississippi	37	50	Barrett Francis Box 307 Amory, MS 38821-0307	Eastern	59	49	Gary Colvin Rear 837 Maple St. Scranton, PA 18505
Missouri				Western	60	49	Arlene (Ar) Houston 210 Mansfield Rd. Washington, PA 15301-8931
Eastern	38	49	William (Clayton) Vandivort Box 158 Sikeston, MO 63801				
Western	39	49	Shirley Rapp 4712 Roanoke Pkwy., #701 Kansas City, MO 64112				

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Rhode Island	61	50	Jim Cotta 156 Thatcher St. East Providence, RI 02916
South Carolina	62	50	Darwin Haines 503 9th Ave. Conway, SC 29526-4028
South Dakota	63	50	Paul Jacob 8816 Valley View Dr. Sturgis, SD 57785
Tennessee	64	50	David Parrish 709 Pair Rd. Martin, TN 38237
Texas <i>Northeast</i>	65	49	Luis Pineda 4113 Woodbury Rd. Balch Springs, TX 75180
<i>Northwest</i>	66	50	Linda Counts 140 Fairview Borger, TX 79007-8300
<i>Southeast</i>	67	49	Mike Divin 1105 Glade College Station, TX 77840
<i>Southwest</i>	68	50	Yolanda (Yoli) Flores 815 Rayburn, #303 San Antonio, TX 78224
Utah	69	49	Mickey Hardesty Box 154 Springville, UT 84663
Vermont	70	50	Mike Perry 11 Mechanic St. Fair Haven, VT 05743
Virginia	71	49	Gene Lesser 7711 Fisher Dr. Falls Church, VA 22043
Washington <i>State East</i>	92	50	Rusty Kidder 4203 N. Normandie Spokane, WA 99205
<i>Western</i>	72	49	Robert (Bob) Fox 5142 S. Findlay St. Seattle, WA 98118-2559
West Virginia	73	49	Joseph (Joe) Deneault 1502 Grandview Dr. Charleston, WV 25302
Wisconsin <i>No. WI/ Up. Penn. MI</i>	74	50	Robert (Bob) Mayer 413 Wisconsin Ave. Ontonagon, MI 49953
<i>Southern</i>	75	49	Ken (Kenny) Gusner 800 N. Sherwood Dr. Beloit, WI 53511
Wyoming	76	50	R. E. (Moose) Messerly 570 Logan Green River, WY 82935
Puerto Rico	77	50	Eric Rossner Urb. Mansion Del Sol MS-53 Via Arco Iris Toa Baja, PR 00952-4044

CANADA

<u>Province</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alberta/N.W.T.	78	50	Carol Readman Box 551 Consort, AB T0C 1B0
B.C./Yukon	79	49	Grace Edwards #307-1011 Fourth Ave. New Westminster, BC V3M 1T3
Manitoba	80	50	Rhonda Worobey #600-1310 Archibald St. Winnipeg, MB R2J 0Z4
New Brunswick/P.E.I.	81	50	Connie (Mike) Maes 21 Great George St., #207 Charlottetown, PEI C1A 4J7
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	82	49	Boyd Snook Box 4 Holyrood, NF A0A 2R0
Ontario <i>Eastern</i>	83	49	Barry Watson 14 Low Meadoway Toronto, ON M2H 2V7
<i>Northeast</i>	84	49	Rolly Boyer 180 Ivanhoe Dr. North Bay, ON P1A 3B8
<i>Northwest</i>	85	49	Murray McIntosh 426 Cuyler St. Thunder Bay, ON P7A 1B2
<i>Western</i>	86	50	Ivan Gilbert 943 #6 Hwy. Box 196 Millgrove, ON L0R 1V0
Quebec <i>Southwest</i>	87	50	Vincent Cousineau 281 Francois-Seguin Boucherville, PQ J4B 1L6
<i>Southeast</i>	88	49	Jean-Rock Tremblay 1123, Ave. St-Louis Plessisville, PQ G6L 2M4
<i>Northeast</i>	89	49	Arthur Hobbs 3132 Cadieu Jonquiere, PQ G7S 2C2
<i>Northwest</i>	90	50	Gaetan Mongeau 310 A Cercle Lacas Rosemere, PQ J7A 1W6
Saskatchewan	91	50	Jean Dudley 421 Ave. T South Saskatoon, SK S7M 3B3

